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Nigerian's Peoples and Culture

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HEADQUARTERS

PLOT 1059 O.P. FINGESI ROAD,

UTAKO, ABUJA

COURSE DEVELOPMENT TEAM

Content Editor: Chidinma Onyechi B.Sc. Economics

Language Editor: Udochi Obiukwu MA English Language

Instructional Designer: Dr Kenneth Kenechukwu Ph.D Economics

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Session 1: Nigeria's History, Culture, and Arts in Precolonial Times

Introduction

The history and cultures of Nigeria offer a fascinating glimpse into the ancient civilizations and diverse societies that have shaped the region over thousands of years. From the early Nigerian cultures and the Nok civilization to the emergence of powerful kingdoms and empires, such as Kanem-Borno, Hausaland, Yorubaland, Benin, and the Igbo and Delta city-states, Nigeria's past is marked by remarkable achievements in art, trade, governance, and religion. The Sokoto Jihad and the collapse of the Oyo empire further illustrate the dynamic and transformative periods in Nigeria's history. This article delves into the rich historical tapestry of Nigeria, highlighting significant cultural milestones and shedding light on the legacies that continue to influence the country today.

Learning Outcomes for Study Session 1

When you have studied this session, you should be able to:

- 1.1. Understand the significance of early Nigerian cultures, such as the Nok culture, and recognize their contributions to Nigerian art and society.
- 1.2. Analyse the characteristics and artistic achievements of ancient cultures like Igbo Ukwu, Benin, Ife, and Oyo, and understand their influence on surrounding regions.

- 1.3. Identify and describe the kingdoms and empires of precolonial Nigeria, including the Hausa states, Kanem-Borno, and Yoruba states, and appreciate their political, economic, and cultural developments.
- 1.4. Explain the historical context and impact of the Sokoto Jihad and its establishment of the Sokoto Caliphate, including its influence on various regions and the consolidation of politico-religious systems.
- 1.5. Assess the factors contributing to the collapse of the Oyo empire and its consequences for the Yoruba people, including the migration and establishment of new centres.
- 1.6. Appreciate Nigeria's cultural heritage and recognize the diversity and richness of its cultural expressions, including art, religion, and social structures.

1.1: History and Cultures of Nigeria

1.1.1: Early Nigerian cultures

The Nok culture

Evidence of human occupation in Nigeria dates back thousands of years. The oldest fossil remains found by archaeologists in the southwestern area of Iwo Eleru, near Akure, have been dated to about 9000 BCE. There are isolated collections of ancient tools and artefacts of different periods of the Stone Age, but the oldest recognizable evidence of an organised society belongs to the Nok culture (c. 500 BCE–c. 200 CE).

Figure 1.1: Nok Pottery Head



Named for the village of Nok, site of some of the finds, the ancient culture produced fine terra-cotta figurines, which were accidentally discovered by tin miners on the Jos Plateau in the 1930s. Initially Neolithic (New Stone Age), the Nok culture made the transition to the Iron Age. Its people raised

crops and cattle and seem to have paid particular attention to personal adornment, especially of the hair. Distinctive features of Nok art include naturalism, stylized treatment of the mouth and eyes, relative proportions of the human head, body, and feet, distortions of the human facial features, and treatment of animal forms. The spread of Nok-type figures in a wide area south of the Jos Plateau, covering southern Kaduna state southeastward to Katsina Ala, south of the Benue River, suggests a well-established culture that left traces still identifiable in the lives of the peoples of the area today. Many of the distinctive features of Nok art can also be traced in later developments of Nigerian art produced in such places as Igbo Ukwu, Ife, Esie, and Benin City.

Igbo Ukwu

Bronzes, which have been dated to about the 9th century CE, were discovered in the 1930s and '40s at Igbo Ukwu, near the southwestern city of Onitsha. (See *also* African art.) They reveal not only a high artistic tradition but also a well-structured society with wide-ranging economic relationships. Of particular interest is the source of the copper and lead used to make the bronzes, which may have been Tadmekka in the Sahara, and of the coloured glass beads, some of which may have come from Venice and India, the latter via trade routes through Egypt, the Nile valley, and the Chad basin. It is believed that the bronzes were part of the furniture in the burial chamber of a high personage, possibly a forerunner of the *eze nri*, a priest-king, who held religious but not political power over large parts of the Igbo-inhabited region well into the 20th century.

1.1.2: Kingdoms and Empires of Precolonial Nigeria

Many indigenous polities emerged in Nigeria before the British took control in the late 19th century. In the north there were several large and developed systems, including the Hausa states of Kano, Katsina, Zaria, and Gobir; Kanem-Borno; and the Jukun states of Kwararafa, Kona, Pinguda, and Wukari. Smaller kingdoms included those of the Igala, Nupe, and Ebira. Notable in the south were the Yoruba states of Ife and Oyo, the Edo state of Benin, the Itsekiri state of Warri, the Efik state of Calabar, and the Ijo (Ijaw) city-states of Nembe, Elem Kalabari, Bonny, and Okrika.

kanem -Bornu

The history of Borno antedates the 9th century, when Arabic writers in North Africa first noted the kingdom of Kanem, east of Lake Chad. The lake was then much larger than the present-day body of water, and its basin attracted settlements and encouraged exchange. A pastoral group, ancestors of the Kanuri, established a centralised state over those referred to collectively as the Sao. Initially, trading links extended to the Nile valley of Egypt. There is some evidence that Kanem had made contact with the Christian kingdoms of Nubia before it was overrun by Muslims, who gained a foothold in the ruling family of Kanem in the 11th century. From Kanem the rulers tried to dominate the areas south and west of the lake as well. By the 12th century they had been compelled by attacks from the Sao to move their capital to the region west of Lake Chad, and they gradually lost control of most of the original Kanem.

For a long time, Borno was the dominant power in the central Sudan, including much of Hausaland. The Bayajidda legend, concerning a mythical Middle Eastern

ancestor of the Hausa, seems to suggest that the rise of a centralised political system in Hausaland was influenced from Borno. Though the rulers of Borno embraced Islam, the structure of the monarchy remained traditional, with the queen mother and other female officials exercising considerable power. The selection of the monarch, the coronation rites, and other bases of royal authority were dictated by pre-Islamic beliefs. The princes and other members of the royal family were granted fiefs and posted away from the capital to govern frontier zones, while people of slave origin were preferred for the royal guard and palace officials.

Hausaland

For centuries, the Hausa have occupied the northern plains beyond the Jos Plateau, which were a crossroads open not only to Borno but also to the states of Mali and Songhai in the western Sudan, the trans-Saharan routes to northern Africa, and various trade routes to the forest areas of Borgu, Oyo, and Benin. Perhaps because of this strategic location, the Hausa developed a number of centralised states—such as Daura, Katsina, Kano, Zaria, Gobir, and, later, Kebbi—each with a walled city, a market centre, and a monarchical system of government. Islam, which was introduced from the Mali empire in the 14th century, strengthened both the monarchical system and the commercial contacts, but it remained predominantly an urban religion until the beginning of the 19th century. Even within the walled cities, however, some pre-Islamic rites remained part of the ceremonies that sustained monarchical authority. A considerable rivalry existed between the different states over agricultural land and the control of trade and

trade routes, and Hausaland was periodically conquered by powerful neighbours such as Borno and Songhai.

Yorubaland and Benin

Ife, which flourished between the 11th and 15th centuries, emerged as a major power in the forested areas west of the Niger and south of Hausaland. Some of the characteristic features of Yoruba culture emerged during that time: a monarchical system based on city-states and nucleated villages; a pantheon of gods, a few of which were recognized widely but with several local variations; and divination centred on the deity Ifa, with its corpus of sacred chants. Ife is best known for its potsherd pavements and for the great artistry of its terra-cottas and bronzes, especially the naturalism of many of its bronze figures. (*See also* African art.) Ife's influence on surrounding states is evident in the fact that all the monarchies of Yoruba states claim descent from Ife as a way of establishing legitimacy, sometimes borrowing regalia from Ife to use in coronation rites and sometimes sending remains of deceased rulers to Ife for burial.

Oyo, founded in the 14th century and located in the savannah to the north of the forest, gradually supplanted the older kingdom of Ife. After more than a century of struggle with nearby Borgu and Nupe, it established itself strategically as the emporium for exchanging goods from the north—rock salt, copper, textiles, leather goods, and horses—with products from the south—kola nuts, indigo, parrots, and cowries. By the 17th century it had built up a cavalry force with which it dominated people in western Yorubaland and in the dry gap to the coast; to the south, infestations of tsetse flies prevented kingdoms there from effectively utilising horses.

When the Portuguese arrived in the kingdom of Benin in the 15th century, they found a monarchy, dating back many centuries, with a complex structure of chiefs and palace officials presiding over a kingdom that was expanding in all directions. In time, Benin dominated not only the Edo-speaking peoples to the north and south but also the area eastward to the Niger and, along the coast, to Lagos (which the Edo now claim to have founded) and even into present-day Ghana. It also exerted considerable influence on eastern Yorubaland and maintained trading connections with Oyo. Benin art, which began to flourish in the 15th century, was characterised by naturalistic bronze sculptures and bronze door panels that covered the outside of the royal palace.

Figure 1.2: Portuguese Explorer or Trader



Igboland and the Delta City-States

Many Nigerian peoples did not develop centralised monarchical states. Of these, the Igbo were probably the most remarkable because of the size of their territory and the density of population. The Igbo characteristic decentralised society seems to have been a deliberate departure from the earlier traditions of Nri; monarchical institutions in such outlying cities as Asaba, Onitsha, and Aboh probably arose through the influence of the kingdoms of Igala and Benin. Igbo lineages were organised in self-contained villages or federations of village communities, with societies of elders and age grade associations sharing various governmental functions. The same was true of the Ijo of the Niger delta and peoples of the Cross River area, where secret societies also played a prominent role in administration. Monarchical structures began to emerge by the 18th century in response to the needs of overseas trade.

Initially, Portuguese contacts focused on Benin and Warri. By the 17th and 18th centuries, at the height of the slave trade, the delta city-states had become the principal outlets of that activity. Various coastal communities organized themselves as entrepôts of the slave trade, so that they would not also become its victims. Similarly, the Igbo, like the Benin and Yoruba kingdoms, supplied slaves to the coast, although Benin had largely ended its involvement in the Atlantic slave trade by the 18th century. The deleterious effect of the slave trade on the society and the economy was felt everywhere, but, in terms of loss of population, those who suffered most appear to have been the noncentralized peoples of the middle belt. The trade also caused severe economic and political dislocations,

intercommunal rivalries, and the forced migrations of millions of people out of Nigeria.

The Sokoto Jihad

At the beginning of the 19th century, Islam was well established at all the major centres of the Hausa states and Borno. The *etsu* (ruler) of Nupe had accepted Islam, and a few teachers and itinerant preachers were also known in parts of the Oyo empire. A group of Muslim intellectuals, most of them Fulani led by Usman dan Fodio, were unhappy that in all these places the rulers allowed the practice of Islam to be mixed with aspects of traditional religion and that nowhere was Islamic law (the Sharī'ah) observed in full. After 20 years of writing, teaching, and preaching in Gobir and surrounding states, Shehu (meaning "chief" or "senior") Usman (as he was now called) withdrew his followers to Gudu, where they formally proclaimed him *amīr al-mu'minīn* ("commander of the faithful"), pledged their loyalty, and prepared for war. In 1804 he called on his followers and all lovers of true Islam to rise up and overthrow the unjust rulers. He appealed to the masses of slaves and to the pastoral Fulani as oppressed people to join the revolt.

The high degree of communication that existed at this time among the different peoples in the area that would become Nigeria was evidenced when the call to jihad ("struggle" or "battle")—made in Gudu, in the northwest—had repercussions throughout the entire area comprising the present-day country. As a result of the considerable interaction along trade routes and rivers draining the northern plains to the Niger-Benue valley, through the delta, and across the coastal lagoons, the call to jihad was answered not only

in the Hausa states, such as Kano, Katsina, and Zaria, but also in Borno, Bauchi, Gombe, and Adamawa and eventually in Nupe, Ilorin, and other places where there were pockets of Fulani scholars.

Thus, was created a caliphate, with its seat at the newly established town of Sokoto. Each emirate enjoyed autonomy but pledged loyalty to the *amīr al-mu'minīn* and made contributions for the upkeep of Sokoto. Disputes within or between emirates were referred to Sokoto for settlement by officials who travelled as often as possible to oversee developments. Usman himself retired in 1811 to concentrate on the intellectual direction of the movement, which followed the teachings of the Qadiri brotherhood and strict adherence to the Maliki code of laws. His brother Abdullahi and his son Muhammad Bello carried on the jihad and laid the basis of administration. When Usman died in 1817, Muhammad Bello succeeded him as *amīr al-mu'minīn*, while Abdullahi, as emir of Gwandu, was given charge of the western emirates, notably Nupe and Ilorin. In this way, all the Hausa states, parts of Borno, Nupe, Ilorin, and Fulani outposts in Bauchi and Adamawa were drawn into a single politico-religious system. The rulers of Borno invited Shehu (Sheikh) Muḥammad al-Amīn al-Kānemī, a distinguished scholar and statesman who disagreed with the Fulani view that jihad was an acceptable tool against backsliding Muslims, to lead their defence of Borno against the Fulani jihad. In the process Islam was revived in Borno, and the old Seyfawa dynasty was eventually replaced by that of Shehu Muḥammad al-Kānemī.

The Collapse of Oyo

Although the Fulani intrusion into Ilorin largely contributed to the collapse of the Oyo empire, it was not the only cause. Deep-seated conflicts arose between

the Alaafin, or ruler, and his chiefs, including both provincial rulers and lineage chiefs and councillors at the capital. In spite of the external threat from the Fulani and others, the conflicts could not be resolved. Fulani ascendancy at Ilorin cut off the supply of horses to Oyo and made the defence of the capital untenable. Large groups of people from Oyo had to migrate southward, where they established a new capital (at present-day Oyo) and other centres such as Ibadan and Ijaye. This pressure, in turn, pushed the Egba farther south, where they founded the town of Abeokuta about 1830. The collapse of the Oyo empire unleashed a major redistribution of the Yoruba people and precipitated a series of Yoruba wars that lasted until 1886.

1.2: Nigeria's Cultural Heritage

Nigeria's rich and varied cultural heritage derives from the mixture of its ethnic groups with Arabic and western European influences. The country combines traditional culture with international urban sophistication. Secret societies, such as Ekpo and Ekpe among the Igbo, were formerly used as instruments of government, while other institutions were associated with matrimony. According to the Fulani custom of *sharo* (test of young manhood), rival suitors underwent the ordeal of caning as a means of eliminating those who were less persistent. In Ibibio territory, girls approaching marriageable age were confined for several years in bride-fattening rooms before they were given to their husbands. A girl was well-fed during this confinement, with the intent of making her plump and therefore more attractive to her future husband; she would also receive instruction from older women on how to be a good wife. These and other customs were discouraged by colonial administrators and missionaries. Some of the more

adaptable cultural institutions have been revived since independence; these include Ekpo and Ekong societies for young boys in parts of the southeast and the Ogboni society found in the Yoruba and Edo areas of southern Nigeria.

1.3: Background to Nigeria's Cultural Diversity

The Nigerian state is a colonial creation. It is a product of a historical accident that arose out of European adventurism with its eventual culmination in the colonisation of Africa. Thus, while the European explorers discovered the undeveloped estate that later became Nigeria, the missionaries established the presence of Europe in the area to pave the way for the eventual arrival of the European traders with their aggressive trade interest. First, the European explorers, second, the European Christian Missionaries and, third, the European traders played very important roles in the chronological sequence of events that led to the colonisation and creation of the Nigerian state. It was the aggressive economic interest and the contestation for the avaricious acquisition of the natural wealth of the native peoples that encouraged the convocation of the inglorious Berlin Conference of 1884-85. Arising from the Berlin Conference, the European interlopers adopted more carefully articulated control mechanisms to bring their effectively occupied territories under their control. It was at the Conference that the British got the imprimatur from the circle of European collaborators to occupy the area that later became known as Nigeria.

What the above development entailed was that the vast area that would soon become Nigeria had become the property of the British colonial powers and thus had to be brought under their effective control. To achieve this, the British colonial administrators quickly established a colony and protectorate of Lagos

and Niger territories under the administration of the Royal Niger Company through the instrumentality of a Charter. The exigencies of the moment ultimately challenged the British colonial administrators to come up with more viable ways of optimising their control over the Nigerian territories at the barest minimum cost. The Niger Committee of 1898, headed by Lord Selbourne was, therefore, inaugurated by the British colonial administrators to, among other things, find the means for achieving greater control over the expansive area at the barest minimum cost. As a way out of the financial deficit in the administration of the expansive areas – the Northern and Southern Protectorates, the Selbourne Committee recommended the use of available funds from the richer Southern Protectorate to soften the large-scale financial short-falls of the Northern Protectorate. Very significantly, the Selbourne Committee recommended an installmental amalgamation process which eventually took place in three phases. The first phase of the amalgamation took place in 1900, the second phase was in 1906 and the last and final phase took place on January 1, 1914. It was the last phase that brought about major challenges in defining the political future of Nigeria in the light of cultural diversity and ethnic pluralism.

From the above background, it is indisputable that Nigeria is an agglomeration of various ethnic groupings. These ethnic groupings significantly differ in their historical, social and cultural make-ups. This reality points to a complex problem of tangible socio-political proportions that constantly manifests in socio-cultural conflicts, ethno-religious intolerance, imagined or real political marginalisation and many others within the Nigerian milieu. Most of these problems arise and persist mainly because of our improper appreciation of the cultural values,

religious beliefs, and political inclinations of others. Yet, we all belong to the same political entity that is administered from one centre; we have a common currency; one federal constitution; one national anthem; one national team; one national assembly and several other institutions.

For us to be able to achieve our desire for unity in diversity, we need to first and foremost, appreciate our history as a people and then we also have to appreciate and tolerate our divergent cultures. This is the inescapable reality that highlights the need for the study of Nigerian peoples and culture.

1.4: Culture: Some Conceptual Perspectives

In our attempt to give a conceptual impetus to the appreciation of the term *culture*, it is proper to submit that there is a seemingly irrefutable consensus among scholars of different intellectual orientations on what the term connotes. This is because culture is commonly interpreted to mean the way of life of a people, and this could be material or non-material. To that extent, it becomes plausible to argue that a people's overall life patterns are conditioned by the adherence to a specific order, which forms an implicit code of conduct. Eating habits, choice of foods, relationship with others, behavioural and attitudinal patterns, among other things, can be said to be components of culture. Clearly, therefore, culture relates to the way and manner with which a given people do the things that are peculiar to them. This goes to explain why culture may be correctly defined as the totality of a people's way of life that manifests through the channels of their belief system, justice system, behavioural patterns, feelings, emotions, morality, possessions and institutions. This validates the claim that culture is a social inheritance that gives structure to people's lives.

It has been correctly argued that human beings are systematically conditioned to conform to culturally defined and constructed patterns of behaviour, thought and belief. The process of learning to fit in or adapt to a culture is referred to as cultural socialisation, which implies that a culture can be learned or adapted to. Perhaps, this explains why E. Nwabueze argues that culture takes the normative, learned, and transmitted dimensions. Whereas the normative aspect of culture entails the goals to be pursued, how to pursue them, the values to be espoused and what constitutes morality, the learned culture involves acquired values, belief systems and rules of conduct.

The transmitted dimension of culture is symbolic. Some scholars view culture as the totality of group expression, a historical process and a dynamic entity. As a platform of cultural expression, cultural identity manifests through certain styles of clothing, totems, tattoos and other aesthetic markers. Other channels of group cultural expression are language, graphic arts, sculpture, drama, dance, music, rituals, etc. The strength of cultural identity resides in group cultural expression. But fundamentally it transcends individual human life.

As a historical process, culture is viewed as a factor of development and the establishment of institutions on the basis of specific historical events. This relates to the interdependence of cultural and institutional factors in social transformation, political development, and economic growth. To that extent, this historical process views culture as a functionally related system that is codified within a cybernetic model of featuring some basic functional imperatives.

As a dynamic process, culture changes intermittently in line with the changing social, political and economic realities of a people. Cultural dynamics constitute

the inevitable aspect of human existence and can take the forms of cultural socialisation, cultural adaptation, cross-cultural encounters, or cultural imperialism. While cultural socialisation, cultural adaptation and cross-cultural encounters may take a consciously voluntary process, cultural imperialism essentially comes in the form of the super-imposition of a 'superior' culture over an 'inferior' culture. In the Nigerian experience, the forms of cultural synchronisation in the global system with its concomitant Euro-Americanization of the country's indigenous cultures profoundly illustrate forced cultural dynamism.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the early Nigerian cultures have left a lasting impact on the country's history and cultural heritage. The Nok culture, known for its fine terra-cotta figurines, represents one of the earliest organised societies in Nigeria. The Igbo Ukwu bronzes and the artistic traditions of Ife and Benin showcase the high artistic tradition and well-structured societies of ancient Nigeria. The Hausa states, Yoruba states, and the kingdom of Kanem-Borno each contributed to the political and cultural landscape of precolonial Nigeria. The Igbo and the delta city-states developed decentralised societies, while the Sokoto Jihad led to the establishment of a caliphate in the north. The collapse of the Oyo empire and the resulting Yoruba wars brought significant changes to the region. Nigeria's cultural heritage is a testament to the diverse and vibrant history of its people, shaping the country's identity to this day.

Summary

The following are what you have learned:

1. Early Nigerian cultures: Nigeria has a long history of human occupation, with evidence dating back thousands of years. The Nok culture, known for its fine terra-cotta figurines, marks the oldest recognizable evidence of an organised society in Nigeria.
2. Igbo Ukwu: Igbo Ukwu, near Onitsha, was a major power in the 9th century, known for its artistic tradition and well-structured society. The discovery of

bronzes and coloured glass beads suggests wide-ranging economic relationships with other regions.

3. Kingdoms and Empires of Precolonial Nigeria: Various indigenous politics emerged in Nigeria before British colonisation. Notable states include the Hausa states, Kanem-Borno, Yoruba states (Ife and Oyo), Benin, and the Delta city-states. These states had developed systems of government and engaged in trade and economic activities.

4. Yorubaland and Benin: Ife emerged as a major power in the forested areas west of the Niger River, known for its artistry and influence on surrounding states. Oyo eventually supplanted Ife and became a dominant empire engaged in trade. Benin, a longstanding monarchy, expanded its influence over neighbouring regions and produced distinctive bronze sculptures.

5. Igboland and the Delta City-States: The Igbo had a decentralised society, organised in self-contained villages or federations. Coastal city-states, such as Benin and Warri, played a significant role in the transatlantic slave trade, while the Igbo supplied slaves to the coast.

Self-Assessment Questions (SAQ)

SAQ1.1. What are some of the early Nigerian cultures that have played a significant role in shaping the region's history? (Tests Learning outcome 1.1)

SAQ1.2. How did the Nok civilization contribute to the cultural development of Nigeria? (Tests Learning outcome 1.1)

SAQ1.3. What were some of the powerful kingdoms and empires that emerged in Nigeria, and what impact did they have on the region? (Tests Learning outcome 1.4)

SAQ1.4. How did trade and commerce flourish in Nigeria during its historical periods? (Tests Learning outcome 1.5)

SAQ1.5. What were some of the notable achievements in art and architecture in Nigeria's past? (Tests Learning outcome 1.6)

Self-Assessment Answers (SAA)

SAA1.1. Some of the early Nigerian cultures that have played a significant role in shaping the region's history include the Nok civilization, the Igbo-Ukwu civilization, the Benin Kingdom, the Hausa city-states, and the Yoruba kingdoms. These cultures developed unique artistic styles, sophisticated political systems, and vibrant trade networks, laying the foundation for Nigeria's rich cultural diversity.

SAA1.2. The Nok civilization, which existed from around 1000 BCE to 300 CE, made significant contributions to the cultural development of Nigeria. They are renowned for their remarkable terracotta sculptures, which depict human figures, animals, and various cultural artefacts. The Nok people also had advanced iron smelting techniques, which played a crucial role in the region's technological advancement.

SAA1.3. Several powerful kingdoms and empires emerged in Nigeria, such as the Kanem-Bornu Empire, the Oyo Empire, and the Sokoto Caliphate. These kingdoms had significant impacts on the region. The Kanem-Bornu Empire, known for its strong military and efficient bureaucracy, facilitated trans-Saharan trade and influenced the spread of Islam. The Oyo Empire, with its centralised political structure and skilled military, controlled vast territories and established a network of tribute states. The Sokoto Caliphate, founded during the Sokoto Jihad led by

Usman dan Fodio, not only brought about religious reforms but also shaped the political and social landscape of Nigeria.

SAA1.4. Trade and commerce flourished in Nigeria during its historical periods through various means. The trans-Saharan trade routes enabled the exchange of goods, such as gold, salt, ivory, and slaves, between North Africa and West Africa. Coastal trade with European powers, particularly during the era of the Atlantic slave trade, further stimulated economic activities. Additionally, the riverine networks of the Niger and Benue rivers facilitated internal trade and the growth of urban centres.

SAA1.5. Nigeria has a rich history of notable achievements in art and architecture. The Benin Kingdom, for instance, produced intricate bronze and ivory sculptures that depicted royal figures and cultural motifs. The Nri Kingdom is renowned for its sacred art, including elaborate terracotta sculptures and stone artefacts. In terms of architecture, structures like the ancient city walls of Kano and the palace complex of the Oba of Benin showcase the architectural prowess and cultural heritage of Nigeria's past civilizations.

Tutor Marked Assignment

1. How did governance and political structures evolve in Nigeria over time?
2. What were the causes and consequences of the Sokoto Jihad in Nigerian history?
3. How did the collapse of the Oyo empire affect the political landscape of Nigeria?
4. What were the major religious practices and beliefs in Nigeria's history?

Study Session 2: A Nigerians Perception of His Nation

Introduction

The diverse cultures of Nigeria can be classified into three distinct regions: the Niger Delta Region, the Rain Forest Region, and the Guinea Savannah Region. This introduction will focus on providing an overview of the Niger Delta Region, its people, socio-political organisation, religious beliefs, and artistic expressions. The Niger Delta Region is home to various ethnic groups such as the Ijaw, Ndoki, Odual, Isoko, Urhobo, Abual, and Itsekiri. Geographically, it encompasses the area from the immediate South of Edo and Igbo lands to the Atlantic Ocean, stretching from the South-East of Yorubaland to parts of the Efik and Ibibio territories. While the Niger Delta people are often described as minorities, they possess a rich cultural heritage and have distinct occupations. Fishing is a major livelihood for those residing in the mangrove and freshwater areas, while those in the hinterland combine fishing with root crop cultivation. The Urhobo people have a history of being great traders, and certain communities, such as Itsekiri, Bonny, and Opobo, have established themselves as intermediaries in the oil trade. The socio-political organisation of the Niger Delta people is centred around village groups or clans, with the exception of the Itsekiri, who form a distinct kingdom. Despite their cultural diversity, the Niger Delta people share a belief in a Supreme God, though they also venerate various deities associated with water. The region's artistic expressions primarily revolve around skills such as canoe making, salt production, ceramics, and oil palm production. Music and dance are also significant contributions of the Niger Delta to the Nigerian heritage, with notable musicians drawing inspiration from their native traditions.

Learning Outcomes for Study Session 2

At the end of this session, students will be able to:

- 2.1. Understand the cultural diversity and geographical distribution of the ethnic groups in the Niger Delta Region, Rain Forest Region, and Guinea Savannah Region of Nigeria.
- 2.2. Identify the socio-political organisation and governance structures prevalent among the Niger Delta people, RainForest people, and Guinea Savannah people.
- 2.3. Analyse the religious beliefs and practices of the Niger Delta people, RainForest people, and Guinea Savannah people, including their belief in a Supreme God and the worship of various deities.

2.1: The Culture of the People of the Niger Delta Region of Nigeria

The Ijaw, the Ndoki, the Odual, the Isoko, the Urhobo, the Abual and the Itsekiri are generally called the Niger Delta people. Geographically speaking, the Niger Delta Region is that area of Nigeria which begins from the immediate South of Edo and Igbo lands to the Atlantic Ocean, ranging from the South-East of Yorubaland to certain parts of the Efik and the Ibibio areas. The different ethnic groups that constitute the Niger Delta Region are generally described as minorities. Although most of these ethnic groups belong to the Kwa language family, only the Urhobo and the Isoko people speak the same language. Fishing is the major occupation for those that live entirely within the mangrove and freshwater areas. Those located in the immediate hinterland combine fishing with the cultivation of root crops. The recent stage of their cultural history shows the Urhobo as great traders while the communities of Itsekiri, Bonny and Opobo have established themselves as the middlemen of the oil trade.

2.1.1: The Socio-Political Organization of the Niger Delta People

The socio-political organisation of the Niger Delta people is strongly established on the basis of village groups or clans. Itsekiri constitute the only exception. Many ethnic groups of the Niger Delta Region rely on their dialects and are eager to develop them. This is especially the case in the Urhobo area.

History tells us that the Ijaw have over forty village groupings, the Urhobo, twenty-two: Isoko, sixteen, etc. You should remember that each of these groupings has its political institutions and autonomy. In the past, these groupings could enter into war against one another. It is recorded that in the past, some of these groupings rose to the status of kingdoms, a number of which have fairly

long histories. History also tells us that unlike the Edo, the Yoruba and the Igbo, the people of the Niger Delta Region have never been builders of empires and they have never nurtured any great ambition to dominate others. Indeed, the most common political trait of the Niger Delta people is the democratic republican spirit, and the basic political unit is the village. The clan or village group is a confederation, and the whole of the ethnic group is something merely of a cultural community. It is recorded that in the Niger Delta Region, the Itsekiri represents the only kingdom that does not have to grapple with the political problems arising from internal fragmentation, multiple dialects and so forth.

2.1.2: The Religious Beliefs of the Niger Delta People

Despite the varieties of different ethnic groups in the Niger Delta Region, it is striking to note that they all believe in the existence of a Supreme God. For instance, in Isoko and Urhobo, the Supreme God is called Oghene while the Ijaw call him Tamara or Egbesu. The Supreme God is called Oritsenebuwe or Oriste in Itsekiri.

However, the Niger Delta people have and believe in many deities. The prominent ones are gods and goddesses of the waters. Olokun also called Umalokun or “mami water” is the most generally known goddess in the Niger Delta region. “Mami water” is well known as the bride of the seas. Any genuine Niger Delta person considers waters, that is, the rivers, the creeks, the lakes and especially the Atlantic Ocean itself, as cities populated by not only fishes but also whole communities of deities and water spirits. You should also know that witchcraft belief is very pronounced in the Niger Delta region. Consequently, ritual ways of dealing with ritual-related issues abound. It is also recorded that it is the belief in

witchcraft and the question of how to solve it that speeded the establishment and the rise of “Igbo” religious groups especially in Urhobo and Isoko areas. You should also remember that in the Niger Delta region, the Ijaw are best known as professional masseurs and physiotherapists, but they know next to nothing about magic, divination, and herbalism.

2.1.3: The Arts of the Niger Delta People

Unlike the Yoruba, the Igbo and especially the Bini, the Niger Delta people are not famous for great works of art. Perhaps their ecological limitations did not encourage such artistic orientation. Nevertheless, this does not mean that Niger Delta people do not know anything about arts and crafts. Of course, the ecological situation of the region does not favour certain crafts and skills such as iron smelting, bronze works, the manufacture of glass beads, the terra cotta tradition, and the textile industry, etc. However, the Niger Delta people are rather professional in the domains of canoe making, salt production, ceramics, etc. Besides, the Ijaw, Itsekiri, the Urhobo and the Isoko have proved their best skills in oil palm production technology. History also tells us that cloth weaving in the Aboh area diffused to parts of Isoko and Urhobo areas.

Also, music and dance constitute an immense contribution of the Niger Delta region to the overall heritage of the Nigeria nation. It is recorded that most of these dances and music have formed the cultural background of some of the young dancers and musicians of today. It is well-known that the late Rex Lawson had derived much of his inspiration from his native Kalabari Ijaw music. This is also true of Okupa in Isoko Land, Sally Young and Mike Okri in the Ukhukori and Ughelli areas of Urhoboland.

2.2 :The Culture of the People of the Rain Forest Region of Nigeria

First of all, the cultures of the Rain Forest Region of Nigeria can be easily categorised into four main groups, namely, the Yoruba, the Western Igbo, the Eastern Igbo and the Edoid. The Yoruba group is located in the Western part of the region stretching across the border of Benin Republic with incursion into Togo as well. The Eastern and Western Igbo subcultures occupy a vast area along the River Niger. The Edoid culture group which includes Bini, Esan, Etsako, Igarra, Owan, etc., is located in between the Yoruba and the Igbo. The eastern part of Igboland to the Cameroonian border is occupied by the Yakur, Ekoi, Ibibio, Anang, Bokyi, Ejaghan, Bekwarra and others.

2.2.1: The Socio-Political Organization of the Rain Forest People

You should always remember that there is no common pattern of sociopolitical organisation among the people living in the rain forest region. Nevertheless, some cultures are similar to others. Based on similarities and dissimilarities of culture among the rain forest people, we can retain at least two broad tendencies as far as their socio-political organisation is concerned. The first tendency is what we may call Village democracies and the second is the monarchical states. The Igbo people, some communities of the east, and the Northern communities of the Edoid, fall under the first tendency, while the Yoruba and the Bini belong to the second category.

2.2.2: Village Democracy

The Igbo people are well known for it. In every Igboland, the village constitutes the basic unit of political organisation. Villages are made up of lineages which are regarded as something similar to component states. Every lineage is headed by an Okpara, the oldest male member. He is the link between his people and the ancestors. He also controls the Ofo that symbolises justice and authority. Anybody that can make meaningful contributions during general meetings is welcome irrespective of sex and age. When there are serious disputes or matters requiring crucial and careful decisions, the Okpara calls a general meeting of the adult members of the lineage. It is the same process at the village level. In Igboland, a number of villages that claim a common primordial ancestry constitute a village group or town.

2.2.3: Monarchical States

Monarchy is the second major tendency of the Rain Forest people. It is best represented by the Yoruba. Contrary to the Igbo, the town is rather the basic political unit in the Yoruba culture area. The town is made up of lineages, organised in order of seniority determined by the order of settlement. The leadership in every lineage in Yorubaland is hereditary. The leader of the founder lineage assumes the headship of the town. The Baale is the head of the town. He is also called Oba when crowned king. His duty is to conduct the administration of the town in consultation with the various lineage chiefs. At the local level, the town is divided into wards. The ward chief is called Ijoye, Adugbo or Olorin itun. Wards are also made up of compounds which are headed by the eldest man called Baale.

In the traditional Yoruba politics, there was a distinction between judicial and legislative powers. There was rather a kind of hierarchy of powers. For instance, we have three judicial levels represented by the court of the Oba, the Ijoye and the Baale. The Oba's court is the court of last appeal.

2.2.4: The Arts of the Rain Forest People

The Rain Forest people are best known for their highly sophisticated artistic traditions and skills. They are unbeatable in the science of metallurgy, especially iron smelting and black smithing. Communities such as Ife, Nkwere, Awka, Abiriba and Oyo have iron smelting as their major business. In the Rain Forest of Nigeria, terracotta figurines of very high artistic qualities have been found in several parts in the Igbo, the Ibibio, the Edo and the Yoruba lands. Ibibioland and her neighbours constitute the reservoir of great masks most of which are objects of deep religious meaning and symbolism. There is also an appreciable level of textile work in the whole of the rain forest region, particularly in Yoruba and Esan lands.

2.2.5: The Religious Beliefs of the RainForest People

Just like the Niger Deltans, the Rain Forest people are religious as well. They also share a general belief in the existence of a Supreme God. Although God is supremely the same, he is differently called according to the various cultures. For instance, in Yorubaland, God is called Olodumare or Olorun. Among the Benin he is called Osanobua. The Esan call him Osenebua and the Etsako call him Oghena. The Igbo call God Chukwu or sometimes Obasi while He is Abasi among the Ibibio, and so forth. Almost all the various cultures of the Rain Forest region of Nigeria consider the Supreme God as the Creator of the whole universe.

To them, God has unlimited powers and He is also benevolent and punitive. His residence is somewhere in space in the direction of the sky. This is one of the reasons why He hardly gets involved directly in the affairs of men. The people of the Rain Forest are more concerned with their deities who are closer to them than God Himself. The most powerful of these lesser deities are Orisa in Yorubaland, Alusi in Igbo and Ebo in Edoland. The attachment to deities is so powerful that in the Ife area, for instance, as many as 2001 deities are said to exist and only 25 days in the calendar year are free from official religious activities devoted to them. There are lesser deities in Yorubaland in than Igboland but all of them are powerful. Sango, Ogun, Sopono, Olokun, Obatala, Obalefun, Orunmila, Orisanla, Yemoo and Oluorogbo are some few powerful deities in Yorubaland, while Amadaiaha or Amadiora, Idemili, Igwe, Ana or Ani are some powerful Igbo deities.

It is important to note that the general philosophy behind the religious spirit of the Rain Forest people is the search for good health, long life, blessing in terms of children and wealth, and general protection against misfortune and evil influences. Of course, they want all these in exchange for constant worship and purity of heart. In their own understanding, failure to worship or make sacrifices to these supernatural forces may make them withdraw their protection and blessing. Unlike in the Niger Delta region, witchcraft belief, especially in most of Igboland, is not of paramount importance.

2.3: The Culture of the People of the Guinea Savannah Region of Nigeria

To begin with, the Guinea Savannah Region is known as the home of an overwhelming majority of Nigeria's cultural or ethnic groups. The four major states of Adamawa, Nasarawa, Plateau and Taraba, which constitute over fifty per cent of the cultures of Nigeria, fall under this region. The Middle Belt (sometimes called Kasashen Bauchi) is also part of this region. It covers the Idoma, the Ebiraland, the Igala and the whole of Zaria communities to the South. It shares the border with Cameroon in the East and with the Republic of Benin in the West. There is even a general tendency to believe that about seventy per cent of the peoples and cultures of Nigeria are found in the Guinea Savannah region. Apart from some large groups such as the Tiv, the Gwari and the Nupe, groups within the Savannah region are generally known for their small size. It is difficult to find groups with more than a thousand souls. Such groups are the Mumuye, the Jukun, the Anok, the Kakanda, the Birom, the Higgi, the Jirai, the Ichen, the Kaka, the Chokobo, the Fyer, the Bassa, the Tikar, the Vergo, the Afizere, the Kambari, the Koro, the Anaguta, the Gade, the Shamo, the Anagas, the Vomni, the Lakk, the Jero, the Tangale, the Zaranda, the Limoro, the Rubu, the Amo, the Kurama, the Holma, the Mbula, the Lau, the Chamo, etc. You should remember that most of these groups claim the origin of Hausa or Jukun ancestors.

2.3.1: The Socio-Political Organization of the Guinea Savannah

The socio-political organisation of the Guinea Savannah people is very different from that of the Rain Forest people known for their large monarchies and great empires. History shows that before the rise of emirates along with their jihads in the early nineteenth century and the advent of warrant chiefs, as part of the colonial political arrangements, the Guinea Savannah people were never used to the culture of centralised government. Only a few ethnic groups such as the Igala, the Nupe and the Jukun had developed elaborate monarchical structures dating back to antiquity. But these few cases cannot be compared with the majority of the groups within the region that do not have monarchical structures.

The Guinea Savannah people have always been known for their petty chiefdoms or village or lineage-based democracy. Some prominent groups such as the Ebira, Idoma, Tiv, and Birom have ultimately formalised the institution of the so-called “Royal Highnesses” with jurisdiction covering the whole ethnic group. However, some ethnic groups in the Guinea Savannah region have been paying allegiance to the Sultan who has spiritual and political control of the greater part of the region.

2.3.2: The Economy of the Guinea Savannah Region of Nigeria

Farming is the major economic preoccupation of the people of the Guinea Savannah region. Yam is the most cultivated. The Nupe, the Koto and the Tiv constitute what is called the “West African yam belt”. Among the other ethnic groups of the region, the primary crop is guinea corn and millet. They also cultivate cassava but not in abundance. Yam cultivation is largely men’s business. In the Guinea Savannah region there is land for everybody and fertility of the land

there is exceptional. Even the hilly terrains of the Adamawa, Jos and Bauchi plateaux still produce enough food.

In the Guinea Savannah region land belongs to the community or lineage and not to individuals. Coincidentally, Nigeria's two major rivers, the Niger and the Benue, together with their several tributaries, flow through this region and provide ample opportunity for professional fishing. It is recorded that apart from Jos where the bulk of the tin being produced is in the hands of women, generally women of the Guinea Savannah region are not used to commerce.

2.3.3: The Religious Beliefs of the Guinea Savannah People

The structure of the religious beliefs in the Guinea Savannah region is different from that of the Delta and the Rain Forest. For instance, the Yoruba of Ife have developed a kind of extensive pantheon which we cannot find in the Guinea Savannah region. Nevertheless, as it is the case in the Niger Delta, the Rain Forest, there is a general belief in the existence of the Supreme God in the Guinea Savannah region as well. But you should remember that although the belief in a Supreme God is general in that region, He is differently called according to the ethnic groups. Among the Kurama, for instance, God is called Ashili or Bakashili. Among the Tiv, he is known as Aondo while the Rukuba call him Katakuru. Among the Gwari He is called Shekoki, Shesha, Esse, Sheko or Soko. The Nupe call him Soko. He is known as Agwatana among the Busa. He is called Owo or Owoico among the Idoma. The Kadara call him Onum. He is known as Shido or Chido among the Jukun, and Hinegba or Ihinegba among the Ebira, etc. The people of the Guinea Savannah region also believe in other forces such as astral spirits. The Igala, the Jukun and the Tiv are well known for their strong belief in witchcraft,

magic, and sorcery. It is recorded that the political significance of the groups aforementioned derives from their powerful attachment to ritual and magic. The political system of this group, especially the Jukun, is sometimes described as theocratic. You should also remember that in the Tiv ethnic group only men are believed to be witches, while the witches of the Nupe and Gwari are almost invariably women.

It is also very important to note that the Guinea Savannah region is the most representative of religious balance in Nigeria. It is in this region more than anywhere, that we find an excellent rapprochement and cohabitation between Islam and Christianity. It is even recorded that in the Guinea Savannah region members of the same household can belong to either faith and still remain brothers. Therefore, this region represents the best hope for religious tolerance in Nigeria.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the diverse ethnic groups residing in the Niger Delta Region, Rain Forest Region, and Guinea Savannah Region of Nigeria possess unique cultural characteristics, socio-political organisations, religious beliefs, and artistic traditions. Through this exploration, we have gained a deeper understanding of their cultural diversity, geographical distribution, and historical development. The significance of village democracy, monarchical states, and lineage-based democracy in these regions highlights the complexity of their socio-political systems. Furthermore, the religious philosophies, artistic skills, and ecological influences have shaped the identities and lifestyles of these communities. As we appreciate their cultural contributions to Nigeria's heritage, including their music, dance, and artistic expressions, we acknowledge the rich tapestry of traditions that exist within the country. This knowledge empowers us to foster greater appreciation, respect, and inclusivity for the diverse ethnic groups that contribute to the vibrant cultural mosaic of Nigeria.

Summary

The following are what you have learned:

1. The Niger Delta Region, Rain Forest Region, and Guinea Savannah Region of Nigeria exhibit diverse cultural characteristics, socio-political organisations, religious beliefs, and artistic traditions.
2. The ethnic groups in these regions have distinct cultural identities and historical developments.

3. Village democracy, monarchical states, and lineage-based democracy are significant elements of socio-political systems in these regions.
4. The religious philosophies, artistic skills, and ecological influences have shaped the identities and lifestyles of these communities.
5. The cultural contributions of these ethnic groups, such as music, dance, and artistic expressions, are an integral part of Nigeria's heritage.
6. Understanding and appreciating the cultural diversity within Nigeria fosters greater respect, inclusivity, and appreciation for the vibrant cultural mosaic of the country.

Self-Assessment Questions (SAQ)

- SAQ2.1.** What are the main cultural characteristics exhibited in the Niger Delta Region, Rain Forest Region, and Guinea Savannah Region of Nigeria? (Tests learning outcome 2.1)
- SAQ2.2.** How do the ethnic groups in these regions differ in terms of their cultural identities and historical developments? (Tests learning outcome 2.1)
- SAQ2.3.** What are the significant elements of socio-political systems found in these regions, such as village democracy, monarchical states, and lineage-based democracy? (Tests learning outcome 2.2)
- SAQ2.4.** How have religious philosophies, artistic skills, and ecological influences shaped the identities and lifestyles of the communities in these regions? (Tests learning outcome 2.3)

Self-Assessment Answers (SAA)

SAA2.1. The main cultural characteristics exhibited in the Niger Delta Region, Rain Forest Region, and Guinea Savannah Region of Nigeria vary but share some common elements. In the Niger Delta Region, cultural characteristics include a rich heritage of indigenous languages, vibrant traditional music and dance forms, intricate craftwork, and a deep connection to the rivers and waterways. In the Rain Forest Region, cultural characteristics include diverse ethnic groups with distinct languages, artistic traditions, and agricultural practices. The Guinea Savannah Region is known for its nomadic herding communities, unique architecture, and strong ties to the land.

SAA2.2. The ethnic groups in these regions differ in terms of their cultural identities and historical developments. In the Niger Delta Region, major ethnic groups such as the Ijaw, Urhobo, and Itsekiri have distinct cultural identities shaped by their historical interactions with trade, migration, and contact with European powers. In the Rain Forest Region, ethnic groups like the Yoruba, Igbo, and Edo have rich cultural traditions, including unique languages, religious practices, and artistic expressions. The Guinea Savannah Region is home to ethnic groups such as the Hausa, Fulani, and Kanuri, each with its own distinct cultural practices, including language, nomadic lifestyle, and historical ties to ancient kingdoms and empires.

SAA2.3. The socio-political systems found in these regions exhibit different significant elements. In the Niger Delta Region, some communities practise village democracy, where decision-making is done collectively through

assemblies or councils. In the Rain Forest Region, there is a mix of socio-political systems, including monarchical states where traditional rulers hold significant authority. In the Guinea Savannah Region, lineage-based democracy is prevalent, where social and political systems are structured around kinship ties and extended family units.

SAA2.4. Religious philosophies, artistic skills, and ecological influences have played crucial roles in shaping the identities and lifestyles of communities in these regions. Religion, such as Christianity, Islam, and traditional African religions, influences belief systems, rituals, and social norms. Artistic skills, such as intricate wood carving, pottery, weaving, and masquerade performances, are integral to cultural expression and often reflect religious or historical themes. Ecological influences, such as the Niger Delta's proximity to water and fertile land, have shaped livelihoods and economic activities, including fishing, farming, and trade, which contribute to cultural practices and social structures.

Tutor Marked Assignment

1. What are some cultural contributions of these ethnic groups, such as music, dance, and artistic expressions, that are considered integral to Nigeria's heritage?
2. How does understanding and appreciating the cultural diversity within Nigeria contribute to fostering respect, inclusivity, and appreciation for the country's vibrant cultural mosaic?

Study Session 3: Ethnic Groups in Northern Nigeria

Introduction

Nigeria has over 250 different ethnic groups, all with their own languages and heritage. The 3 major ethnic groups are Hausa, Yoruba and Igbo. However there are other notable ethnic groups scattered across the country's two major geographical divides in the North and South. The notable ethnic groups in the north include Hausa, Kanuri, Fulani, Tiv, Nupe, Igala, Idoma, Jukun, Igbira, and Berom. In this chapter we shall discuss the notable ethnic groups in the northern part of Nigeria. The core emphasis of this segment shall be to highlight the peoples traditions of origin, migration pattern, belief system, and their socio-political and economic activities.

Learning Outcomes for Study Session 3

When you have studied this session, you should be able to:

- 3.1. Understand the diversity of ethnic groups in northern Nigeria, including their languages, origins, and cultural practices.
- 3.2. Identify and differentiate between the major ethnic groups in northern Nigeria, such as the Hausa, Fulani, Kanuri, Nupe, Jukun, and Ebira.
- 3.3. Explain the historical and cultural significance of the Hausa, Fulani, Kanuri, Nupe, Jukun, and Ebira ethnic groups in northern Nigeria, including the impact of Islam on the Hausa and Kanuri ethnic groups and the influence of Arabic culture on the Hausa architectural style.

3.1: The Hausa People

Hausa is the largest ethnic group in northern Nigeria and by extension the whole country. The term Hausa also refers to a language spoken indigenously by Savannah peoples across the far North from Nigeria's Western boundary Eastward to Borno State and into much of the territory of central Nigeria. Hausa influence has spread to most parts of West Africa and beyond. Next to Swahili, the Hausa language is more widely spoken than any other single indigenous language throughout the continent of Africa.

There are conflicting legends about the origin of the Hausa States in Nigeria. However, the most popular account traced their origin to a certain Bayajida who emigrated from Baghdad to Kanem Bornu and married the daughter of the Kanuri ruler. Bayafida who was forced to flee Kanem Bornu due to squabbles relocated to Biramta-Gabas, where his wife bore him a son. He left his family for Daura where he killed a sacred snake "sarki" which had for years deprived the people of water from a well, except on Fridays. In appreciation of the great feat achieved by Bayajida, the Queen of Daura married him and later gave birth to a son called Bawo. It was Bawo's seven (7) children that became the founders of the original Hausa states known as Hausa Bokwai.

The original seven (7) states are Biram, Daura, Katsina, Zaria, Kano, Rano and Gobir. With the passage of time another seven (7) states emerged known as the Bansa Bokwai. These states are Kebbi, Zamfara, Nupe, Gwari, Yauri, Ilorin and Kwararafa. The various Hausa States emerged as city states and developed a well-structured centralised political system headed by the King, Sarki and other principal officials. An elaborate judicial department was also put in place, headed

by the Alkali and the qadi. The earliest form of worship in Hausa land was animism i.e., pagan idol worship. It was not until the 14th century that Fulani missionaries from Mali started serious work of conversion of people from paganism to Islam in Hausa land. However, the people continued to mix paganism with Islam until the advent of the Islamic Jihad of the early 19th century led by Usman Dan Fodio.

This development transformed Hausa land into a theocratic state governed by Islamic law. With this development the people's social life such as marriage and education became highly influenced by Islamic and Arabic culture. Hence in marriage, the women were put in purdah and were compelled to wear veils in public.

The Hausa architectural style and building design was heavily influenced by the Arabic world. The major occupation of the Hausa is farming. The people also engaged in handicraft such as weaving and dyeing of clothes.

3.1.1: The Fulani Ethnic Group

The Fulani originated in upper Senegal and were believed to have descended from the union between Tuculor women and Berber traders. By the 7th century A.D the Fulani had firmly established themselves in West Africa. The Fulani were among the first people to embrace Islam in West Africa. However, for centuries the Fulani were scattered throughout West Africa and belong to no identifiable kingdom. By the 14th century, Fulani scholars of Islam and pastoralists began to settle in Northern Nigeria. They helped in propagating Islam while discouraging the Hausa from idol worship. By the early 19th century the Fulani in Northern Nigeria led by Usman Dan Fodio, an Islamic scholar launched a Holy War, Jihad on Hausa states with the purpose of converting the people to Islam and putting an end to

paganism. Usman Dan Fodio's campaign received widespread support from his kinsmen and even Hausa who were fed up with the corrupt leadership style and high handedness of their leaders.

The Jihad dramatically altered the political equation of Hausa land as Fulanis who supported Usman Dan Fodio in his campaign took over the seat of powers across the land. Ever since, the entire Hausa land was brought under the rulership of the Fulani with Sokoto being the headquarter of the Islamic caliphate. There are two categories of Fulani, the Fulani Bororo whose main occupation is cattle rearing and the Fulani Gida i.e., town dwellers who engaged in urban crafts and trade. The Fulani's over the years have emerged as a critical element in the politics of Northern Nigeria and the country at large. The Fulani have blended so well with the Hausa that it is today difficult for an outsider to distinguish between these two sets of people.

3.1.2: The Kanuri Ethnic Group

They are also known and referred to as Beri Beri by their Hausa neighbours. The Kanuris are predominantly found in Borno and Yobe State. A substantial number of them are also found in Kano and Nasarawa State. They are predominantly farmers and fishermen and are known for their long facial marks. The Kanuri have their kiths and kins across the borders of Nigeria in Chad, Cameroon, and Niger. Most Kanuris are sunni muslims, while a few are animists. The Kanuris speak a variety of dialects such as Manga, Tumari and Bilma.

The Kisra legend or tradition of origin traced the founder of the earliest known Kanuri kingdom to a prince called Kisra who migrated with his followers to the east of Lake Chad from eastern Africa as a consequence of the destruction of the city

of Meroe (in the present day Sudan) by the people of Axum in about A.D. 350. By the 9th century, the Kanuri kingdom had fused with several petty states and developed into a great empire known as Kanem at the east of Lake Chad. However, by the 15th century, the seat of government was relocated to Bornu in the west of Lake Chad. Ali Ghaji and Idris Alooma were two great leaders who contributed so much to the fortune of the Kanem – Bornu empire. The Kanuri empire lasted for over a thousand years (A.D 774 – 1810), placing it as one of the longest lasting dynasties in world history. It was the sacking of Mai Ahmad, the last Kanuri ruler of the Sefawa dynasty in 1808 from the seat of power at Ngazargamu by Fulani Jihadists and the subsequent death of Mai Ahmad in 1810 that closed the chapter of the Sefawa dynasty. However, Muhammad Al-Kanemi, a devout Islamic scholar and warrior rally support for Bornu with his troops from Kanem by dislodging the Fulani jihadist. Al-Kanemi argued that it was wrong of Usman dan Fodio to launch Jihad against a fellow Islamic state which had all along been practising the purest form of the Islamic faith.

Following the death of Mai Ahmad in 1810, Al-Kanemi became the Sheik or Shehu of Bornu and ruled the territory until his own death in 1835. The new line of leadership he established replaced the Sefawa dynasty and persisted till date. Thus, the throne of the paramount ruler of Bornu, the Shehu stool is the exclusive preserve of the descendants of Muhammad Al-Kanemi. The people of Bornu had continued with the practice of Islam as the dominant faith within their domains. The Kanuri because of the environment of the Lake Chad basin were basically farmers, traders, salt producers and fishermen. The encroachment of the Sahara Desert and the shrinking of Lake Chad had negatively impacted on the economy

of Kanuri land coupled with the ongoing Boko Haram insurgency which had displaced most of the populace and stifled economic activities in the area.

3.2: Nupe

The Nupe speaks the language generally classified as the Nupoid group which is identified with the sub-family group of languages of the Benue-Congo. The Nupe ethnic stocks are found in three states of Nigeria, Niger, Kwara and Kogi. Bida, the seat of the Etsu Nupe the paramount ruler of Nupe people is regarded as the traditional headquarters of Nupeland.

The formation of Nupe Kingdom was largely attributed to Tsoede, also known as Edegi. Tsoede who was born in 1465 was the son of a Nupe mother and an Igala father who was raised at the Palace of Attah Igala in Idah. Having been equipped with charm and magical power by his father, he eventually returned to his mother's place to establish the Nupe Kingdom through force of arms and conquest of other neighbouring areas. Those he conquered include the Yoruba in the south and the Kamberi and Kamuku in the North. He ruled the entire Nupeland from his administrative headquarters of Nupeko until his death in 1591 during one of his military expansionist missions north of the Nupe Kingdom. Long before the 19th century, the Nupe people had historical links with the Hausas of Katsina, Kano and Borno people, who pioneered the establishment of some of their towns such as Abaji, Eggan, Kutigi and Enagi. In terms of culture, the Nupe borrowed substantially from their neighbours across the River Niger such as Yoruba, Igala, Gwari and Borgu. It is pertinent to state that the Nupe did not only borrow culture from her neighbours but also donated some aspect of her culture to them. For instance, while they borrowed the kinship system of Igala land, they in turn

introduced the Egugu masquerade in Yoruba land. It was also from Nupe land that Islam spread to the neighbouring Yoruba towns like Offa and Ibolu communities. By the early 19th century, the existing political structure in Nupeland was altered due to the outbreak of the Fulani Jihad.

The Nupe indigenous rulers were dislodged from their offices by Fulani Jihadists who took over their positions. Mallam Dendo, a Fulani Jihadist emerged on the seat of the paramount ruler of Nupe in Bida in 1804 and declared himself as the leader of the people. Mallam Dendo who derived his flag of authority from the Emir of Gwandu presided over the affairs of Nupe people under the supervision of Gwandu emirate.²⁴ By 1832, Dendo's son mounted the stool of his father and was installed as the first Etsu Nupe. Ever since, the Fulani's have continued to preside over the Nupe people.

The economy of Nupeland, though largely agrarian, is supplemented with fishing and cottage industries such as traditional soap making, blacksmithing, brass work, woodwork, and tailoring.

3.3: Jukun

The Jukun who speak six dialects, Wukari, Donga, Kona, Gwana, and Pindiga, Jibu and Wase Tofa are located in Taraba, Benue, Nassarawa, Plateau, Adamawa, and Gombe States, and some parts of northwestern Cameroon. The Jukun states presided over chunks of Gongola and Benue river basins over a long period of time stretching from the 14th to the 18th century A.D. One of their traditions of origin claims that they are of the same stock with the Kanuri of Borno. It is, thus, stated that they migrated with the Kanuri to Borno where they left them and then continued their movement southwards before settling along the Gongola and

Benue river basins.²⁷ Whereas between the 14th century and the 15th century, Jukun suffered so much in the hands of Kano and Zaria who occasionally raided her territories and exerted much tributes, as from the 16th century up to the 18th century Jukun became a formidable military force that posed serious threat to Borno, Kano, Zaria, the surrounding areas of Jos Plateau and to some parts of the Cross River basin.

As Jukun became very influential, many communities in the central parts of Nigeria area from the upper Benue to the middle Niger adopted the Jukun institutions in one way or the other. Thus, the Tiv, Idoma, Igala and Igbira derived so much from the Jukun traditional belief system, economic activities, and act of governance. By the turn of the 18th century, internal wrangling and intrigues coupled with constant raids from the Chambas had weakened the Jukun Kingdom and rendered her vulnerable to the Fulani Jihadists who greatly plundered her territories in the 19th century. However, the robust centralised political system of the Jukun, represented by the Aku of Wukari survived the Islamic Jihadist onslaught and is still thriving till date.

The Jukuns are divided into two major groups, the Jukun Wanu and Jukun Wapa. The Jukun Wanu are fishermen residing along the banks of the river Benue and Niger where they run through Taraba State, Benue State and Nasarawa State. The Jukun Wapa are the homeland Jukun that lives around Wukari. Even though the traditional stool of Aku of Wukari was able to survive after the Fulani conquest of Jukun, the initial cohesiveness of the people were disrupted as shown in the case of the Jukun in Adamawa State who were brought under the rulership of the Fulani emir of Muri.

Prior to the advent of colonialism, Jukuns were predominantly traditional worshipers. The coming of Christianity has significantly altered the people's belief system, as most Jukuns, including their paramount ruler, have embraced the Christian faith.

3.4: Ebira

The Ebira also known as Igbira are heavily concentrated in the central senatorial district of Kogi State, not far from the Niger-Benue Confluence. People of Ebira ethnic group are also found in other Nigerian states such as Kwara, Ondo, Oyo, Osun, Nassarawa, Edo, Benue, and the Federal Capital Territory. Ebira Tao is the largest of the several Ebira groups. The other sister groups are Ebira Koto and Ebira Ozum (Kogi State), Ebira Fulani (Kogi State), Ebira Etuno (Edo State), Ebira Agatu (Benue State) Ebira Oloko (Ondo, Oyo, and Osun States).

The earliest homeland of the Ebira according to oral traditions was around Wukari in the defunct Kwararafa empire. The Ebira alongside with the Igala and Idoma were believed to have migrated out of Wukari following a chieftaincy dispute in the area at about 1680 A.D. The Ebira in the course of their migration later split into various groups and settled in different locations as discussed earlier between 1680 and 1750 A.D. The Ebira are known for their cultural festivals such as "Echane" an annual masquerade festival dedicated to women, "Eche Ori", a new yam festival, and "Eknechi " a night masquerade festival which marks the end of the Ebira calendar year and the beginning of a new one.

The throne of the paramount ruler of Ebiraland known as the Ohonoyi of Ebira land is located in Okene, a hilly and rocky terrain which served as a fortress for the Ebira people against enemy incursion especially in the 19th century. The Ebira are

predominantly muslims and well versed in agriculture and crafts such as pottery, dyeing and blacksmithing.

3.5: Igala

People of Igala ethnic group though largely domiciled in Kogi State are also found in Delta, Anambra and Edo States. Various traditions link the Igala with the Yoruba, Benin and Jukun. Similarities as well as differences in the institution of divine kingship, methods of succession, royal regalia; and languages among the Igala, Yoruba, Benin, and Jukun have led, amongst other things, to a controversy about the origin of Igala kingship and political institutions.

However, it is incontrovertible that the present dynasty ruling in Igala is of Jukun origin. C. A. Temple in his compilation on the ethnic groups of Northern Nigeria observed that the Igala descended from the Apa who had lived in the neighbourhood of Ibi for many years but had to flee from the Jukun in canoe down the Benue in about 1490 A.D under their Chief Idoko. It was Idoko son, Ayegba Om' Idoko who joined forces with the head of Akpoto Omeppa to defeat the Jukun near Idah after sacrificing her daughter Inikpi.³⁷ Ayegba Om' Idoko who emerged as the first Attah of Igala ruled the Igala Kingdom from Idah while his elder brother Atiyele migrated eastward to establish Ankpa Kingdom. However, Idah has since continued to serve as the traditional headquarters of Igalaland.

The traditional Igala society is largely agrarian, although fishing is also a mainstay of the people's economy especially the Igalas of the riverine Idah area. Igala practises a number of different religions, including African traditional religion, Christianity, and Islam. The people through their culture and language are closely related to the following ethnic groups, Idoma, Igbo, Itsekiri, Bini, Yoruba and Nupe.

3.6: Birom

The Birom are largely located in Plateau State but are also found in Bauchi and Kaduna States. They speak the Birom language which belongs to the large Niger-Congo family of languages. The Birom ethnic group which currently constitute the largest indigenous group on the Jos Plateau migrated into their present abode from Central Africa as Bantu migrants who took their journey from Ethiopia through Sudan to Chad, and then to Niger before settling down at Gobir close to Sokoto from where they moved before finally settling down at Riyom from where they eventually spread to Xwang, Forom Zawan, Kuru, Gyel, Haipan, Fan and Gashish. The Birom are predominantly farmers and hunters who celebrate their occupations through series of cultural festivals such as Mandyang (rain festival – usually marked between March – April), Nshor (hunting festival – usually marked between April – May) Nzem Berom (music, dance, arts cultural day mandatory marked every first week of April).

The Birom political system prior to the advent of colonialism functioned more as a chieftain under the Gwoms (village heads) and Da Gwoms (village heads) until the establishment of the stool of the paramount ruler for the entire Birom land known as Gbong Gwom Jos in 1935.

3.7: The Idoma

People of Idoma ethnic group are largely found in Benue State and other states such as Cross River, Nassarawa, Enugu and Kogi State. The Idoma legend of origins and ethnicity is about the most complex aspect of their pre-colonial history.

Different accounts abound on the peoples origin and migrations, however, it is evident that the evolution of an Idoma ethnicity began in the 16th century from Apa in Kwararafa empire to various places within the Lower Benue. This migration was in waves and phases. The first wave of Idoma migrations which involved the Ugboju, Adoka and Otukpo people occurred between 1535 – 1625. The second wave which involved the core of western Idoma districts such as Otukpa, Orokam, Owukpa, and Ichama took place between 1685 – 1751.⁴⁵ While the first wave was instigated by the Tiv migrants who dislodged the Idoma from their first settlement in Benue valley Apa I, the second wave of migrants to enter Idoma land came in through Igalaland following intense chieftaincy tussles in Idah.

By about the last quarter of the 19th century, the process of the consolidation of new territories in which the Idoma found themselves had been completed. This consolidation was however at the expense of other numerically smaller ethnic groups like the Igede, Akweya and Ufia on whose territories the Idoma settled while the Igede were pushed to the eastern fringes of the Idoma territories, the Ufia and Akweya were encircled by the Idoma and today constitute a bilingual micro-nationality in the heart of Idomaland. The people operated a decentralised and communal-based system of government throughout the precolonial period. However, the British colonial government which firmly announced its presence in

Idoma Land following the suppression of the Ogbuloko revolt in 1928, introduced a chieftaincy institution.

In Idomaland, first at the district level before the creation of the seat of the paramount ruler of Idomaland, Och'Idoma in 1946 at Otukpo. This political innovation was not established essentially to engender unity among the people but for administrative convenience, especially for the enhancement of the British indirect rule system.

The major occupation of Idoma people over the years is farming, supplemented with fishing and hunting. The people are also versed in handicraft such as blacksmithing, woodwork, basketing and cloth weaving. Since the advent of colonialism and the spread of Christian activities in the area, most of the people have embraced Christianity at the expense of African traditional religion.

3.8: The Tiv

The Tiv ethnic group, though predominantly domiciled in Benue state, are also found in Nasarawa, Taraba, Plateau, and the Federal Capital Territory. The Tiv which form part of the Bantu continuum lived within the Cameroon-Obudu complex between 1475 and 1505 before moving down the hills into the Benue Valley through four waves of migration that lasted between 1475 – 1900. The migration of the proto Tiv into the Lower Benue Valley was not spontaneous but occurred in phases and periods. The phases lasted as follows, the first phase 1475 – 1535, the second phase 1535 – 1595, the third phase 1595 – 1775 and the fourth phase 1775 – 1900.

The reason for migration from Swem around the Cameroon–Obudu Plateau has been attributed to diverse factors such as inter and intra ethnic hostilities, population explosion and the gradual decline of the Kwararafa military efficacy in the Lower Benue Valley. The migration of the Tiv into the Benue Valley was accompanied by a series of warfare against the Jukun, Chamba, Idoma, the Alago, the Hausawa/Katsinawa and the Kamberi.

The Tiv in their interaction with their neighbours had imbibed so much in terms of farming techniques and technology, cultural practice and political system. The Tiv who emerged from Swem as an egalitarian society by the 19th century instituted a political system, Tor Agbande (Drum chief) which they copied from the Jukun. The Tor Agbande held sway at the kindred level where they offered both political and military leadership to their people. With the advent of colonialism, the British in their attempt to implement the indirect rule system created the offices of district heads and subsequently that of the paramount ruler of Tivland, Tor Tiv by 1945. The seat of the Tor Tiv is in Gboko which in contemporary time is regarded as the traditional headquarter of Tivland.

The Tiv are predominantly farmers. A significant portion of the population are also engaged in trading and merchandise. The advent of Christianity in Tivland has significantly altered the people's belief system in favour of the Christian faith. Nongu u Kristu u i ser u sha Tar (Universal Reformed Christian Church) NKST one of the largest indigenous Christian Mission in Nigeria is a proof of the tremendous impact of Christianity in Tivland.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the northern region of Nigeria is home to a rich diversity of ethnic groups, each with their own distinct languages, traditions, and histories. The Hausa, Fulani, Kanuri, Nupe, Jukun, and Ebira are among the notable ethnic groups that have contributed to the cultural fabric of the region. From the ancient origins of the Hausa States and the spread of Islam through the Fulani Jihad, to the resilience of the Kanuri empire and the cultural exchanges between the Jukun and neighbouring communities, the northern part of Nigeria is a mosaic of traditions and influences. Understanding and appreciating the heritage and socio-political dynamics of these ethnic groups is essential for fostering unity and promoting intercultural dialogue in Nigeria. By recognizing and celebrating the contributions of each ethnic group, Nigeria can continue to build a diverse and inclusive society that embraces its rich cultural tapestry.

Summary

The following are what you have learned:

1. The northern region of Nigeria is characterised by a diverse range of ethnic groups.
2. Prominent ethnic groups in the region include the Hausa, Fulani, Kanuri, Nupe, Jukun, and Ebira.
3. Each ethnic group has its own unique languages, traditions, and histories.
4. The Hausa States have ancient origins and played a significant role in the region's history.

5. The spread of Islam was facilitated by the Fulani Jihad, which had a lasting impact on the region.
6. The Kanuri empire showcased resilience and contributed to the cultural heritage of northern Nigeria.
7. The Jukun people had cultural exchanges with neighbouring communities, enriching their traditions.
8. Understanding and appreciating the diversity and dynamics of these ethnic groups is crucial for fostering unity in Nigeria.
9. Celebrating the contributions of each ethnic group can help build a diverse and inclusive society in the country.

Self-Assessment Questions (SAQ)

- SAQ3.1.** What are some of the prominent ethnic groups in the northern region of Nigeria? (Tests learning outcome 3.1)
- SAQ3.2.** How have the Hausa States influenced the history of the region? (Tests learning outcome 3.2)
- SAQ3.3.** What was the significance of the Fulani Jihad in the spread of Islam in northern Nigeria? (Tests learning outcome 3.3)
- SAQ3.4.** What contributions did the Kanuri empire make to the cultural heritage of the region? (Tests learning outcome 3.3)

Self-Assessment Answers (SAA)

SAA3.1. Some of the prominent ethnic groups in the northern region of Nigeria include the Hausa, Fulani, Kanuri, Nupe, Tiv, and Jukun.

SAA3.2. The Hausa States have had a significant influence on the history of the northern region of Nigeria. These states, such as Kano, Katsina, Zazzau (Zaria), and Gobir, emerged as powerful political entities in the 11th century. They developed complex administrative systems, fostered trade networks, and promoted the spread of Islam. The Hausa culture and language became influential, serving as a unifying factor among diverse ethnic groups in the region.

SAA3.3. The Fulani Jihad, led by Usman dan Fodio in the early 19th century, had great significance in the spread of Islam in northern Nigeria. This religious and political movement sought to establish an Islamic state based on the principles of the Qur'an. The Fulani warriors, known as the Fulani Empire or Sokoto Caliphate, successfully waged wars against existing political entities and expanded their influence. The Fulani Jihad led to the consolidation of Islamic rule, the spread of Islamic education, and the promotion of Fulfulde (Fulani language) as a lingua franca in the region.

SAA3.4. The Kanuri empire, centred around the Bornu kingdom, made significant contributions to the cultural heritage of the northern region of Nigeria. The Kanuri people developed a well-organised and centralised state with a structured bureaucracy. They engaged in extensive trade networks, particularly in the Trans-Saharan trade, which brought wealth and cultural exchanges to the region. The Kanuri empire also played a key role in the spread of Islam, promoted

education, and made notable architectural and artistic achievements, including the construction of the impressive city of Kanem-Bornu.

Tutor Marked Assignment

1. How did the Jukun people engage in cultural exchanges with neighbouring communities?
2. Why is it important to understand and appreciate the diversity and dynamics of these ethnic groups in northern Nigeria?
3. How can celebrating the contributions of each ethnic group help in building a diverse and inclusive society in Nigeria?

Study Session 4: Ethnic Groups in Southern Nigeria

Introduction

Nigeria is a multi-ethnic nation with several ethnic groups. These ethnic nationalities or groups occupy different territories that formed the area known as Nigeria. While geographical factors such as good climate, soil, presence of mineral resources and others such as better security, search for land, religion, trade, and migration etc. provide explanations to the spread of ethnic groups in different parts of the country. The uniqueness or the geographical attributes of the immediate localities played major roles in the people's culture, economic activity as well as political organisations. Also, through geographical determinisms, certain ethnic groups developed centralised political systems while others developed what is described as non-centralized or segmentary political organisations. The focus of this study is on notable ethnic groups in southern Nigeria particularly, the Yoruba, Igbo, Benin, and Itsekiri among others with particular emphasis on their culture, economy, and political organisation. The people of Nigeria are classified under two major geographical groups, namely the forest peoples and the grassland (savannah) people.

Therefore, the people of Southern Nigeria belong to the geographical group called the forest people. The forest south comprises the mangrove swamp forests of the Niger Delta and coastal Greeks which have provided protection for refuge cultures. The major ethnic groups in Southern Nigeria include the Yoruba and Edo (Benin) people in Southwest Nigeria, and the Igbo, Ibibio, Ekoi people of Southeastern Nigeria.

Learning Outcomes for Study Session 4

When you have studied this session, students should be:

- 4.1. Understand the geographical factors influencing the spread of ethnic groups in Nigeria.
- 4.2. Identify and describe major ethnic groups in Southern Nigeria and their culture, economy, and political organisation.
- 4.3. Explain the origins and migration theories of the Yoruba and Igbo people.

4.1: The Yoruba

The Yoruba speaking people of Nigeria are concentrated in Ogun, Oyo, Ondo, Kwara, Ekiti and Lagos State. The Yoruba do not consider themselves as belonging to one language or cultural group. Rather, they consider themselves to belong to smaller units or monarchical states which later became known as Yoruba. These were Egba, Ijebu, Ekiti, Ibadan, Ife, Ijesha, Oyo and so on². It was from the 10th century that the Yoruba's, who possessed strikingly similar values and traditional practices, began to emerge as one people. In addition to linguistic homogeneity, the Yoruba share a common tradition and trace descent from a common ancestor called "Oduduwa" who is believed to have established the Ife dynasty.

The origin of the Yoruba people is an issue of controversy. One oral tradition holds that the Yoruba had always been in Yoruba land. This tradition describes Ile -Ife as the centre of the world where all human beings were created. God the Supreme Being noticed the earth was covered with water and decided to create the earth and man. He therefore sent his servant *Obatala*, sometimes also known as *Orisanla* to create the earth and man. But this messenger of God was drunk on his way to the earth. Another servant of God, *Oduduwa*, who watched this development took over the functions of *Orisanla* and created the soil, man, and beast. This tradition credits Ile-Ife as the cradle of civilization not only of the Yoruba but the entire world. There is however, another tradition which states the Yoruba came from Mecca. Their leader, Lamundo, was said to have been expelled from Mecca after he became an idolator and forced to flee southwards. After many days of travel, his men led by Oduduwa

arrived at Ile-ife where they decided to settle. It seems clear, however, that in spite of these stories of migration there were some indigenous inhabitants who had always lived at Ile-ife. It seems that the Oduduwa group seized control of Ile -ife on their arrival. However, the two groups agreed to live together.

Oduduwa is said to have proceeded to marry Omonide who gave birth to a daughter and a number of sons. All the sons are said to have left their father to found kingdoms. Oduduwa is therefore believed to be the father of the Yoruba people while Ile-ife served as the spiritual home of the Yoruba's.

4.1.1: Culture of the People

The Yoruba people stand out as a deeply religious group with great respect for superiors and elderly people. The Oni of Ife is regarded as the spiritual ruler of all Yoruba's. They have a tradition of living in large towns, the largest of which include Ibadan, Ogbomosho, Oshogbo, Ilorin, Abeokuta, Ilesha and Ede. They are the most urbanised group in Nigeria. The growth of these large urban centres derived in part from the need for defences but also largely as a result of the highly centralised political organisation of the people. The extended family is the basic social unit of the Yoruba. And since they live together, each extended family has a territorial existence (the large traditional compound) within the town as well as a distinct area of farmland in the rural areas. They worshipped several deities such as the *San'go* (god of thunder) and other festivals such as Osun festivals.⁵ The people are reputed for their craftsmanship, they excel in wood carving and other crafts such as bronze working, iron smelting. The famous terracotta and bronze heads of Ife which are reputable in Nigerian cultural history were produced by the

Yoruba. They have several dances, rituals and myths which display their rich culture.

4.1.2: Economy of the People

Like the economy of other forest people in Nigeria, the Yoruba are predominantly an agricultural people. They cultivate crops such as yams, sweet potatoes, cassava and other tuber crops. They are also hunters and engaged in lumbering as an economic activity because of the presence of trees. They are wood carvers and sculptors and also specialised in iron working. They exchange these products both within and outside their locality through long distance trade.

4.1.3: Political Organization of the Yoruba People

While the origin of the Yoruba remains vague, there is a clear picture of the political and social organisation of Yorubaland. Certain rulers were recognized throughout the whole of Yorubaland, the most important of these being the Oni of Ife, who was regarded as the spiritual ruler of all Yoruba and *Alaafin* of Oyo who was the political leader of the Yoruba people during the ascendancy of Oyo to power over the whole of Yorubaland. There was a monarchical structure of government. At the head was the traditional ruler, the Oba. He was elected only after divine approval had been obtained during a consultation with God through the Oni. Once crowned, the Oba becomes sacred. He is considered as the representative of God on earth, and an associate of the Supreme Being, '*Igba Kaji Orisa*'. His authority was strengthened by the use of many rituals and myths and by wearing clothes such as flowing gowns and beaded crowns which reflected glory on his imperial majesty. His words were law for the people. The monarchy was centralised. Agents of the crown (Oba) were found in outlying regions where

they served as representatives of the king. The monarch (Oba) was assisted by an advisory council which consisted of civil and military nobility as well as executive agencies. Another arm in the administration was the Ogboni society. The society was first established at Ile-Ife to assist in administration, to protect the people against the newcomers, and to help in the integration of the entire community. The Ogboni pass laws and take part in the election of Oba. Their duties were political, administrative, social and religious. Other institutions in the Yoruba political organisation are the Oro and Egungun.

The Oro was another society which carried out the order of the Ogboni elders. Egungun was a cult believed to represent the ancestors. Its members conducted visitation to the people from time to time to punish the wicked ones. Both Oro and Egungun performed duties of arrest and punishment in the society. It will be seen that although the king was in charge of affairs, he was not alone. He was assisted by powerful and influential people, therefore, could not be despotic. There were also checks and balances on his powers. Thus, the political administration of the Yoruba's can be said to be both monarchical and democratic in nature. It ensured participation in government by all, working for the same goal of bringing greatness to the people.

Later with the ascendancy of Old Oyo to dominance over the rest of states or kingdoms of Yoruba, Oyo became the strongest states in the whole of Yorubaland and incorporated many areas of Yoruba into her administration. In the Oyo political organisation, the Oba was the Alaafin of Oyo, Alaafin was the occupant of the throne and the owner of the palace. He was seen three times a year.⁷ These were during the ile, Ori and Bere festivals. Alaafin was the chief executive of the

Kingdom. All powers came from the Alaafin, but he was hemmed in by a number of checks. The Alaafin was assisted by a council of seven, the oyo-mesi. These were members of the nobility whose duties included the selection of kings. As king makers, they were very powerful. They also had the duty of ensuring that the Alaafin did not exercise arbitrary authority. The leader of the Oyomesi was known as the Bashorun. Bashorun was the prime minister and chancellor of the kingdom. He acted as the president of the council and had the chief choice in the selection of a new Alaafin.

Following the Oyomesi council in the Oyo political organisation were the Eso and Ilari. The Eso were a military caste or constabulary of the empire. The ilari were the Alaafin's representatives in the districts. At the head of the army (Eso) was their leader himself, a war general, the *Are Ona kakanfo*. To avoid a situation in which he could pose a threat to the Alaafin, the *Are Ona Kakanfo* lived in the outskirts of the town, usually in the most troublesome spot. This arrangement would keep him busy and discourage him from spending his time envying the power and influence of the Alaafin and the civilian officers. The Ogoni cult also served as a check on the excessive powers of the king and the Oyomesi and it also restrained the people. The whole system was therefore a carefully worked out arrangement of checks and balances. Oyo was able to use its calvary to expand its territory.

4.2: The Igbo People

The Igbo speaking people are located East of the lower Niger valley⁸. They constitute one of the largest ethnic groups in Nigeria. They occupy a continuous stretch of territory roughly bounded on the north by the Igalla, Idoma and Ogoja peoples, in the east by the Ibibio people, in the south by the Ijo and in the west by the Edo. Today, the Igbo inhabit the entire Imo and Anambra, Ebonyi and Enugu States, while significant fractions of them are found in Rivers and Edo states of Nigeria.

The Igbo origin has been a matter of serious speculation among scholars. Some are of the view that the Igbos had always lived where they now live and that they came from nowhere. Others are of the view that Igbo origin could be located outside their present territory. Such scholars as G. T. Basden, M. D. W. Jeffreys Major A. G. Leonard, and Robin Horton believe that the Igbo are a part of early Egyptian or Hebrew people. After a comparative study of the religion and language of these peoples, the writers come to the conclusion that, the Igbo are part of the "lost race of Israel".⁹ They assert that the Igbo settled in North Africa at the time of Moses Perhaps around 2000 BC and migrated into their present location as a result of Islamic jihads. However, despite these oral traditions on Igbo origins, many of the Ibos accept the tradition that they all first lived in the area known as *Nri-Awka-Orlu* complex and that later some of their forefathers moved away from the complex to other areas. This view is popularised by G. I. Jones, P. A. Talbot, K. O. Dike and others.

The Igbo are believed to have settled in some parts of what is now Igboland at about 2,500BC. G. I. Jones described the Nri-Awka, and Isuama (Odu) area as the

“core Igbo centre” or areas where they first settled when they arrived. From these core centres, the Igbo are said to have migrated to Nsukka Udi highlands while another wave of migration moved southwards towards the coast, the descendants of whom are the present day Uratta, Ikwerre, Etihe, Asa, Ndoki. Also from the core centre of Isuama, the Ngwa, Umuahia, Ohafia, Arochukwu, Edda and Item groups moved to the southeast and east.

4.2.1: Culture of the People

The Igbo's have a rich culture which is being practised by the people. They believe in the existence of the Supreme Being and therefore worship different deities as their gods, the most notable being *Amadioha* (god of thunder). They settle in dispersed family compounds. An average Igbo compound has a shrine meant for the worship of gods. They expressed other forms of their culture through arts work such as iron smelting or blacksmithing, they made human and animal figures from the melting and casting of bronze or aluminium. They also have a series of festivals which the people perform as a way of reenactments of their past historical experiences. Some of these include the masquerades festival, the Ofala festival and others. Some of the good cultural artefacts in Igboland were discovered at *Igbo-Ukwu* accidentally while digging a well in his compound. Their elders were mostly the custodians of tradition and cultural values in the society, mostly ritualists, medicine men and diviners.

4.2.2: Economy of the Igbo People

The economic system of the Igbo can be discussed under three major headings: agriculture, trade and local manufacturers. Agriculture was the most important single occupation of the Igbo. Both the Igbo man and woman were farmers. They produced enough yams, cassava, cocoyam, palm oil, palm kernel fruits and vegetables. Agriculture was responsible for its very high population density. The chief crop of the Igbo was the Yam followed closely by the cocoyam. Trade was not as important as agriculture; it was however an important aspect of Igbo economic life. Ecological differences and varied vegetation appear to have been the major reason behind the development of local and regional trade amongst the Igbo. For example, as the soil of the northern and central Igboland appeared to have been overworked by the concentration of population, the sellers took to trading and manufacturing in order to supplement agriculture. In the southeast and west of Igboland, the soil appeared fertile with a scanty population. The people produced enough food items.

Mineral products like iron ore are found in Awka, salt is found in Ubanu and lead in Abakaliki were exported by the various Igbo groups who traded on them. Also manufactured products, like crafts, blacksmithing material produced by the Awka, Nkwere and Abiriba were items of Igbo regional trade.

4.2.3: Political organisation of the Igbo People

The political organisation of the Igbo people belongs to the category generally referred to as stateless, or non-centralized. This is so because their political system lacked a central authority with powers over the entire Igboland or Igbo people. Such political systems are generally described as segmentary or

egalitarian because of lack of central authority usually headed by a single person. It is worthy to clarify that the Obi or Igwe stood as leaders in Igboland, but these political leaders did not have control over the whole of Igbo people. They were rather representatives of their various domains.

Two types of democracies operated in Igboland during the pre-colonial period¹¹. These are the direct and representative democracy. The largest political unit was the village group which had a population of only a few thousand people. Within the village group, authority was never concentrated in the hands of any individual or family. Although there were chiefs, usually elderly men, there was no ruling aristocracy which wielded authority as a specialised full-time occupation. Rather, the village was ruled by a council of elders, usually heads of the major extended families. At the bottom of Igbo political arrangement was the Household made up of man, wife and children. This was closely followed by the sub-lineage or the extended family. The sub-lineages were made up of various households who could trace their descent to one common ancestor. The sub-lineages formed the lineage whose origin centred on the remote ancestor. Here the heads of the various households discussed matters at the sub-lineage group or level. These heads of various levels or units were known as the *Okpara* (first son). They were spokesmen at every level and offered sacrifices to the gods on behalf of the units. The lineage assembly made up of all adult males of the units deliberated on matters affecting the sub-lineages. The age groups and secret societies assisted the lineages assembly in the government of the lineage units. The age-grades organised themselves for work, war and government. Those who were still youths cleared paths and public places, streams and also served as police.

Above the lineage assembly was the village assembly which was made up of all the adult members of the village with an inner council made up of the lineage heads known as the *Amaala* or *Oji-oyo*. They decided on matters affecting the entire village. The sub-lineage unit, the lineage assembly and the village were levels of direct democracy where every adult male, or female in some cases were directly involved in the affairs of the group.

The village-group assembly was made up of the representatives of the member-villages. The representatives included *Ofo*holders, members of secret societies, and senior titled men; decisions reached at this level were implemented by the age grades and secret societies.

4.3: The Bini People

The word Bini is broadly used to cover the capital city, to describe the kingdom, the empire, the language, and the people. The Bini people are located in the forest belt of southern Nigeria. The people had an empire that embraced both the Edo – speaking (bini proper) and a large non-Edo speaking population. The Bini empire thus incorporated the Bini, Esan, Kukuruku, Orra, Akoko, Isoko etc. There are two separate traditions which seek to account for the origin of the Bini people and the Kingdom.

The first of this tradition which is also the most ancient is called the *Osanubua* legend. This account claimed that the Bini kingdom was founded by the youngest son of the Bini High God known as Osarubua. According to this version, the Bini left Egypt for West Africa sometimes in the remote past. After a brief stay in Sudan, they headed southwards and made a head-stop at Ile-Ife, from where they came to their present abode.

4.3.1: Culture of the Bini People

The Bini people, just like their neighbours, occupy the forest region. They have a rich culture and settle in clustered or urban areas. Through their environmental endowments, the people produced artworks of iron, bronze, and wooden materials. A lot of art works from carved wood were produced by the Bini people.

Bronze and iron working flourished in this area. Beads were also manufactured by the people for political and religious significance. A lot of cultural festivals were celebrated by the people, the prominent amongst which is the Igwe festival. They believe in worship of different deities as gods.

4.3.2: The Economy of the Bini People

The major economic activity of the Bini people was agriculture. This engaged both the men and women in the society. They cultivated crops like yam, cassava, and sweet potatoes. Because of the presence of raw materials, the people were great artisans. They manufactured furniture, and other art works of various figures and sizes. They also traded in agricultural products. The people worked iron and bronze most of which were used for the decoration of the Oba's palace.

4.3.3: Political Organizations of the Bini People

The Bini had an imperial system of political organisation which at the centre was the Oba who was a divine monarch or priest king. He was prevented by innumerable taboos from leaving in the palace except on occasions when ceremonies fundamental to the well-being of the state were ascribed to him and it was popularly believed that he did not eat or die. He had legislative, executive, and judicial powers and had the monopoly right to impose and communicate

capital sentences. He controls the grant of politically important titles. He controlled the minor chiefs and could proclaim peace or war and was said to own all the land in the Bini etc. Next to the Oba in the imperial political system was the Bini state council which was made up of a senior titled chief under the leadership of Iyase – the prime minister. The council was summoned by the Oba on the enactment of a new law and the proclamation of war or peace. But day to day administration, the Oba consulted the prominent titled chiefs. The kingdom was ruled by an absentee resident who resided at the imperial capital.

4.4: The Itsekiri People

The Itsekiri are found in the Western Delta area of Nigeria. The Itsekiri tradition of origin is diverse. Most of the Itsekiri villages have their own tradition of origin. Some claim that they came from Ode, an area of Ijebuland, while some claim they came from Bini. But some also claim they have always been where they are now and descended from *Umaale* who is now deified and worshipped as an ancestor. The Bini tradition has it that the founder Ginua (*Iginuwa*) a Bini prince left Bini with a retinue of his supporters. He thereafter proceeded to found 'Ode' as a capital of a new settlement. In their new place of abode, they are said to have met a man called Itsekun who had Ginua land to build his capital. It was this new settlement, called *Ode itsekiri* that later became the capital of Warri kingdom. From this capital, other main settlements grew. These include Gbolokposo, Obodo, Erere and Elume.

4.4.1: Culture of the Itsekiri People

Society amongst the Itsekiri people like the rest of the coastal Delta states was divided along the lines of clan (*Ibe*). The society lacked an instrument of central control, and in fact only the high priest representing the cult of national god exercised authority over the whole clan. The people had great respect for age. Secret cults played significant roles such as the maintenance of law and order. They have societies like the Ekpe, Ekine, and Sekiapu which put on special displays of dancing and drumming. They had festivals which re-enacted the people's historical experience and rich culture.

4.4.2: Economy of the Itsekiri People

It is generally believed that the Itsekiri Kingdom rose and developed as a result of the trans-Atlantic trade, particularly the trade in slaves. However, before the emergence of slave trade, the Itsekiri exchanged products of the Delta, fish, crayfish, salt and earthenware with agricultural products of the hinterland. The Itsekiri were famous in canoe building and had the timber for canoe manufacture. Salt was an important item in the Itsekiri hinterland trade. Itsekiri, like other Delta groups, made salt. They also specialised in pot-making and were the only suppliers of pots in the entire Delta area. The pots were used in the salt industries, for grinding tobacco and for household purposes.

The advent of overseas slave trade helped to expand the Itsekiri trade by providing it with more commodities for exchange within the hinterland. Even during the heydays of slave trade, slaves did not constitute the mainstay of

Itsekiri economy. The internal trade within Itsekiri involved trade articles like palm oil, ivory, pepper and cloth.

4.4.3: Political Organization of the Itsekiri People

Itsekiri had evolved a compact system of government with ode-Itseki ri as the capital. The *Olu* was at the apex of the administration, and a supreme council of '*Ojoye*'. The *Ojoye* council was made up of the sons of the seventy Bini notables who accompanied Ginua to Itsekiri land. Apart from the council, the king had the help of other imperial officers who helped him in the day-to-day administration of the Kingdom. These included *Ologbotsere* (prime minister and chief adviser to the Olu). *Iyatsere* (war chief), *Uwangué* (custodian of Olu's regalia and chief spokesman in council). Olu had the right to confer titles on worthy and deserving citizens; such titles became hereditary. Olu was both a spiritual and political head of the Itsekiri people. He offered sacrifices to the departed rulers and important deities of the kingdom. The village council was headed by the *Olara-aja* (the eldest man of the land) and the *Okpanran* (priest). Disputes which could not be settled by village elders were sent to the Olu's council.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the study of notable ethnic groups in Southern Nigeria, such as the Yoruba and Igbo, provides valuable insights into the rich cultural, economic, and political organisation of these communities. The Yoruba people, with their monarchical and democratic political structure, vibrant craftsmanship, and agricultural practices, exhibit a deep sense of religious and social values. On the other hand, the Igbo people, known for their dispersed family compounds, worship of deities, and agricultural prowess, showcase a unique cultural heritage. Understanding the origins, traditions, and economic activities of these ethnic groups contributes to a broader understanding of Nigeria's multi-ethnic society and the diverse dynamics that have shaped its history. By appreciating the complexities and nuances of these societies, we can foster cultural appreciation, promote inclusivity, and strengthen social cohesion in Nigeria and beyond.

Summary

The following are what you have learned:

1. The Yoruba and Igbo ethnic groups in Southern Nigeria offer valuable insights into cultural, economic, and political aspects of their communities.
2. The Yoruba people have a political structure that combines monarchy and democracy, showcasing vibrant craftsmanship and agricultural practices.
3. The Igbo people have dispersed family compounds, worship deities, and excel in agriculture.

4. Studying these ethnic groups contributes to a broader understanding of Nigeria's multi-ethnic society and its history.
5. Appreciating the complexities and nuances of these societies can promote cultural appreciation, inclusivity, and social cohesion.

Self-Assessment Questions (SAQ)

- SAQ4.1.** What are some cultural, economic, and political aspects that can be learned from the Yoruba and Igbo ethnic groups in Southern Nigeria? (Tests learning outcome 4.2)
- SAQ4.2.** How does the political structure of the Yoruba people combine monarchy and democracy? (Tests learning outcome 4.2)
- SAQ4.3.** What are some examples of vibrant craftsmanship and agricultural practices exhibited by the Yoruba people? (Tests learning outcome 4.2)
- SAQ4.4.** What are the characteristics of the Igbo people's dispersed family compounds? (Tests learning outcome 4.3)
- SAQ4.5.** What role do deities play in the religious practices of the Igbo people? (Tests learning outcome 4.3)

Self-Assessment Answers (SAA)

- SAA4.1.** The Yoruba and Igbo ethnic groups in Southern Nigeria offer valuable insights into cultural, economic, and political aspects. Culturally, they have rich traditions, art forms, music, dance, and oral history that highlight their unique identities. Economically, both groups engage in agriculture, trade, and craftsmanship, contributing to the local and national economy. Politically, the Yoruba people have a system that combines elements of monarchy and democracy, with traditional rulers known as obas, who serve as symbols of unity

and authority, while democratic institutions play a role in decision-making processes.

SAA4.2. The political structure of the Yoruba people is characterised by a combination of monarchy and democracy. At the centre of this structure is the traditional ruler, known as the oba, who holds a hereditary position and serves as a symbol of authority and unity. However, the Yoruba people also have democratic institutions, such as the Oyo Mesi, a council of chiefs, and the Ogbomoso Parapo, a representative body, which play a role in decision-making processes. This combination allows for a balance between traditional leadership and participatory governance.

SAA4.3. The Yoruba people are known for their vibrant craftsmanship and agricultural practices. In terms of craftsmanship, they produce intricate works of art, such as wood carvings, pottery, beadwork, and textiles. Adire, a traditional indigo-dyed cloth, is a notable example of their artistic craftsmanship. In agriculture, the Yoruba people engage in farming, cultivating crops such as yams, cassava, corn, and palm produce. Their agricultural practices are often intertwined with cultural rituals and ceremonies, emphasising the significance of agriculture in their society.

SAA4.4. The Igbo people's dispersed family compounds are characterised by a unique social structure. Instead of living in centralised villages, the Igbo people traditionally live in dispersed family compounds called "Umunna" or "Obi." These compounds consist of multiple residential buildings and are occupied by extended family members who trace their ancestry back to a common ancestor.

The compounds serve as centres of social and economic activities, fostering a sense of community and shared responsibilities among the extended family.

SAA4.5. Deities play a significant role in the religious practices of the Igbo people. They believe in a pantheon of deities, known as the Alusi, who are associated with various aspects of life, nature, and ancestral spirits. Deities serve as intermediaries between the living and the spiritual realm, and rituals and sacrifices are performed to honour and appease them. The Igbo people believe that maintaining a harmonious relationship with these deities is essential for the well-being and prosperity of the community. The religious practices of the Igbo people reflect their deep spiritual beliefs and cultural traditions.

Tutor Marked Assignment

1. How do the Yoruba and Igbo ethnic groups contribute to Nigeria's multi-ethnic society and its history?
2. What are some potential benefits of studying these ethnic groups in terms of cultural appreciation, inclusivity, and social cohesion?

Study Session 5: Evolution of Nigeria as a Political Unit

Introduction

The polity called Nigeria as we know it today was before colonial rule made up of several independent states variously referred to as kingdoms, empires, chiefdoms, etc. Each state was independent of the other but there were numerous layers of relationships among them. The politically strong ones just before the onset of colonial rule were the Sokoto Caliphate, Borno, the Hausa states and Nupe in the north and Oyo and Benin in the south. This is in addition to several small kingdoms and numerous states without clearly defined political leadership beyond the family or clan referred to as politically non-centralized states.

These states were at the onset of British colonial rule gradually amalgamated and administered as one colonial entity known as the colony and protectorate of Nigeria. It was this colonial creation that became independent in 1960 as the Republic of Nigeria.

Learning Outcomes for Study Session 5

When you have studied this session, you should be able to:

- 5.1. Understand the historical factors leading to Nigeria's emergence as a country, including the role of British colonialism, amalgamation, and naming.
- 5.2. Comprehend the process and reasons behind the British amalgamation of Nigeria, and the impact of indirect rule on different regions and traditional governance structures.
- 5.3. Trace the constitutional developments in Nigeria from colonial rule to independence, including the transition from regionalism to a federal system of government, and the evolution of Nigeria's constitutional framework up to the 1999 Constitution.

5.1: The Evolution of Nigeria

The territories that later became Nigeria comprised different states with sovereign status. Relations between these states were international relations before the colonial onslaught. Considering the constellation of state systems within the area – the Sokoto Caliphate to the north and the northwest, Borno to the northeast, the Oyo and Benin empires to the southwest, and the numerous non-centralized communities of the forest belt to the southeast, the possibility of the emergence of a state system similar to the present Nigeria without an external intervention is indeed very remote. However, some scholars such as Billy Dudley have argued that the inter-group relationships such as those of trade, conquests, political association, myths of common origin, etc. could still have provided the basis for a state like Nigeria.

The credit for the amalgamation and emergence of Nigeria in its present form goes to the British. ITQ From the study of the evolution of Nigeria in this section, you might have come across some factors that led to the emergence of the entity Nigeria, what are these factors?

5.2: Amalgamation

The name “Nigeria” was first used by Flora Shaw, who was to become the wife of Frederick Lugard, in an article to the London Times of 1899 to refer to the territories around the River Niger in Northern Nigeria. The name was originally applied to the Protectorate of Northern Nigeria before it later came to be applied to the whole country.

British interest in Northern Nigeria predated the nineteenth century, however, by the beginning of the nineteenth century as early as 1879 the British government allowed British trading companies access to these territories for commercial activities. By 1826 British merchant ships had traded on the Bonny River, and by 1886 up to 1900 the British allowed the United Africa Company (UAC), which later became the chartered Royal Niger Company power to administer the Northern Nigeria territories on its behalf. This meant that the company was the government of Northern Nigeria at this period. By 1900 the British government took over administration of the territory from the Royal Niger Company and appointed Frederick (later Lord Lugard) as High Commissioner. It was Lugard who proclaimed the Protectorate of Northern Nigeria.

What became Nigeria was an amalgam of various colonial possessions which were acquired over different times and later amalgamated gradually even though the general reference to amalgamation is the one of 1914 which brought the two giant territories of the Northern and Southern protectorates together. In 1900 the Niger Coast protectorate was amalgamated with the Colony of Lagos to form the Protectorate of Southern Nigeria. This is different from the Colony of Lagos which had a different status.

Then in 1906 there was the second series of amalgamation when the Colony of Lagos was merged with the Protectorate of Southern Nigeria to form a single entity known as the Colony and Protectorate of Southern Nigeria. Finally, there was the amalgamation of 1914, which brought the Protectorate of Northern Nigeria and the Colony and Protectorate of Southern Nigeria into one single entity known as the Colony and Protectorate of Nigeria on 1st January 1914.

In 1861 the British annexed the Territory of Lagos as a colony but administered it by the governor for the West African settlements resident in Sierra Leone between 1866 and 1874 and the governor for Gold Coast Colony between 1874 and 1886.

5.3: Reasons for the Amalgamation

The British amalgamated Nigeria for the same reasons that made them want to colonise it in the first place. That is, to serve their imperial interests. The main reasons for the amalgamation are: First, they wanted a cheap and secure source of raw materials for their industries. Second, they wanted a market for their manufactured goods. Third, they needed a source for generating capital resources for investment in Britain thereby strengthening the British pound sterling against other currencies. Fourth, they needed a manpower reserve for military and other purposes. Fifth, they wanted the ports, water ways, roads, railways, and air spaces for transportation and imperial communication systems. All these would be easier and more efficient only if Nigeria was amalgamated.

5.4: Colonial Rule

In the previous discussion, the interest of colonial rule was stated bearing in mind the invasion and occupation of Nigeria. The major task before the British was to find the most cost-effective way to rule their newly acquired territory, a territory composed of different cultural and religious groups with different systems of governance and administration. The British, based on Lord Lugard's recommendations, decided to interfere as little as possible in the day-to-day administration of the peoples they ruled. It was decided that interference should be limited to what was necessary to the basic needs of colonial administration and economic exploitation of the country or to eliminate what they perceived as repugnant to British conception of justice and morality.

To this end, a system of British rule through local traditional rulers known as Indirect Rule was instituted. These rulers would be responsible for carrying out colonial policies and tax collection under the supervision of British colonial officers. This system created the illusion of Africans ruling themselves and significantly reduced the cost of administration. It also created a wedge between the traditional rulers who became beneficiaries of the colonial system and patriots resisting colonial domination. In Northern Nigeria, Indirect rule, in part, insulated Islam from the Christian influences which might have led to resistance to colonialism.

The northern part of Nigeria, with its large states and developed emirates system was the most fertile ground for the indirect rule system of administration. The system was a success in the northern region. However, in the western and eastern regions it was not so successful. In Benin and Yorubaland, the British

reenacted the former empires in 1916 and an unpopular attempt to bring back the Oyo Empire was also attempted. The Oba, now appointed and backed by the British, were expected to serve them. Many of them became autocratic because the mechanism for removing despotic ones was no longer effective. This did not eliminate resistance as four officials of the Oyo Native Authority were killed at Iseyin in 1916. Similarly, in 1918 a rebellion broke out after the Abeokuta Native Authority introduced direct taxation.

In igboland, for example, there were no chiefs; the British had to create a class of chiefs referred to as warrant chiefs, to collect taxes and enforce colonial policies. The policy of indirect rule was premised on local peoples being ruled by their local traditional rulers without disruption to their lives. However the warrant chiefs had no prior legitimacy in the places they ruled and were invariably corrupt and unscrupulous; therefore they were deeply resented. In most of the southern provinces indirect rule was a problem because of the absence of traditional rulers and centralised governments. This did not stop the British from introducing them anyway.

Throughout Nigeria, when traditional rulers or British appointed rulers served as intermediaries between the government and the people, the result was always misrule and corruption by local officials and eventually anti-colonial resistance. The 1929 Aba Riots arose because of tax abuse and other forms of bad governance. Native courts set up by the colonial administration to try cases based on local traditions and customs were equally failed. The most vociferous opposition to the native authorities came from the class of western educated

Nigerians for example nationalists like Dr. Nnamdi Azikiwe, Herbert Macauley, Obafemi Awolowo, and Aminu Kano.

In spite of the claim of mutual benefits to both the British and local traditional rulers as well as the claim of minimum disruption of people's lives and livelihood, British interference was widespread and very negative. Some of the visibly negative impacts included the following:

- Most emirs and chiefs who resisted British rule in any form were deposed and new pliant ones installed. Therefore, only those who collaborated with the colonial regime were maintained.
- The British reduced the status of both the Caliph at Sokoto and the Shehu of Borno to that of emirs. The Caliph was renamed Sultan.
- The judicial system was changed to reduce the potency of the Islamic legal system (shari'ah). Shari'ah courts became subordinate to customary and common law courts.

5.5: Constitutional Developments

You may know that the colonial government set out how they can rule Nigeria through defined rules and regulations. A constitution is a document which clearly defines how a state should be governed. It contains statements that depict the relationship between the rulers and the ruled and the basic rights and duties of citizens in a country. A constitution, therefore, is a body of rules and regulations that set out how a state should be governed. It defines the structure, powers, functions of the government and the rights and responsibilities of citizens.

Constitutionalism is a basic principle that states that the government should rule the people according to the constitution of the land. The essence is to make sure that the activities and operations of the government are within the confines of the law. Constitutionalism promotes respect for the operations of the rule of law.

The historical development of constitutions and constitutionalism in Nigeria can be traced to the establishment of colonial rule in the 1860s. However, constitutional government in the formal sense began with the institution of the Nigerian Council by Lord Lugard after the amalgamation of the Southern and Northern Protectorates in 1914. The evolution of the Nigerian Council marked the beginning of constitutional development in Nigeria. The council was however dissolved in 1922 following the adoption of the Clifford Constitution. Between 1922 and 1954, four different notable constitutions were operated in Nigeria. These are the Clifford Constitution (1922), the Richards Constitution (1946), the Macpherson Constitution (1951) and the Lyttleton Constitution (1954).

The Richards Constitution gave birth to the idea of regionalism, which enabled the different regions: East, West and North to develop at their own pace. The 1951 constitution introduced a quasi-federal model into the administration of the regions. This allowed for power to be shared between the central and the regional governments, but the central government was empowered to have control over the regional governments in some matters.

The Lyttleton constitution of 1954 rearranged the whole system and introduced a federal system of government. The constitution marked the beginning of the operation of the federal system in Nigeria. In 1957 and 1958 constitutional conferences were held for the purpose of resolving some issues such as the

minority problem and charting the way forward for the granting of self-government in 1960. Between 1960 and 1979, three constitutions were put in place in the country. These are the 1960 Independence, the 1963 Republican and the 1979 Presidential constitutions. The amended 1999 constitution is an improvement of the 1979 constitution.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the evolution of Nigeria is a complex and multifaceted process shaped by historical factors, British colonialism, and constitutional developments. The amalgamation of different territories under British rule in 1914 marked a significant turning point in Nigeria's history, leading to the formation of the country in its present form. The British motivations behind amalgamation were driven by their imperial interests, including access to raw materials, markets, and transportation routes. The implementation of indirect rule further influenced Nigeria's governance structure, with varying degrees of success and resistance across different regions. The constitutional developments, from the Nigerian Council to the post-independence constitutions, reflect the changing dynamics of power and governance in the country. Understanding this evolutionary journey provides valuable insights into Nigeria's socio-political landscape and the challenges it has faced.

Summary

The following are what you have learned:

1. The territories that later became Nigeria comprised different states with sovereign status, and their inter-group relationships provided a basis for the emergence of Nigeria.
2. The British played a crucial role in the amalgamation of Nigeria, gradually bringing together various colonial possessions, culminating in the 1914 amalgamation of the Northern and Southern protectorates.
3. British interests in Nigeria included securing raw materials, establishing markets for manufactured goods, generating capital resources, and gaining control over transportation and communication systems.
4. The British implemented a system of indirect rule, relying on local traditional rulers to carry out colonial policies, which created a divide between those benefiting from the system and those resisting colonial domination.
5. Indirect rule was more successful in the northern region, while in the western and eastern regions, attempts to reinstate former empires and create warrant chiefs led to resistance and discontent.
6. Constitutional developments in Nigeria started with the Nigerian Council in 1914 and continued with notable constitutions such as the Clifford Constitution (1922), Richard Constitution (1946), Macpherson Constitution (1951), Lyttleton Constitution (1954), and subsequent post-independence constitutions.

7. These constitutions introduced regionalism, quasi-federal models, and eventually a federal system of government, shaping the balance of power between central and regional governments.
8. The British interference in traditional governance structures, including deposing resistant rulers and reducing the status of religious leaders, had negative impacts and fueled resistance movements.
9. The evolution of Nigeria's constitutional framework reflects the country's journey toward self-governance and the struggle to address issues such as minority representation and self-determination.
10. The amended 1999 Constitution represents the current constitutional framework in Nigeria, building upon the foundations laid by previous constitutions.

Self-Assessment Questions (SAQ)

- SAQ5.1.** What were the factors that contributed to the emergence of Nigeria as a country? (Tests learning outcome 5.1)
- SAQ5.2.** Who was responsible for the amalgamation of Nigeria, and what were their motivations? (Tests learning outcome 5.2)
- SAQ5.3.** How did the British implement indirect rule in Nigeria, and what were the effects of this system? (Tests learning outcome 5.3)
- SAQ5.4.** What were the different stages of amalgamation that led to the formation of Nigeria in its present form? (Tests learning outcome 5.2)
- SAQ5.5.** How did the British colonial government interfere with traditional governance structures in Nigeria, and what were the consequences of this interference? (Tests learning outcome 5.3)

SAQ5.6. What were the reasons behind the resistance movements against British colonial rule in Nigeria? (Tests learning outcome 5.2)

SAQ5.7. How did the British colonial government change the judicial system and the status of traditional rulers in Nigeria? (Tests learning outcome 5.3)

Self-Assessment Answers (SAA)

SAA5.1. The factors that contributed to the emergence of Nigeria as a country include the diverse territories with sovereign status that comprised Nigeria, the inter-group relationships based on trade, conquests, and myths of common origin, and external intervention by the British during the colonial era.

SAA5.2. Lord Frederick Lugard, later Lord Lugard, was responsible for the amalgamation of Nigeria. His motivations were primarily driven by British imperial interests, including securing raw materials, establishing markets, generating capital resources, and gaining control over transportation and communication systems.

SAA5.3. The British implemented indirect rule in Nigeria by appointing local traditional rulers as intermediaries between the colonial government and the people. These rulers were responsible for carrying out colonial policies and tax collection under the supervision of British colonial officers. The effects of this system varied across different regions of Nigeria, with more success in the northern region and challenges in the western and eastern regions.

SAA5.4. The stages of amalgamation that led to the formation of Nigeria in its present form involved multiple steps. In 1900, the Niger Coast protectorate was amalgamated with the Colony of Lagos to form the Protectorate of Southern

Nigeria. Then, in 1906, the Colony of Lagos was merged with the Protectorate of Southern Nigeria, creating the Colony and Protectorate of Southern Nigeria. Finally, in 1914, the Protectorate of Northern Nigeria and the Colony and Protectorate of Southern Nigeria were amalgamated into the Colony and Protectorate of Nigeria.

SAA5.5. The British colonial government interfered with traditional governance structures in Nigeria by deposing resistant rulers, reducing the status of religious leaders, and imposing warrant chiefs in areas where there were no existing chiefs. The consequences of this interference included resentment, corruption among local officials, and resistance movements against colonial rule.

SAA5.6. The resistance movements against British colonial rule in Nigeria were fueled by various factors, including the loss of traditional authority, cultural and religious suppression, economic exploitation, imposition of taxes, and interference in local governance. Nationalist leaders emerged and mobilised against colonial rule, demanding self-governance and independence.

SAA5.7. The British colonial government changed the judicial system in Nigeria by reducing the potency of the Islamic legal system (shari'ah) and making it subordinate to customary and common law courts. Additionally, traditional rulers who resisted British rule were deposed, and their status was reduced to that of emirs or chiefs appointed by the British. These changes had significant implications for the traditional governance structures and systems of justice in Nigeria.

Tutor Marked Assignment

1. What were the key constitutional developments in Nigeria from the colonial period to independence?
2. How did the concept of regionalism shape Nigeria's political landscape and governance structure?
3. What were the aims and outcomes of the constitutional conferences held in Nigeria between 1957 and 1958?
4. How did Nigeria transition from regionalism to a federal system of government, and what were the implications of this transition?
5. What were some of the negative impacts of British interference and indirect rule on different regions of Nigeria?

Study Session 6: The Settler-Indigene Phenomenon

Introduction

As a political system, Nigeria is unique and exceptionally different from other countries. For instance, although Nigeria operates a federal presidential-democracy like the United States of America (USA), the theory and practice of the system in Nigeria is unique. This is not because Nigeria's constitution is so much different in theory regarding what is obtainable in the Constitution of the USA, but in practice. Nigeria's federal-democracy is out of the blue. The chief among the strange things about Nigerian federalism is the 'definition' of who is a Nigerian. Everyone born in the country is practically a citizen of the country, but not everyone given birth to in a state (the second tier of government in Nigerian federation) is truly regarded as a bonafide Nigerian in that state. This gives birth to settler-indigene lexicon in the political vocabulary of Nigeria. Thus, the settlers-indigenes question has been one of the greatest challenges confronting Nigeria federalism.

Complicating settlers-indigenes' question in the country is seen in the 1999 Constitution (as amended) of the Federal Republic of Nigeria. The Constitution frowns at discrimination, yet it upholds indigeneship. By implication, the Constitution encourages unity – one Nigeria – and paradoxically, it encourages the disintegration of the country.

The focus of this chapter is to examine the issues relating to settlers-indigene question in Nigeria. We analyse how the movement of people across the geo-political zones and ethnic divides (in history and at present) has not only

affected the practice of federalism in Nigeria, but also has a significant impact on the political development of the country.

Learning Outcomes for Study Session 6

When you have studied this session, students should be able to:

- 6.1. Understand the unique political system of Nigeria, its differences from other countries, and the settlers-indigenes dichotomy's impact on Nigerian federalism.
- 6.2. Examine the historical and political factors contributing to the settlers-indigenes question in Nigeria and evaluate the role of the 1999 Constitution in addressing it, along with its limitations.
- 6.3. Discuss the influence of elite theory on the manipulation of settlers-indigenes dichotomy by Nigerian political elites and recognize the consequences of this issue on political development, ethnic conflicts, and social cohesion in Nigeria.

6.1: Theoretical Analysis

The elite theory was advanced in the early twentieth century by three famous sociologists: Vilfredo Pareto, Gaetano Mosca, and Robert Michels. The term 'elite' as a category of sociological analysis was introduced by Pareto, while the idea associated with the theory was floated earlier by Mosca. The term 'elite' was derived from French where it meant to be something excellent. Pareto, in his book titled "The Mind and Society", used the term to indicate a group of people who show the highest ability in their field of activity whatever its nature might be. However, according to Mosca in his work titled "The Ruling Class", the people (the society or a political system) are divided into two groups: the rulers and the ruled. The rulers are the elite, and they control most of the wealth, power, and prestige in the society. The ruled are referred to as the masses and are said not to be able to replace the elite.

It is worthy to note the fact that classical elitists make use of the inevitability of elite rule as a premise to counter argue with political liberalism and Marxism. Lopez (2013) stated that classical elitists claimed that both democracy (as the government of the people or demos) and socialism (as a classless regime) were impossible outcomes because society is necessarily elite driven. These theorists believe that elites could only be substituted by another set of elites. However, this means that the majority is necessarily ruled by a minority. This notion was expressed in Pareto's (1935) law of elite circulation and in Mosca's (1939) notion of political class.

According to Lopez (2013), the principle or law of elite circulation holds that elites alternate in power because of either peaceful or violent competition. In Pareto's

(1935) terms, history is (and could only be) nothing but a 'cemetery of elites'. The notion of political class, which is currently less frequent in elite studies, defines elites as a class of political rulers- in opposition to a mass of followers.

Furthermore, in the classical elitist literature, elites were often (but not only) defined through capacity, personality, and skill. It was submitted, for instance, that Pareto (1935) distinguished elites between those who resembled the lion (domination by force) and those who resembled the fox (domination by persuasion and skill). Therefore, it was a typology that resembles Machiavelli's political philosophy. Mosca (1939) made mention of material conditions and the intellectual and moral superiority of elites (Lopez, 2013).

In its classical formulation, elite theory seeks to describe and explain the power relationships in contemporary society. The theory posits that the minority, consisting of members of the economic elite and policy-planning networks, holds most of the power. This power is independent of the state democratic electoral process. Elite theory was developed as an alternative paradigm to pluralism. It rejects the pluralist view concerning the distribution of power in society. Mosca argued that a minority group, as against the pluralist perspective, performs all political functions, monopolises power, and enjoys the advantages that power brings. As a minority group within the society, the elite have many manipulative devices they use against the masses, the majority. They use manipulative skills, including oratory, persuasion, and playing upon the sentiments of the people to perpetuate themselves into power. Consequently, power is concentrated in the hands of the few.

Based on the argument of the elite theorists, settler-indigene dichotomy in Nigeria is the manifestation of the manipulative skills of the elites in the country. The dichotomy itself is an objective reality that could be managed for political development in Nigeria. Nevertheless, this is used but for playing upon the sentiments of the Nigerian masses, especially the one attached to ethnicity. Settler-indigene issue, therefore, has become one of the national questions that are difficult to manage in the country. The Nigerian political elite are doing this to perpetuate themselves in power and keep the masses, the Nigerian citizens, divided against each other instead of being united against the parasitic elites.

Since Nigerian political elites have been “sentimental, uncontrollably dependent, greedy or materialistic, and in most cases non-nationalistic”, they have become self-centred. Thus, they are only concerned about their welfare and that of their immediate families. As against “elite consensus” that guarantees democratic consolidation, the attitude of the Nigerian elites reinforces ‘no permanent enemy (in politics) but permanent interest’. The interest is, however, not that of the corporate development of Nigeria but that of the individual elites. They, therefore, use settlers-indigenes dichotomy among Nigerians to achieve their permanent interest, which is to remain relevant in politics and perpetually occupy political posts.

6.2: The Genesis of Settlers-Indigenes Brouhaha in Nigeria

The beginning of what is today known as Nigeria is traceable to many communities and ethnic groups existing in the pre-colonial era. Apart from other 'smaller' socio-ethnic kingdoms, three major political organisations existed in the pre-colonial times; the Old Oyo Empire in what is referred to as the South-West (Yoruba) today, the Sokoto Caliphate (in today's Northern part of Nigeria), and the village political structure of the Igbo society (Southeastern part of the country). Each of these major political organisations in the pre-colonial times existed independent of each other and were organised based on the peculiarities and needs of the people.

In broad terms, the people of "Nigeria" in the pre-colonial era were organised into either centralised or non-centralised systems of government. The formal system usually had kings, class arrangement, administrative officials, privileges of ranks, regulation of tax and tributes, among others. The latter does not possess these features in a clear-cut manner. It is these political arrangements that the colonial master, the British Imperial Government, met on ground when the Nigerian area was subjugated. The colonial government initially created Southern and Northern Protectorates, ruling them separately, before the two Protectorates were amalgamated in 1914.

Furthermore, the bringing together of the two Protectorates can be seen as the genesis of federalism in Nigeria. Sadly, the genesis of settlers-indigenes question is traceable to this amalgamation. Federalism, according to Babalola (2013:43), in Nigeria was necessitated by the desire to achieve 'unity in diversity'. However, from the outset, the British Imperial Power had another agenda. It was a "divide

and rule” strategy employed by the colonial state to heighten “ethnic and regional sectionalism (in order) to curb Nigerian nationalism and to maintain colonial power”.

Therefore, instead of achieving unity in diversity, the various ethnic groups are pulled apart through the heightened consciousness of their differences rather than features that bring them together. Since then, till independence and up till today, ethnicity, the feeling of marginalisation and discrimination, political exclusion, and exploitation among the Nigerian citizens across all states of federation had been unresolved issues in Nigerian federalism. These ugly trends have manifested in different ways in the country.

Chief among the manifestations of heightened differences among Nigerians as they live across states in the federation is ethno-political crisis. Both settlers and indigenes in the states struggle for political relevance and rights. Therefore, this has led to armed conflict and political crises. Post-independence Nigeria has witnessed political crises like the 1951 Western Region House of Assembly election crisis in which the “National Council of Nigerian Citizens (NCNC) defeated the Action Group (AG) in the Western Region. The NCNC won 35 seats, while the AG secured 29 seats. The AG was created as a Yoruba political party with Western Region as its base. Thus, it was defeated by the NCNC, which was considered an Igbo and Eastern Region party. This led to the crisis in the Western region. Also, the 1954 federal election crisis, 1964 federal election crisis, 1979 federal election crisis, and even the June 12, 1993 crisis could be traced to the scramble for power, political space, and relevance occasioned by the abnormality identified with Nigerian federalism.

In the Fourth Republic, this ugly trend has led to killings of innocent Nigerians across the states of the federation. In the timeline of ethnopolitical crises, one realises that settlers-indigenes' question is more heightened as democracy was re-institutionalised in Nigeria in May 1999.

Furthermore, among the devastating attacks by the Fulani herdsmen were those experienced in Benue, Plateau, Kaduna, Niger, Jigawa, Sokoto, Edo, Delta, Yobe, and Anambra States. The Fulani herdsmen usually set houses on fire, sack communities, and occupy them. The herdsmen do not tolerate co-existence but extinction of the host community. "Their hosts, who ordinarily should be their friends for accommodating them, are slaughtered with reckless abandon". This goes to prove that even with the dawn of democracy in Nigeria and with the 1999 Federal Constitution (as amended), the settlers-indigenes question is still prevalent in the operation of the country's federal system of government. However, in what specific ways does the 1999 Constitution (as amended) lack the power to solve settlers-indigenes problem in Nigeria?

6.3: The 1999 Constitution and the Settlers-Indigenes Question

Ideally, a constitution, which serves as a basic institutional framework of government, is supposed to define the relations between rulers and the ruled, the rights and duties of citizens, and many important procedures are to be followed in connection with those matters in which all are carefully set out. However, as if the challenges Nigeria has with settlers-indigenes dichotomy were not enough, the promulgation of the 1999 Constitution (as amended) makes the issue worse.

The definition of a Nigerian is clearly spelt out in the 1999 Constitution, but the clarification on an indigene and a settler is still a bone of contention. The

citizenship of Nigeria can be acquired by birth, by registration, and by naturalisation (Sections 25, 26 and 27 of the 1999 Constitution, as amended). Consequently, as a citizen of Nigeria, every Nigerian has a right to freedom from discrimination. In Section 42, Subsections 1 and 2:

1. It is stipulated unequivocally that a citizen of a particular community, ethnic group, place of origin, sex, religion, or political opinion shall not, by any reason only that he is such a person:

- be subjected either expressly by, or in the practical application of, any law in force in Nigeria or any executive or administrative action of the government, to disabilities or restrictions to which citizen of Nigeria of other communities, ethnic groups, places of origin, sex, religions, or political opinions are not made subject; or
- be accorded either expressly by, or in the practical application of, any law in force in Nigeria or any executive or administrative action any privilege or advantage that is not accorded to citizens of Nigeria of other communities, ethnic groups, places of origin, sex, religions, or political opinions.

2. No citizen of Nigeria shall be subjected to any disability or derivation merely by reason of the circumstances of his birth.

In essence, the Constitution does not accord any special privileges to any Nigerian living in any part of the country. Also, it does not allow any Nigerian to be discriminated against because the individual comes from a specific part of the country. This therefore means that a Nigerian regardless of where he lives is a citizen of the country as long as the parents or grandparents are Nigerians. Apart from this, as a citizen of the country, such individuals are free to live and work

anywhere in the Federal Republic of Nigeria. In practical terms, this is not the situation in the country.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the settlers-indigenes question in Nigeria poses significant challenges to the country's federalism and political development. The unique political system of Nigeria, combined with the manipulative skills of the political elite, has perpetuated this dichotomy for their own self-interests. The 1999 Constitution (as amended), while aiming to promote equality and non-discrimination, falls short in effectively addressing the issue. The historical legacy of ethnic divisions and the colonial strategy of divide and rule have further exacerbated the problem. The consequences of the settlers-indigenes question are evident in ethnic conflicts, political crises, and social disunity. To achieve true unity in diversity, it is crucial for Nigeria to confront and resolve this long standing issue, fostering a sense of inclusivity, equal rights, and shared national identity among its diverse population.

Summary

The following are what you have learned:

1. Nigeria's political system is unique, with distinct characteristics and practices compared to other countries, particularly in its federal presidential-democracy.
2. The definition of who is considered a Nigerian varies between being a citizen of the country and being recognized as a bonafide Nigerian in a specific

state, leading to the settlers-indigenes dichotomy.

3. The settlers-indigenes question in Nigeria is a significant challenge to federalism and political development, perpetuated by the manipulative skills of the political elite.
4. The 1999 Constitution (as amended) aims to prevent discrimination and promote unity, but it lacks the power to effectively address the settlers-indigenes issue.
5. Ethnic conflicts, political crises, and social disunity are consequences of the settlers-indigenes question in Nigeria.
6. The historical legacy of ethnic divisions and the colonial strategy of divide and rule have contributed to the exacerbation of the settlers-indigenes problem.
7. It is crucial for Nigeria to confront and resolve the settlers-indigenes issue, promoting inclusivity, equal rights, and a shared national identity among its diverse population.

Self-Assessment Questions (SAQ)

SAQ6.1. How does Nigeria's political system differ from other countries, particularly in terms of its federal presidential-democracy? (Tests learning outcome 6.1)

SAQ6.2. What factors contribute to the unique practice of Nigeria's federal-democracy, despite similarities in constitutional theory with countries like the United States? (Tests learning outcome 6.1)

SAQ6.3. How does the settlers-indigenes dichotomy in Nigeria's political landscape affect the country's federalism? (Tests learning outcome 6.2)

SAQ6.4. What role do the political elite play in perpetuating the settlers-indigenes question in Nigeria? (Tests learning outcome 6.3)

SAQ6.5. How does the 1999 Constitution (as amended) address the issue of discrimination and unity among Nigerians, particularly with regard to settlers and indigenes? (Tests learning outcome 6.2)

Self-Assessment Answers (SAA)

SAA6.1. Nigeria's political system differs from other countries, particularly in its federal presidential-democracy, due to unique factors in its practice. While the constitutional theory may have similarities to countries like the United States, the practical implementation in Nigeria sets it apart.

SAA6.2. Several factors contribute to the unique practice of Nigeria's federal-democracy. While the constitutional framework may resemble other countries, the practical application is influenced by historical, cultural, and socio-political factors specific to Nigeria. These factors shape the dynamics of power, governance, and the relationship between settlers and indigenes within the federal system.

SAA6.3. The settlers-indigenes dichotomy in Nigeria's political landscape has a significant impact on the country's federalism. It creates challenges and complexities in defining citizenship, political rights, and the allocation of resources. The distinction between settlers and indigenes often leads to identity-based tensions, conflict, and discrimination, affecting the functioning and stability of Nigeria's federal structure.

SAA6.4. The political elite in Nigeria play a crucial role in perpetuating the settlers-indigenes question. They exploit these divisions for their own political interests, using them as tools to manipulate and consolidate power. By fueling ethnic sentiments and perpetuating a sense of "us versus them," the political elite deepen the divide between settlers and indigenes, hindering national unity and development.

SAA6.5. The 1999 Constitution (as amended) in Nigeria addresses the issue of discrimination and unity among Nigerians, including settlers and indigenes. It explicitly prohibits discrimination based on community, ethnic group, place of origin, sex, religion, or political opinion. The Constitution guarantees equal rights and privileges for all citizens, irrespective of their background. However, the effective implementation and enforcement of these provisions remain key challenges in achieving true equality and unity in Nigeria.

Tutor Marked Assignment

1. What historical factors have contributed to the heightened differences and ethnic divisions among Nigerians living across different states in the federation?
2. What are the consequences of the settlers-indigenes question on Nigeria's political development, social cohesion, and ethnic conflicts?
3. How do the manipulative skills of the Nigerian political elite exploit the settlers-indigenes dichotomy for their own self-interests?
4. In what ways does the settlers-indigenes question challenge the notion of unity in diversity in Nigeria?

Study Session 7: Concept of Trade

Introduction

International trade serves as a crucial bridge between nations, facilitating the exchange of goods, services, and resources. Throughout history, trade has played a pivotal role in meeting the diverse needs of nations and promoting their development. As no country possesses all the necessary resources to sustain a comfortable standard of living, the exchange of surplus goods for scarce ones has become an essential practice. Over time, foreign trade has evolved into a strategic tool for national economic growth, fostering social and international relations. At the global level, foreign trade establishes the foundation for regulations that fuel the process of globalisation. It is increasingly evident that a country cannot thrive in a closed, self-sufficient economy, regardless of its abundance of demographic or natural resources. In this context, the concept of international trade encompasses the exchange of capital, goods, and services across international borders, involving both government and individual activities. This trade represents a significant portion of a country's gross domestic product (GDP) in most nations. International trade is characterised by various factors, such as currency exchange, language barriers, transportation costs, and heterogeneous markets. Despite the challenges it poses, international trade holds great importance, including the full utilisation of resources, access to a wide variety of goods, disposal of surplus production, stimulation of competition and productivity, expansion of markets, technological advancement, and promotion of cooperation among nations. Alongside international trade, internal trade, also known as domestic or home trade, involves the exchange of goods

within a country's boundaries. It encompasses wholesale and retail trade, with wholesalers acting as intermediaries between manufacturers and retailers, and retailers selling products directly to consumers. Internal trade plays a crucial role in facilitating domestic exchange, ensuring the availability of goods and raw materials, and promoting industry growth. Understanding the differences and merits of international and internal trade allows for a comprehensive perspective on the complex dynamics of trade in our interconnected world.

Learning Outcomes for Study Session 7

When you have studied this session, you should be able to:

- 7.1. Understand of the historical development and importance of international trade in promoting social and international relations, including its merits and demerits.
- 7.2. Differentiate between internal trade and international trade, exploring factors like factor mobility, different currencies, and trade restrictions.
- 7.3. know the role of wholesalers and retailers in domestic trade, the significance of internal trade in promoting economic growth and ensuring raw material availability, and the complexities associated with international markets.

7.1: International Trade

International trade has been and will remain the bridge between peoples. Trade has existed since ancient times, and historical development of a nation is the result of ensuring its needs, both physical and moral, as well as intellectual. Since no country has available all the material and human resources to assure an easy life standard, the exchange of surplus goods with the scarce goods has become a particularly important practice.

Furthermore, over time, foreign trade has become a strategy for developing the national economy. It is seen as being very important from the perspective of the contribution that it brings in promoting social and international relations. At world level, foreign trade ensures the main pillars of support, determining regulations that amplify the globalisation process. It becomes more and more obvious that a country cannot exist, it is not possible to develop in a closed, autarchic economy, regardless of how rich in demographic or natural resources it is.

7.1.1: The Concept of International Trade

Arnold Kling (2012) argued that the views of economists tend to differ from those of the general public on issues concerning international trade. He noted three principal differences; first, that many non-economists believe it is more advantageous to trade with other members of one's nation or ethnic group than with outsiders. Economists see all forms of trade as equally advantageous. Second, many non-economists believe that exports are better than imports for the economy. Economists believe that all trade is good for the economy. Third, many non-economists believe that a country's balance of trade is governed by the "competitiveness" of its wage rates, tariffs, and other factors. Economists believe

that the balance of trade is governed by many factors, including the aforementioned, but also including differences in national saving and investment. However, international trade can be defined as the exchange of capital, goods and services across international borders or territories, which could involve the activities of the government and individual. In most countries, such trade represents a significant share of gross domestic product (GDP). In summary, international trade can be defined as trade between two nations or countries, it involves many factors such as foreign exchange for possibility of importation and exportation of goods and services, language barriers, transport cost etc.

7.1.2: Characteristics of International Trade

There are a number of salient qualities that international trade involves. These include the following among others:

- Human wants and countries' resources do not totally coincide. Hence, there tends to be interdependence on a large scale.
- Factors endowments in different countries differ
- Technological advancement of different countries differs. Some countries are better placed in one kind of production and some others in some other kinds of production.
- Labour and entrepreneurial skills in different countries.
- Factors of production are highly immobile between countries. The degree of immobility of factors like labour and capital is greater between countries than within a country. Immigration law, citizenship, qualification, etc. often restrict the international mobility of labour. According to Harrod, he believes that domestic

trade consists largely of exchange of goods between producers who enjoy similar standards of life, whereas international trade consists of exchange of goods between producers enjoying widely different standards.

- Heterogeneous Markets; in the international economy, world markets lack homogeneity on account of differences in climate, language, preferences, habit, customs, weights and measures, etc. The behaviour of international buyers in each case would therefore, be different.
- Different National Groups: International trade takes place between differentially coherent groups. The socio-economic environment differs greatly among different nations.
- Different Political Units: International trade is a phenomenon which occurs among different political units.
- Different National Policies and Government Intervention: Economic and political policies differ from one country to another. Policies pertaining to trade, commerce, export and import, taxation, etc., also differ widely among countries though they are more or less uniform within the country. Tariff policy, import quota system, subsidies and other controls adopted by the governments interfere with the course of normal trade
- Between one country and another.
- Different currencies: Another notable feature of international trade is that it involves the use of different types of currencies. So, each country has its own policy regarding exchange rates and foreign exchange.

7.1.3: Importance of International Trade

Some importance of International Trade are as follows:

- International trade enables the full utilisation of resources. Most of the time underdeveloped countries do not use their mineral resources efficiently; they export their raw materials to developed countries where the same are needed for the production of other goods.
- International trade makes trading partners get goods cheaper than otherwise. Because every country produces those goods in the production of which it has less comparative cost.
- By virtue of international trade consumers get an opportunity to consume a large variety of goods produced by different countries and this improves the quality of life.
- International trade enables every country to dispose of their surplus production. Some countries produce more than their own requirements. They sell this surplus production in other countries and avoid the occurrence of deflationary pressures in the domestic economy.
- International trade encourages countries to compete with each other in the production of different kinds of goods at a low cost of production. Competitiveness stimulates productivity.
- It widens the extent of the market. Every country makes an attempt to produce different goods in large quantities. This induces production on a large scale and thereby generates economies of scale.

- International trade stimulates the spirit of competition among the entrepreneurs. New techniques of production are devised to produce quality goods at low cost. Advancement of technology is the key to economic development.
- International trade promotes cooperation among different countries. It creates an atmosphere of goodwill and friendship among the trading countries. Human wants and countries' resources do not totally coincide. Hence, there tends to be interdependence on a large scale.

7.2: Internal Trade

7.2.1: The Concepts of Internal Trade

Internal trade, also known as Domestic trade or home trade is the exchange of domestic goods within the boundaries of a country. This may be subdivided into two categories, wholesale, and retail. Wholesale trade is concerned with buying goods from manufacturers or dealers or producers in large quantities and selling them in smaller quantities to others who may be retailers or even consumers. Wholesale trade is undertaken by wholesale merchants or wholesale commission agents.

Retail trade is concerned with the sale of goods in small quantities to consumers. This type of trade is taken care of by retailers. In actual practice, however, manufacturers and wholesalers may also undertake retail distribution of goods to bypass the intermediary retailer, by which they earn higher profits.

The importance or role of domestic trade in a country is that it facilitates exchange of goods within the country. By doing this it also makes sure that

factors of production get to the right places so that the economy of the country can grow. By allowing different types of goods and services to reach all parts of the country it improves the standard of living of the residents of the country as well as the employment rate of the country. And it helps the growth of an industry by ensuring the availability of raw materials.

Traders from outside the country will have to encounter internal traders, because it is not easy to come directly into another country and get the required products.

7.2.2: Wholesale Trade

Wholesalers play a major role in working of domestic trade. One could even say that it is the backbone of the domestic market. A wholesaler is one who is directly in contact with the manufacturers but in indirect contact with the consumers. A wholesaler generally deals with one type of industry. e.g., machinery, textile, stationery. A wholesaler is not only into selling products as it is also involved in packaging, advertising, grading, and market research. They have their own warehouse which saves the manufacturers from bothering about storage. They normally get cash payments from retailers and sometimes consumers themselves and give advance payments which benefit the manufacturers. They sell in smaller quantities to retailers, which refrains the retailers from requiring storage space. They allow credit facilities to retailers at times.

7.2.3: Retail trade

A retailer is normally the final seller of a product. It makes its purchases from wholesalers and sales are made to the customers directly. Retailers do not particularly have to be from one industry i.e. they can trade in a variety of products at the same time. It generally has purchases made by credit and sales made in cash. Sales as compared to wholesalers are made in small quantities.

7.2.4: Major Difference between Internal and International Trade

A controversy has been going on among economists whether there is any difference between internal or domestic trade and international or foreign trade. The classical economists held that there were certain fundamental differences between internal trade and international trade. Accordingly, they propounded a separate theory of international trade which is known as the Theory of Comparative Costs. But modern economists like Bertil Ohlin and Haberler contest this view and opine that the differences between internal and international trade are of degree rather than of kind. The following are the major differences between domestic trade and international trade:

- Factor Mobility: Labour and capital as factors of production do not move freely from one country to another as they do within the same country. Thus, labour and capital are regarded as immobile between countries while they are perfectly mobile within a country. Adam Smith said, "Man is of all forms of luggage, the most difficult to transport". Differences in cost of production cannot be removed by moving and money. The result is the movement of goods, on the contrary, between regions within the same political boundaries; people distribute themselves more or less according to the opportunities. Real wages and standard

of living tend to seek a common level though they are not wholly uniform as between nationals, these differences continue to persist and check population movements. Capital also does not move freely from one country to another country.

- Different Currencies: Each country has a different currency. Buying and selling between nations give rise to complications absent in internal trade. This hampers smooth flow of trade between one country and another country. A large number of foreign exchange problems arise in a number of foreign trade which are non-existent in internal trade.
- Different National Policies: Different needs lead countries to pursue divergent national policies and not only with respect to foreign exchange rates. National Policies differ in a wide range of domestic matters affecting international economic relations, wages, prices, competition, investment, business regulation etc and often involve interference directly in international economic intercourse in tariffs, exchange controls, non-tariff barriers and the like.
- Different Political Circumstances: Most countries differ in political circumstances. In internal trade, trade takes place among the same people. But international trade takes place among people of different cultures, habits and languages. These cultural distinctions between markets, important in the absence of different national measures, have led political scientists to take a look at the nature of countries.
- Difference in National Resources: Different countries are endowed with different types of natural resources. They tend to specialise, in the production of

those commodities in which they are richly endowed and trade them with others where such resources are scarce.

- **Geographical and Climatic Differences:** Every country cannot produce all commodities due to geographical and climatic conditions, except at possibly prohibitive costs. Countries having climatic and geographical advantage specialise in the production of commodities and trade them with others.
- **Different Markets:** International markets are different in various aspects. Even the system of weights and measures and patterns and styles in machinery and equipment differ from country to country. Goods which are traded within regions may not be sold in other countries. Therefore, in many cases products to be sold in foreign countries are especially designed to confirm the national characteristics of that country.
- **Problem of Balance of Payments:** The problem of balance of payments is perpetual in international trade while regions within a country have no such problem.
- **Restrictions on Trade:** Trade between different countries is mostly not free. There are restrictions imposed by custom duties, exchange restrictions, fixed quotas, or other tariff barriers.
- **Ignorance:** Differences in culture, language and religion stand in the way of free communication between different countries.
- **Transport and Insurance Costs:** The cost of transport and insurance also check the free international trade. The greater the distance between the two countries the greater the cost and insurance.

7.2.5: Merits and Demerits of International Trade

Merits of International Trade

The main merits of international trade to a country are as follows:

Boosts Domestic Competitiveness: Exporting or importing your products provides a good chance to increase your competitiveness within the domestic markets. Once you are to acquire imported commodities at similar or even lower costs as compared to the ones you acquire from the domestic market and the other way around, then you will certainly gain profits which will boost the level of your competence.

Increase in Profit and Sales: Once you are able to make exports from your locality or imports in same or high-quality products on the better profit margin, it is possible then for the levels of your sales to increase. And with this, you get the chance to eventually increase your profits.

Economy in the Use of Productive Resources: Each country tries to produce those goods in which it is best suited. As the resources of each country are fully exploited, there is thus a great economy in the use of productive resources.

Wider Range of Commodities: International trade makes it possible for each country to enjoy a wider range of commodities than what is otherwise open to it. The commodities which can be produced at home at relatively higher cost can be brought from the cheaper market from abroad and the resources of the country thus saved can be better employed to produce other commodities in which it is comparatively better fitted.

Scarcity of Commodities: If at any time there is shortage of food or scarcity of other essential commodities in the country, they can be easily imported from other countries and thus the country can be saved from shortage of commodities and low standard of living.

Promotes Competition: International trade promotes competition among different countries. The producers in their home country, being afraid of the foreign competition, keep the prices of their products at a reasonable level.

Speedy Industrialization: International trade enables a backward country to acquire skill, machinery; and other capital equipment from industrially advanced countries for speeding up industrialization.

Fall of Prices: A country can export her surplus products to a country which needs them. The domestic prices are, thus, prevented from falling.

Extension of Means of Transport: When goods are exchanged from one country to another, it leads to an extension of the means of communication and transport.

Economic Interdependence: International trade offers facilities to the citizens of every country to encounter one another. It makes them realise that no country in the world is self-sufficient. It thus promotes peace and goodwill among nations.

Demerits of International Trade

International trade has its own demerits/disadvantages; these in brief are as follows:

- **Exhaustion of Resources:** To earn present export advantages a country may exploit her limited natural resources beyond proper limits. This may lead to

exhaustion of essential material resources like iron, coal, oil, etc. The future generation thus stands at a disadvantage.

- Effect on Domestic Industries: If no restrictions are placed on the foreign trade, it may ruin the domestic industries and cause widespread distress among the people.
- Effect on Consumption Habits: Sometimes it so happens that the traders to make profits import commodities which are very harmful and injurious to the people. For instance, if opium, wine, etc., are imported, it will adversely affect the health and morale of the people.
- Times of Emergency: If each country specialises in the production of those commodities in which it has comparative advantage over other countries, it may prove very dangerous rather fatal during times of:
 - Long Term Process: Exports from your local, or some other productive opportunities in import export business, demand lots of time so as to be converted. So, you have to be very patient in order to gradually achieve your desired goals. In addition to this, it requires huge time investment for the business to produce strategic partnerships with various parties inside the channel.
 - Additional Licensing and Other Taxes, Regulations, etc.: Plans for import export business should not just be created after taxes, understating licensing and other relevant country regulations in which you are planning to have your audiences targeted.

Conclusion

In conclusion, international trade plays a pivotal role in the social, economic, and political landscape of nations worldwide. It has been a driving force behind the growth and development of economies, facilitating the exchange of goods and services across borders. Through international trade, countries can capitalise on their comparative advantages, harnessing their unique resources and capabilities to boost domestic competitiveness and increase profit. However, it is essential to recognize the potential drawbacks and challenges associated with international trade, such as the strain on resources and the impact on domestic industries. Nonetheless, by understanding the complexities of international markets, including cultural distinctions and logistical considerations, nations can harness the benefits of international trade to widen their commodity range, stimulate competition, and foster cooperation among different countries. Embracing international trade and its nuances is crucial for nations to thrive in an increasingly interconnected and interdependent world.

Summary

The following are what you learned:

1. International trade plays a vital role in the social, economic, and political aspects of nations worldwide.
2. It facilitates the exchange of goods and services across borders, contributing to economic growth and development.

3. Comparative advantages allow countries to leverage their unique resources and capabilities for competitive advantage.
4. International trade presents challenges, such as resource strain and impacts on domestic industries, which must be considered.
5. Understanding cultural distinctions and logistical considerations is crucial for navigating international markets successfully.
6. International trade widens the commodity range, stimulates competition, and fosters cooperation among nations.
7. Embracing international trade and its complexities is essential for nations to thrive in an interconnected world.

Self-Assessment Questions (SAQ)

- SAQ7.1.** What role does international trade play in the social, economic, and political aspects of nations? (Tests learning outcome 7.3)
- SAQ7.2.** How does international trade contribute to economic growth and development? (Tests learning outcome 7.3)
- SAQ7.3.** What are comparative advantages, and how do they influence international trade? (Tests learning outcome 7.1)
- SAQ7.4.** What challenges are associated with international trade, and how can they be addressed? (Tests learning outcome 7.2)

Self-Assessment Answers (SAA)

- SAA7.1.** International trade plays a crucial role in the social, economic, and political aspects of nations. Socially, it fosters cultural exchange, encourages diversity, and promotes understanding among nations. Economically, it enables countries to access a wider range of goods and services, stimulates economic

growth, creates job opportunities, and boosts productivity. Politically, international trade can enhance diplomatic relations, promote cooperation, and contribute to geopolitical stability.

SAA7.2. International trade contributes significantly to economic growth and development. By allowing countries to specialise in producing goods and services that they have a comparative advantage in, international trade promotes efficiency and productivity. It expands market opportunities, increases access to resources and technology, encourages innovation, and facilitates economies of scale. Additionally, trade liberalisation and the removal of trade barriers can lead to increased foreign direct investment, which further drives economic growth and development.

SAA7.3. Comparative advantages refer to the abilities of countries to produce goods or services at a lower opportunity cost compared to other nations. Each country has different factors of production, such as natural resources, labour skills, and technology, which determine its comparative advantages. These advantages influence international trade by guiding countries to specialise in producing goods and services in which they are relatively more efficient. Through specialisation and trade, countries can maximise their overall output, achieve higher levels of efficiency, and benefit from the diverse range of products available in the global market.

SAA7.4. International trade also presents challenges that nations need to address. Some of these challenges include trade imbalances, protectionism, unfair trade practices, and the potential for job displacement in certain industries. To address these challenges, countries can promote fair trade policies, negotiate

and enforce trade agreements that ensure a level playing field, and establish mechanisms for dispute resolution. Additionally, investing in education, training, and job transition programs can help mitigate the negative impacts of trade on certain sectors and workers. Cooperation among nations through international organisations like the World Trade Organization (WTO) can also play a role in addressing trade-related challenges and fostering a more inclusive and sustainable global trading system.

Tutor Marked Assignment

1. What factors should be considered when navigating international markets?
2. How does international trade impact the commodity range, competition, and cooperation among nations?
3. Why is it important for nations to embrace international trade in today's interconnected world?

Study Session 8: Economic Self-Reliance

Introduction

Current thinking about economic development has not bettered global livelihoods. Speaking at the 2007 annual meeting of the American Economics Association, Professor Simon Johnson of MIT invoked a powerful metaphor to highlight the failure of existing models; he noted that sustained progress in health and sanitation came only after “public health had the germ theory of disease. Economics has made great progress, but it’s still waiting for its ‘germ theory of disease’”. Without a solid model, economic development models produce hit-and-miss successes.

Creating economic development represents more than the mere academically elegant exercise of theory building. Pragmatically, ineffective development models mean that real money is being granted, loaned, or invested without any real, sustainable return. Economically, the lives of billions are lived out in misery and despair while many tools of better living are readily available. At a very basic level all of us suffer because social justice is not being achieved and the spiritual talents and gifts of far too many lie fallow and undeveloped.

Learning Outcomes for Study Session 8

When you have studied this session, you should be able to:

1. Understand the concept of economic self-reliance (ESR) and its significance in economic development, including the importance of resilience to withstand economic shocks.
2. Recognize the dimensions and determinants of economic self-reliance, including institutional, social, economic, and human capital, and analyse their role in fostering ESR.
3. Evaluate the limitations of traditional thinking about economic development and the advantages of adopting an ESR-focused approach, using the stock and flow model to measure and evaluate the four types of capital in the context of economic self-reliance.

8.1: What is Economic Self-Reliance?

Economic self-reliance (ESR) represents a different way of thinking about the processes and outcomes of economic development. ESR is an individual's ability to garner and hold economic resources more than their basic needs.

The concept of ESR recognizes that there are individuals who are unable (due to physical or mental disability) to garner any surplus resources, individuals with surpluses large and secure enough to meet any conceivable need, and individuals at every point in between. ESR affects the entire spectrum.

ESR is also context specific; what constitutes "basic needs" for someone in a developed country will differ drastically from someone in a developing country. But the core principles of economic development are the same throughout the world.

8.2: Why is ESR Important?

Individuals who are economically self-reliant have greater resilience in the face of negative economic shocks. Those with greater resilience will suffer lower intensity (less severe) or shorter duration (quicker recovery). ESR represents a type of insurance against the disruptions caused by adverse economic events.

More important than its insurance value, ESR provides a solid platform from which people can develop and reach their full human potential. Once people possess a sustainable surplus, they can turn their attention to the pursuit that psychologist Abraham Maslow termed self-actualization: developing and expressing talents, skills, emotions, and values to the fullest extent. It's hard to reach our full potential when we are worried about our next meal.

8.3: What Determines an Individual's Level of ESR?

Economic self-reliance arises from two sources:

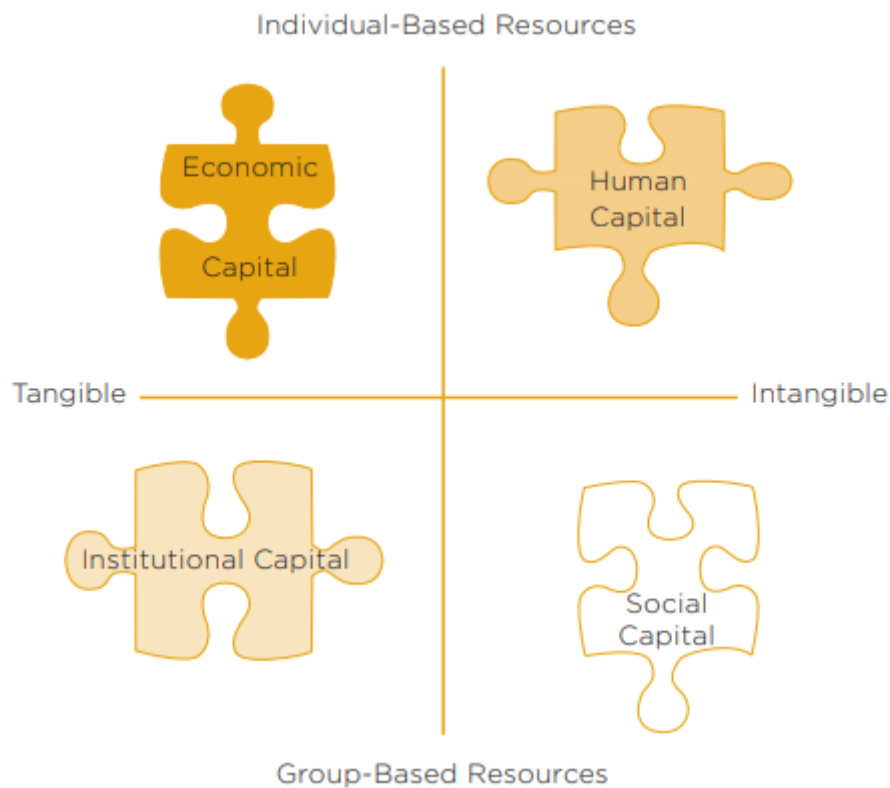
- Our own efforts, talents, and skills and
- Our relationships with family, friends, government, and macrosocial systems.

This dimension of ESR is the individual-social locus continuum.

Another dimension considers the types of resources that individuals and social units use. On one hand, resources may be very tangible, such as the amount of money in a savings account. On the other hand, resources may be very intangible and hard to measure, such as the quality of family relationships; but they are very real. These elements can be captured on the tangible-intangible resource continuum.

Taking these two dimensions together, we can categorise the determinants of economic self-reliance, as shown in Figure 8.1 below.

Figure 8.1: The Capital Accounts of ESR



The dimensions create four separate quadrants, each with its own element that contributes to economic self-reliance. We choose to describe these elements as forms of capital—accumulated wealth that can be productively employed to create more wealth. Table 8.1 reviews the definition, elements, and drivers of each type of capital.

Institutional capital represents tangible, societal-based resources and is the sum total of the macrosocial resources available to an individual. It captures the strength or weakness of the system a person lives in. Institutional capital comes in two broad types: physical and systemic resources.

Physical resources include the physical geography of a country (e.g., mountain or coastal), the physical infrastructure (e.g., roads and bridges), and the technological infrastructure (e.g., wired, or wireless connectivity).

Systemic resources include features of the governmental system, such as political stability and the level and extent of regulation. Systemic resources also include less tangible, but readily observable, societal-level features, such as the basic economic orientation of the system (e.g., market or Marxist), the religious culture and history of the society, as well as any other important cultural traditions that dictate or affect economic activity.

Social capital lies in the social intangible quadrant and is the sum total of resources available to an individual by virtue of the strength of relationships between an individual and other social units. Social capital can be broken down into two types: network and membership resources. Network resources come from the relationships that a person develops and maintains. Important network relationships include family ties (both nuclear and extended), personal friendships, and education or employment colleagues.

Membership resources arise by virtue of an individual's affiliation with some recognized social group, including ethnic or religious groups, civil or community groups, and educational affiliations.

Economic capital stands in the tangible-individual quadrant and is the sum total of the financial and physical resources possessed by an individual. It refers to not only the contents of a person's wallet, but also the contents of his/her safety deposit box and his/her cupboards and shelves. Economic capital comes in two forms: liquid and physical assets.

The most liquid asset is cash, but other types of assets can be turned into cash fairly easily. These include savings account balances, stocks or bonds, home equity or other personal property, and insurance policies. Physical assets include tangible property, such as a home or an apartment lease, an automobile, clothing, and stockpiles of items that may be useful during an economic disruption like food, water, and hygiene supplies. Human capital lies in the individual-intangible quadrant and represents the final form of capital that helps individuals develop economic self-reliance. Human capital is the sum total of attitudes, cognitive abilities, and deployable skills possessed by an individual. Human capital can be described as what is in an individual's head (knowledge), hands (skills), and heart (attitudes). Human capital is represented by knowledge and skill and attitude. Precisely measuring knowledge and skill can be difficult; however, an individual's innate intelligence is one measure. The level and extent of formal education—including any degrees or certificates, apprenticeships, and on-the-job training – helps in assessing what skills an individual possesses. The attitude component of self-reliance includes things pertaining to an individual's levels of self-efficacy, responsibility, perseverance, hopefulness and optimism, and fear and anxiety. It also considers views about current consumption versus saving for the future.

Table 8.1: The Four Types of Capital That Drive ESR

	Institutional Capital	Social Capital	Economic Capital	Human Capital
Locus of activity	Social Group	Social Group	Individual	Individual
Types of resource	Tangible	Intangible	Tangible	Intangible
Definition	The system you live in	The relationships you have	The stuff in your wallet	The stuff in your head, heart, and hands
Elements	Physical (e.g., roads, telephone, laws)	Network (e.g., family, friends, professional acquaintances)	Liquid (e.g., cash, investments, insurance)	Knowledge (e.g., education, training, degrees)
	Systemic (e.g., government, education, religious beliefs)	Membership (e.g., ethnic religious group)	Physical (e.g., housing, food, autos, fuel)	Attitudes (e.g., perseverance, responsibility)

Enhancers	Political stability, market orientation	Nurturing families, civil society organisations	Wages in excess of survival, access to financial services	Health systems, non-subsistence culture and values
Inhibitors	Corruption, incentive-destroying safety nets	Parasitic families, physical distance, tribal animosity	Debt, unemployment, low wages, instability	Discrimination, lack of resource husbandry, low motivation

8.3.1: How Would We Measure the Four Types of Capital and Self-Reliance?

The best way to measure the four types of capital is by using what economists refer to as a stock and flow model. This is the same way that analysts look at the performance of a business firm; they look at the balance sheet, which represents the different capital stocks at any given time, and the income statement, which captures the resource inflows and outflows and the residual that can be added to the existing capital stock. The balance sheet metaphor raises another important characteristic of the four types of capital: a balance sheet contains both assets (positive capital) and liabilities (negative capital). The overall stock for any type of capital will be the total of the assets less the liabilities. It is possible to have either positive or negative values in the various capital accounts. The advantage of the capital accounts model is twofold. First, by identifying comparative assets and

liabilities in the capital account, policy makers, business leaders, and NGO directors can plan more effective interventions. Second, just like a business's balance sheet, the ability to track each element over time helps provide a picture of the economic development process within that capital account.

8.3.2: Why is ESR better than Current Thinking about Economic Development?

The four types of capital build a holistic picture of development— one that is multi-level (from individuals to institutions), multi-type (considering both tangible and intangible resources), and multidisciplinary (combining the best of economic, psychological, sociological, legal, political, and theological thinking). Poverty and its related evils are a complex problem; the four types of capital present a complex model from which to view these problems.

Traditional thinking about development believes that if resources flow in (garnered), then capital stocks will rise (held). The negative entries (liabilities) in each capital account point out why garnering resources does not equal holding them. With more liabilities than assets—a case that describes several individuals, families, and countries— the net effect is that resource inflows may lead to worsening, rather than improving, the capital account. ESR differs from traditional development economics because it deals explicitly with the need for individuals (and families, social groups, and nations) to hold resources, not just garner them.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the concept of economic self-reliance (ESR) offers a transformative perspective on economic development. By encompassing multiple dimensions and determinants of self-reliance, including institutional, social, economic, and human capital, ESR provides a comprehensive framework for understanding and fostering sustainable progress. The emphasis on resilience and the ability to navigate economic shocks highlights the importance of individuals and societies holding resources rather than merely garnering them. By acknowledging the interconnectedness of various factors and adopting a multidisciplinary approach, ESR offers a promising alternative to traditional thinking about economic development. By striving towards economic self-reliance, individuals and communities can unlock their full potential, cultivate social justice, and pave the way for a future marked by prosperity and fulfilment for all.

Summary

The following are what you learned:

1. Economic self-reliance (ESR) is a different approach to economic development that focuses on individuals' ability to acquire and maintain economic resources beyond basic needs.
2. ESR recognizes the varying levels of resource acquisition and applies to individuals across the spectrum, considering context-specific definitions of "basic needs" in different countries.

3. ESR is important because it provides resilience against economic shocks, reducing the severity and duration of their impact, while also enabling individuals to reach their full potential and pursue self-actualization.
4. The determinants of ESR lie in two dimensions: individual efforts, talents, and skills, and relationships with family, friends, government, and macrosocial systems.
5. The four types of capital that drive ESR are institutional capital (tangible societal-based resources), social capital (intangible resources derived from relationships), economic capital (financial and physical resources), and human capital (knowledge, skills, and attitudes).
6. Measuring the four types of capital follows a stock and flow model, similar to analysing a business firm's balance sheet, and helps in planning effective interventions and tracking progress over time.
7. ESR offers a holistic and multidisciplinary perspective on economic development, considering multiple levels, types of resources, and disciplines, presenting a complex but comprehensive model for addressing poverty and related issues.
8. Traditional thinking about development, focused solely on resource garnering, falls short as it neglects the importance of holding resources for sustainable development, making ESR a valuable alternative approach.

Self-Assessment Questions (SAQ)

SAQ8.1. What is the concept of economic self-reliance (ESR) and how does it differ from traditional approaches to economic development? (Tests learning outcome 8.1)

SAQ8.2. How does economic self-reliance contribute to individual resilience in the face of economic shocks? (Tests learning outcome 8.2)

SAQ8.3. What are the dimensions that determine an individual's level of economic self-reliance? (Tests learning outcome 8.2)

SAQ8.4. How can institutional capital, social capital, economic capital, and human capital be measured within the framework of ESR? (Tests learning outcome 8.2)

SAQ8.5. What role does each type of capital play in fostering economic self-reliance? (Tests learning outcome 8.3)

Self-Assessment Answers (SAA)

SAA8.1. The concept of economic self-reliance (ESR) revolves around an individual's ability to acquire and maintain economic resources beyond their basic needs. Unlike traditional approaches to economic development that primarily focus on resource garnering, ESR emphasises the importance of individuals holding resources rather than simply acquiring them. It recognizes that sustainable progress requires individuals to possess and manage resources effectively, leading to greater autonomy and resilience.

SAA8.2. Economic self-reliance contributes to individual resilience in the face of economic shocks by providing a solid platform and resources that act as a

buffer against adverse events. Individuals who are economically self-reliant are better equipped to withstand and recover from negative economic shocks, experiencing lower intensity or shorter duration of the impacts. The ability to access and hold resources helps individuals navigate through challenging times and reduces their vulnerability to economic disruptions.

SAA8.3. The dimensions that determine an individual's level of economic self-reliance include their own efforts, talents, and skills, as well as their relationships with family, friends, government, and macrosocial systems. These dimensions can be visualised as the individual-social locus continuum, which considers the interplay between personal agency and the support provided by social networks and institutions. Additionally, the types of resources utilised by individuals and social units, captured on the tangible-intangible resource continuum, also influence economic self-reliance.

SAA8.4. Institutional capital, social capital, economic capital, and human capital can be measured within the framework of ESR by employing a stock and flow model. This model evaluates the balance sheet of each capital type, considering both assets and liabilities. For instance, institutional capital can be assessed by examining physical resources like infrastructure and technological connectivity, as well as systemic resources such as political stability and level of regulation. Similarly, social capital can be measured by analysing network resources (relationships developed and maintained) and membership resources (affiliation with recognized social groups). Economic capital involves evaluating liquid assets (cash, investments) and physical assets (property, possessions),

while human capital is assessed through knowledge, skills, and attitudes possessed by individuals.

SAA8.5. Each type of capital plays a crucial role in fostering economic self-reliance. Institutional capital provides the societal-based resources and the strength of the system within which individuals operate. It encompasses physical resources like geography and infrastructure, as well as systemic resources such as governmental stability and economic orientation. Social capital, on the other hand, relies on the strength of relationships and networks individuals maintain, enabling access to resources, support, and opportunities. Economic capital represents the financial and physical resources possessed by individuals, including liquid assets and tangible possessions. Finally, human capital, comprising knowledge, skills, and attitudes, equips individuals to develop their potential and pursue self-actualization. Each type of capital contributes to individuals' ability to hold and leverage resources, thereby enhancing their economic self-reliance.

Tutor Marked Assignment

1. How does the stock and flow model help in understanding and evaluating the progress of economic self-reliance?
2. In what ways does ESR offer a more comprehensive and multidisciplinary perspective on economic development compared to traditional thinking?
3. How can ESR contribute to the achievement of social justice and the fulfilment of individual potential?
4. What are some of the inhibitors and enhancers that can impact the different types of capital and hinder or promote economic self-reliance?
5. How does ESR address the complexities of poverty and related issues by considering multiple levels and types of resources?

Study Session 9: Citizenship Education in Nigeria

Introduction

Leadership and followership have manifested in diverse forms and varied over time and space. Some examples of leadership positions include, class monitor, head-teacher, school principal, vice-chancellor, state governor and executive president, just to mention a few. On the other hand, some of the nomenclatures that express varied forms of followership include members, devotees, supporters, disciples, spectators, and citizens, among other things. Just as each of the terms listed above can be used more appropriately in reference to specific manifestations of followership and leadership respectively, so does the term citizenship refer more aptly to followership under a particular kind of socio-political environment.

Learning Outcomes for Study Session 9

When you have studied this session, you should be able to:

- 9.1. Identify various forms of leadership positions and followership roles in different contexts and periods, and analyse the historical evolution of citizenship from ancient societies to contemporary nation-states.
- 9.2. Understand the concept of citizenship and its relationship to allegiance and protection by the state, recognizing the varying degrees of implementation of citizenship rights and responsibilities based on political philosophies and governance systems.

9.3. Evaluate the consequences of a government's failure to fulfil its responsibilities and the resulting civil disobedience, and explore ways to demonstrate patriotism, combat corruption, and foster a responsible citizenry through different platforms for citizenship education.

9.1: Definition of Citizenship

Citizen as defined by the Collins English dictionary, simply refers to a member of a nation-state who owes allegiance to the state and is in turn entitled to protection by the state. Since the details of what constitutes the citizen's terms of allegiance and what constitutes his protective entitlements are perceived differently across time and space, the degrees of implementation tend to vary from one country to another depending largely on the political philosophy that governs respective states. Generally speaking, nation-states that lean more in the direction of socialism tend to hold the government and the government more accountable to one another, as compared to nation-states that practise liberal democracy.

Citizenship as a concept has been in existence from the very distant past. In the ancient Greco-Roman and Egyptian societies for instance, the term was merely used to differentiate those whose biological ascendancy could be traced to the original settlers, from the captured slaves who were considered to be sub-human. This perception and usage of the term has however altered significantly in contemporary times, following the evolution of modern nation states, and the emergence of more clearly defined responsibility of the respective governments to the governed, and vice versa. Citizenship is therefore seen more from the perspective of the amply stated or implied social contract, which binds the government of a sovereign nation state to its citizens, and also binds the citizens to the government.

The failure of any government to fulfil its part of this contract gradually weakens its legitimacy, and this manifests in various forms of civil disobedience. However, once citizens are convinced that a government has sufficiently fulfilled its

responsibilities, they tend to be more patriotic. One way in which we can demonstrate patriotism in Nigeria is to join hands with the Economic and Financial Crimes Commission EFCC in the fight against corruption and bribery. This should be done while bearing in mind that the main causes of bribery and corruption include, government official bureaucracy, undue influence, unnecessary delay, false style of living, and frequent creation of artificial scarcity of essential commodities.

Nigerians are therefore expected to avoid bribery and corruption. Students, lecturers, police, soldiers, friends, families, etc. should cooperate with relevant government agencies to tackle these ugly practices in Nigerian society. Similarly, cultism should be stamped out of our tertiary institutions of learning. This is because cultism is an evil association that is capable of destroying one's career and can also ruin one's life. Even beyond the individual level, cultism can be a stumbling block to Nigeria's quest for peace and prosperity.

Furthermore, a patriotic citizen is expected to steer clear of vices like political violence and all forms of malpractices. Political thuggery and gangsterism have become too frequent in Nigeria simply because the Nigerian politicians usually recruit, train and arm our teeming youth and then use them as thugs in their political campaigns. It is however interesting that some of those that were used as thugs are now turning round to intimidate their former pay masters. Thugs who have been trained in the art of using modern weapons are now using the weapons at their disposal negatively. This partly explains the recurrent militancy in the northeast and Niger Delta regions respectively. Some of them even end up as armed robbers that terrorise our highways, towns, and cities. Examination

Malpractices on the other hand have become endemic in our nation's institutions. Many students have perfected ways of cheating in examinations. Some students now use the products of modern technological innovation like the GSM handsets, calculators, to perpetrate cheating in examinations. Consequently, governments at various levels have enacted laws and penalties to curb examination misconducts. In addition, from the legal consequence students should understand that cheating in examinations will ultimately bring disgrace to parents, friends, relations and themselves.

Etymologically, the word education is of Latin origin where it derives from *educere*, which means to rear, breed, or nurture. The two main categories of education are formal and informal education, respectively. While the latter is usually acquired on-the-go without the need for any criteria, the former is only possible where certain minimum prerequisites are guaranteed. Citizenship education is imparted through both systems of education.

Citizenship Education entails all efforts made by respective countries (through formal and informal means) to keep the citizens adequately informed about the terms of relationship between the government and the citizens. Such information usually spells out in unambiguous terms citizen's responsibilities to the state which is known as 'Civic Responsibilities. It also defines the responsibilities of the government to the citizens.

Both sides of responsibilities are collectively known as 'Social Contract', and it is only when this social contract is well respected by both the government and the citizens that a government can be described as having legitimacy. Once a government begins to lose legitimacy, the main political actors begin to fear for

their safety in the midst of ordinary citizens. They therefore require a greater degree of security men and devices around themselves. Such security men tend to be oppressive towards other citizens, and this often worsens the degree of mistrust between the political actors and the citizens.

9.2: Platforms for Acquiring Citizenship Education

As a corollary of the foregoing, it can be deduced that citizenship education is acquired through formal and informal means. Since this sort of education is targeted at the entire populace with the exception of aliens, it means that diverse approaches need to be adopted in order to reach every social class, cultural segment, and political divide, within the society. Citizenship education is usually achieved through certain key platforms, which include, the home, school, mass media, government propaganda, and political parties. Each of these platforms are discussed more extensively as presented below.

9.2.1: Home

The home in this case refers not only to one's nuclear family, but the entire extended biological relations and neighbourhood where one was raised as a growing child. A growing child begins to learn informally and subconsciously about social contract between the government and the governed, as he or she listens to what the adults say and do as part of their expectations from government, and responsibilities to the same. A growing child will for instance watch adult members of his nuclear family, extended family, or even visiting neighbours, talk about issues such as participation in voting, census, heavy tax burden, law enforcement agents, etc. The child may pose questions from time to

time on each of these issues out of curiosity. In other cases, explanations are offered to others while the child is present.

Ultimately, the child begins to have the basic understanding about some of these issues without necessarily understanding their complex relationship in terms of social contract between the state and its citizens. By and large, the level of citizenship education that is attainable in any given home depends on the social status of the parents. Children born to elite parents are more likely to be better informed about citizenship from their homes than children from underprivileged backgrounds.

9.2.2: School

The school remains the most credible platform for offering a well -rounded formal education on all subjects including citizenship education. In Nigeria for instance, every knowledge pertaining to citizenship education that is considered appropriate for a primary school pupil is usually contained in the social studies curriculum. As the child advances further into adolescent stage in the secondary school preparatory to his attainment of adult status at the age of eighteen (18), he is introduced to the basic elements of governance and citizenship. Those who gravitate towards the arts and social science are usually more grounded in the *modus operandi* of governance, especially when they study the subject known as 'Government'. For those who may not be inclined to study in this direction, they take advantage of their improved ability to read, write, and speak English confidently.

With this ability, they easily learn about the basic elements of governance and citizenship through interpersonal interactions in addition to messages frequently put out through print and/or electronic media.

9.2.3: Mass media

Even though citizenship education is supposed to be done without any iota of prejudice by the media houses as part of their social responsibility, media houses are more often than not, influenced by their ownership structure, which in turn dictates their respective in-house policies. Consequently, citizenship education as disseminated by the print and electronic media houses tend to be lopsided in their presentation of citizenship education. They do this by emphasising more on the responsibility of government to the citizens when their in-house policy is not favourably disposed towards a particular government in power. On the other hand, they tend to emphasise more on civic responsibilities when they are favourably disposed towards a particular government in power. Even though a well-informed and discerning reader/listener should be able to detect such imbalance in reportage, not all members of the public are of the same status. Majority of the listeners and/or readers in most developing countries including Nigeria, unfortunately rely almost entirely on whatever information they get from the mass media.

9.2.4: Government Propaganda

Government propaganda makes use of every available avenue of getting the desired information across to the people. This is done for instance through radio, television, newspapers, posters, banners, handbills, and lately the internet. The bottom line is that each of them is sponsored and paid for with taxpayer's money.

And this is done with the intention of swinging public opinion in favour of the government. Although the ministry of information usually takes responsibility for government sponsored propaganda in Nigeria, but beginning from the late 1980s, the federal government established an agency known as

Mass Mobilization for Social and Economic Recovery (MAMSER), which has now metamorphosed to the National Orientation Agency (NOA). In carrying out its functions over the years this agency has been placing undue emphasis on the duties of the citizen to the state, while de-emphasizing the duties of the state to the citizen. This is arguably done deliberately in a bid to create a docile and submissive followership, while creating a soft-landing government in the event that it fails in carrying out its responsibilities to the citizens.

9.2.5: Political parties

Political parties usually engage in citizenship education both intentionally and unintentionally. They do this intentionally when they occasionally organise public lectures, workshops, symposia, etc., aimed at sensitising the voting public on the responsibility of government to the citizens. In some rare cases, they also educated the citizens on their own responsibility to the state during such talk-shows. On the other hand, they carry out citizenship education unintentionally when in their frantic effort to discredit rival political parties, they rehash all the responsibilities of a government to the governed. This is commonly done at the time of electioneering campaigns

Conclusion

It has so far been demonstrated that citizenship education is acquired both formally and informally in Nigeria as in all other places. This is usually done through the home, schools, mass media, and government propaganda and the activities of political parties, respectively. While the school system provides the objectively most balanced citizenship education, the mass media provides the most effective citizenship education in terms of wide coverage. In order for Nigeria to achieve optimal citizenship education, teaching sessions on the subject of citizenship education recorded from schools should be disseminated through the print and electronic media for public consumption.

Summary

The following are what you learned:

1. Leadership and followership have taken various forms throughout history and across different regions.
2. Examples of leadership positions include class monitor, head-teacher, school principal, vice-chancellor, state governor, and executive president.
3. Followership can be expressed through terms such as members, devotees, supporters, disciples, spectators, and citizens.
4. Citizenship refers to being a member of a nation-state and entails allegiance to the state and entitlement to its protection.
5. The understanding of citizenship and its terms of allegiance and protection varies across time and space.

6. Implementation of citizenship rights and responsibilities differs between socialist-leaning and liberal democratic nation-states.
7. Citizenship has evolved from differentiating biological descendents from captured slaves to a concept based on a social contract between the government and citizens.
8. Failure of a government to fulfil its responsibilities weakens its legitimacy and can lead to civil disobedience.
9. Patriotism can be demonstrated by joining efforts against corruption and bribery, while recognizing their causes.
10. Combating cultism in tertiary institutions is crucial for peace and prosperity.

Self-Assessment Questions (SAQ)

- SAQ9.1.** How can cultism be detrimental to Nigeria's quest for peace and prosperity? (Tests learning outcome 9.3)
- SAQ9.2.** What vices should patriotic citizens avoid, according to the text? (Tests learning outcome 9.2)
- SAQ9.3.** What are the two main categories of education mentioned in the text? (Tests learning outcome 9.1)
- SAQ9.4.** How does citizenship education impart knowledge about the relationship between the government and citizens? (Tests learning outcome 9.1)
- SAQ9.5.** What are the platforms or avenues for acquiring citizenship education mentioned in the text? (Tests learning outcome 9.3)
- SAQ9.6.** How does the home environment contribute to a child's understanding of social contract and citizenship? (Tests learning outcome 9.3)

Self-Assessment Answers (SAA)

SAA9.1. Cultism can be detrimental to Nigeria's quest for peace and prosperity in several ways. Firstly, cultism promotes violence, intimidation, and criminal activities, which disrupt the social fabric of communities and hinder economic development. Cult groups engage in activities such as extortion, drug trafficking, and armed conflicts, leading to insecurity and instability. Secondly, cultism fosters a culture of fear and mistrust among citizens, eroding social cohesion and hindering cooperation for collective progress. It undermines the principles of unity, peace, and tolerance necessary for a harmonious society. Additionally, cultism often infiltrates educational institutions, leading to academic disruptions, the victimisation of students, and the degradation of the learning environment. This further undermines the quality of education and hampers the development of human capital, which is essential for national prosperity.

SAA9.2. According to the text, patriotic citizens should avoid vices such as bribery, corruption, political violence, examination malpractices, and involvement in cultism. These behaviours are seen as detrimental to the well-being of individuals and the nation as a whole. By abstaining from these vices, patriotic citizens uphold the values of integrity, justice, fairness, and accountability, which are crucial for fostering a peaceful and prosperous society.

SAA9.3. The two main categories of education mentioned in the text are formal education and informal education. Formal education refers to the structured and systematic learning that takes place within educational institutions, such as schools and universities. It follows a curriculum and requires

certain prerequisites for enrollment. Informal education, on the other hand, is acquired through everyday experiences, interactions, and observations without the need for specific criteria. It encompasses learning that occurs in the home, community, and through various social and cultural activities.

SAA9.4. Citizenship education imparts knowledge about the relationship between the government and citizens by providing information on the rights, responsibilities, and obligations of both parties. It educates individuals about the social contract, which is the mutual agreement between the government and citizens, outlining their respective roles and expectations. Citizenship education aims to inform citizens about their civic duties, such as voting, obeying laws, and actively participating in the democratic processes. It also highlights the government's responsibility to protect citizens' rights, provide public services, and ensure the welfare of the nation.

SAA9.5. The text mentions several platforms or avenues for acquiring citizenship education. These include:

- The home environment, where children learn informally by observing and interacting with their family members, extended relatives, and neighbours who discuss civic responsibilities, government participation, and societal issues.
- Schools, which provide formal education and often include citizenship education as part of the curriculum. Social studies and government subjects are specifically mentioned as areas where citizenship education is addressed.
- Mass media, such as print and electronic media, play a role in disseminating information about citizenship and government-citizen relationships. This includes

news reports, documentaries, and other programs that raise awareness and provide civic knowledge.

- Government propaganda, which utilises various communication channels such as radio, television, newspapers, posters, and the internet to disseminate information and shape public opinion on citizenship-related matters.
- Political parties, through their public lectures, workshops, and campaigns, engage in citizenship education by discussing government responsibilities and citizen obligations, both intentionally and unintentionally.

SAA9.6. The home environment contributes to a child's understanding of social contract and citizenship through informal learning experiences. Children observe and absorb information from their parents, extended family members, and neighbours who discuss civic responsibilities, government actions, and societal issues. By listening to conversations, witnessing adults' behaviour, and asking questions, children gradually develop a basic understanding of citizenship and the relationship between the government and citizens. The social status of the parents can influence the level of citizenship education received at home, with children from privileged backgrounds more likely to have better-informed discussions and exposure to civic responsibilities.

Tutor Marked Assignment

1. What role does the school system play in providing formal citizenship education?
2. How does the mass media influence the dissemination of citizenship education, and what biases can be observed?
3. How does government propaganda impact the presentation of citizenship education?
4. How do political parties contribute to citizenship education intentionally and unintentionally?
5. What is the significance of disseminating teaching sessions on citizenship education through the media?
6. How can optimal citizenship education be achieved in Nigeria?

Study Session 10: The Nigerian Economy and National Development

Introduction

Geographically, Nigeria is the largest country in Black Africa, covering 923,770 square kilometres (356,688 square miles) with a population of approximately 200 million. It boasts the second-largest economy in Africa, with a GDP of about 441 billion US dollars. Additionally, Nigeria is the 15th largest oil-producing nation globally, holding around 37 billion barrels of oil reserves and significant gas reserves. Despite its vast potential, over 60% of the population lives in poverty, with a life expectancy of around 50 years. Around 20 million school-age children have never attended school, and more than half of the population relies on subsistence agriculture for their livelihoods.

Historically, Nigeria's diverse ethnic groups and cultural identities posed challenges to common allegiance. The British colonial administration initiated efforts to unify the various groups for national development, leading to the amalgamation of the Protectorate of Southern Nigeria with the Lagos Colony in 1906. Nigeria became a Republic in 1963, followed by a civil war from 1967 to 1970 and subsequent national crises. These challenges have hindered the country's progress towards inclusive national development.

Learning Outcomes for Study Sessions 10

When you have studied this session, you should be able to:

- 10.1. Understand the geographical and economic characteristics of Nigeria, including its size, population, GDP, oil reserves, and dependence on subsistence agriculture.
- 10.2. Recognize the challenges and disparities within Nigeria, such as high poverty rates, low life expectancy, and limited access to education.
- 10.3. Comprehend the historical context of Nigeria's ethnic diversity and the efforts towards national unification for development.

10.1: The National Development Question: Nigeria Under The Military 1966 to 1999

The concept of national development is usually seen as economic growth. However, it is not limited to or synonymous with economic issues. It is seen as a process and changes in the Gross Domestic Product (GDP), which experts argue should be at least up to 5% annually to be considered as reasonable growth.

Economic development means several things such as expansion of output in units of production and when factors or strategies of production are used more efficiently to boost production. At a macro-level, economic growth may also involve increase in labour force, more working hours, and use of more arable land in agricultural production. At the micro-level, it involves shifts in production strategies from one crop to another as well as higher capacity utilisation which was previously underutilised. Thus, even without technical innovations, there could be economic growth in an economy, which may not necessarily imply development. In other words, economic growth and development do not mean the same thing because genuine development must begin from a certain level of simple change and proceed to complex development, such as from subsistence agricultural production to industrial revolution which is more dynamic and robust. More importantly, development implies multidimensional things and touches all aspects of human society and life. For instance, national development as used here is supposed to be a process of change in the country which translates into more meaningful living standards of the majority of the people through the enhancement of oneself esteem, the ability to freely exercise one's power of choice and freedom from servitude. It means the ability to meet one's daily basic

needs for the majority of the people and ensuring the life span of people essentially constitute the core issues of development. Thus, national development can only make sense when people are less poor, where there is social justice and equity, and when women and men have equal opportunities. In simple terms, without social progress or reasonable changes, economic development would make no sense to anybody. This is an abbreviated explanation of the concept of economic and national development which according to the UNDP involves reasonable life expectancy of Nigerians, good health status and the longevity, higher educational knowledge and attainment as well as reasonable level of income or cash liquidity for decent standard of living.

Ab initio, it may be observed that both democratically elected civilian and the military governments in Nigeria have not substantially brought about the much expected economic growth and development with the framework of the above concept of national development since independence to date so far. The truth of this claim is shown in the fact that national development has not been translated into broader issues of better living standards or social wellbeing, equality, and happiness of the vast majority of the people since 1999. National development in Nigeria can be examined in several ways as follows:

10.2: The Role of the Nigerian Military in National Development from 1966 to 1999

The first Military intervention in Nigerian politics was in a coup led by Major Chukwuma Nzeogwu in 1966. Since then, the military had remained in power till 1999 when General Abdulsalam Abubakar handed over to General Olusegun Obasanjo as elected president. For a period of 33 years between 1966 and 1999, the military phenomenon in Nigeria was punctuated by a democratically elected government under Shehu Shagari in October 1979 to 1983.

The military coup in January 1966 which ushered in the regime of General Yakubu Gowon; one of the longest military regimes in the nation's history (1966-1975) led to the cessation of Igbo in Eastern Nigeria and the (1967-1970) civil war and the unprecedented massive destruction of lives and property. By the end of the war when Nigerians woke up to the reality of the 3 Rs: Reconstruction, Reconciliation and Rehabilitations, it was like beginning the process of nation building & economic development all over. Then came the regime of Murtala Muhammed (July 1975-February 1976) but it was short-lived and followed by that of Olusegun Obasanjo (February 1976- September 1979). The euphoria of the second civilian Government in Nigeria under Shehu Shagari (October 1979- Dec. 1983) quickly died down and everybody was ready for another round of national crisis, especially of political and religious nature setting back the process of national development.

The next coup was masterminded by General Muhamudu Buhari and Idiagbon on December 31, 1983, and the regime lasted up to August 1985 and was mainly regarded by most Nigerians as government of "Muslims" especially when at last the government was handed over to another Northerner, Ibrahim Babangida on

August 27th, 1985, to August 1993, that was about eight years. It was under IBB that the Federal capital was moved from Lagos to Abuja before he reluctantly handed over power to another Northerner-General Sani Abacha for about five years beginning from November, 1993 till June 1998 almost leading the nation to a brink of disintegration because of the claim that Abiola, a Southerner won the general presidential elections but was denied; giving way subsequently to the saga of June 12th, 1994 and the Interim National Government of Shonekan came up till May 1999.

Considering the achievements of the military towards national development, some have argued that they succeeded in restoring law and order and made way for national integration and development. As their traditionally assigned role, the military further claimed they wanted to maintain professionalism and were able to check the reckless and unacceptable accumulation of the nation's wealth in a few hands *vis-a-vis* the utter neglect of the vast majority of the people. They also ensured human rights and paved the way for faster national development and above all, has kept the Nation's corporate existence especially after the civil war. The Nigerian military has also checked the poor performance of almost all the civilian regimes, the corruption of the political class, the fear of domination of one region over the other amidst the fear successive democratically elected political leaders may probe the past military leaders.

According to Major-General Gbor, the positive impact of the successive Nigerian military engagements in party-politics appear to be more on the military themselves rather than the much-desired national development. Among other things, the military did much to enhance their professionalism and national

defence, although most Nigerians have accused the military of neglecting to modernise the military barracks as well as lack of capacity building of the armed officers and men, the primitive accumulation of wealth of military officers and slow promotions from the rank and file to the top. Most Nigerians are happy to remember that it was the Nigerian military that created the 12 and later the 36 states of the Federation out of the colonial regional governments to bring development closer to the grassroots and speed up national development. It was also the Nigerian military that brought about the 1976 Local Government

Reforms and the creation of 774 Local Government Councils in the country. The military must also be commended for establishing a new Federal Capital in Abuja by moving out of Lagos traffic-jam. The military has also successfully engaged in the development of infrastructure across the country and changed the National currency to Naira and Kobo from the British Pound Sterling as well as the promotion of national integration by establishing the National Youth Service Scheme, the Federal Character Commission and Unity Schools, Universal Primary Education, and establishments of Teachers' Colleges, Secondary Schools, Colleges of Education, and more Universities. Other achievements still include the establishment of the Refineries, the Iron and Steel Rolling Plants, Hospitals, the Green Revolution, Operation Feed the Nation, Accelerated food production through the River Basin Development Authorities.

It was the military that brought about the devaluation of the Nigerian currency and the destruction of the middle class and the civil society which are very important in a growing economy like Nigeria's. The implication of this is the unprecedented growth of poverty among the vast majority of Nigerians over time

all traceable to the long presence of the military in governance. It is against this background that *Osisioma Nwoli*, summed up the lessons to be kept in view regarding the contributions of the Nigerian military in national development by saying that:

The overall result is that it has been devastating to national development, its people, laws, values, and structures. Military rule is an inverse function. They solved some problems and created new ones such as armed robbery, terrorism, institutionalised corruption and unitary federalism.

10.3: National Development in Nigeria Under Democratically Elected Government Since 1960

Bade Onimode describes the nature of the colonial economy which was handed to the newly independent country - Nigeria, as "mixed within the Keynesian framework and characterised by structural distortions and peripheral capitalism and overdependence on foreign trade mechanisms. He further argues that most of the new economic policies in Nigeria since independence were essentially policies of underdevelopment which were incapable of promoting national development. In fact, they rather continued to entrench neo-colonial dependence policies. These include Oil policy in 1967, Indigenization policy in 1977, Income policy, Austerity measures, National Economic and Empowerment and Development Strategy (NEEDS), National Poverty Eradication Programme (NAPEP), National Directorate of Employment (NDE), and so on. In between all these, different programmes of government have also been articulated to achieve the aims including Operation Feed the Nation, Green Revolution, River Basin Authorities, Poverty alleviation and Reduction. These policies were duplications

of previous ones and too much of everything without specific direction over the last 55 years. The implication of this after 1960 is shown in the slow growth rate performance in the nation's economy and high growth rate of poverty across the country.

The level of poverty in Nigeria and to what extent poverty has been reduced is another way by which to explain national development, especially under democratically elected governance since 1999 to date. As Kofi Annan has argued "good governance is perhaps the single most important factor by which to eradicate poverty and promote development". This is linked to "democracy which is a universal right that does not belong to any country or region, and that participatory governance, based on the will of the people, is the best path to freedom, growth, and development".

Apart from that, under democratic governments, there are more chances of social security which in the long run facilitate economic development through foreign investments. Although, democratic governments usually have numerous challenges and conflicting demands to contend with from the federating units, they tend to succeed and grow faster especially nations that are oil-rich like Nigeria. There is no justification why a democratically elected government like Nigeria should not develop in all ramifications. However, the country is acclaimed to be one of the richest nations in the world but remains one of the poorest with over 75 percent of the population living in absolute poverty, constituting a population of individuals who do not know where their next meal will come from throughout the year. This contradiction is partly linked to the fact that over 80 percent of Nigeria's 924,000 sq km land mass is available for agricultural

production, which if fully utilised would be a springboard for national development itself. However, out of this, only about 20 percent of land area is used for agriculture.

To make matters worse, non-oil resources are about 35 percent of Nigeria's real GDP growth since 2010. More specifically, in the last fifty years, the performance of the Nigerian economy has been more or less a staggering experience despite the discovery of Oil on the Nigerian Shores in 1957 which has brought about the general syndrome of what is termed *Dutch Disease*, implying a course in disguise. Several analysts see the general performance during the period as wasted years and loss of battle against poverty. Although all the postcolonial governments in Nigeria at federal, states and LGAs recognized the importance of the agricultural sector and situate it the National Development Plan or the fiscal plans of State governments budgets each year respectively, the role of Petroleum/Oil has become an overriding phenomenon in all aspects of national life and the GDP per cent of agriculture began to fall from 60 per cent in 1957 to 53 percent in 1960 and further down to 34 per cent in 1974 worsened further by the civil war accentuated by the droughts of the 1970s. From the beginning of the 1980s, Nigeria was importing more than 50 per cent of her food requirements which is a serious contradiction of the policy of a nation that made self-sufficiency in food production a cardinal objective towards national development. Another significant way by which to assess the performance of economic growth and national development is to look at the National Development Plans: From (1962-1968); (1970- 1974); (1975-1980); (1981-1985) involving all national development plans and fiscal policies covering the different sectors of the

economy are subsumed, ranging from agriculture to manufacturing, commerce and industry, communication, power & energy banking. The 1st Development Plan (1962-1968) represented continuity of colonial policy of expansion of commodity production from the four Regions for export without any co-ordination or drive towards transformation of the traditional economy to a modernised one. With a puny allocation of N1.4 billion out of which N183.3 million was allocated to agriculture as capital expenditure covering all levels of government, nothing much was done to put the economy to work as anticipated especially under the circumstances of war that was looming in the air. The 2nd National Development Plan (1970-1974) marked the years of the popular 3Rs (Reconciliation, Reconstruction and Rehabilitation) in Nigeria as an attempt to move the nation away from the ruins of the civil war. The 3rd National Development Plan (1975-1980) was thus incapable of revamping the battered economy and worse of all, the agricultural sector-the livewire of the economy was unable to provide adequate food and raw materials for industries. Thus indeed, the concept of self-sufficiency in food production remains mere academic exercise, even after the launching of three related programmes of National Accelerated Food Production Programme (N AFPP), Operation Feed the Nation (OFN) and the Green Revolution programme in the subsequent Development plan. These strategies created awareness among Nigerians, but because they lacked coherent planning and weakness at implementation stages did not achieve the desired results towards national development. For the OFN in particular, it meant different things to different groups of Nigerians: the urban wage earners, the agricultural experts, and the rural farmers.

According to the UNDP classification of Human Poverty Index, Nigeria ranks 80 out of 100, with 52 per cent of the population without improved water supply, over 70 percent live on less than one US Dollar per day. Furthermore, 80 percent of Nigerian children and women are malnourished. On the whole, this has pushed the nation's poverty level from 46 per cent in 1996 to about 76 per cent as the current poverty regime in both urban and rural areas.

Conclusion

From this abbreviated assessment of the Nigerian national development under the military and democratically elected governments, macro and micro economic issues were examined, in broad strokes. The National Development Plans and performance of major sectors of the Nigerian economy were also reviewed up to 1999 with emphasis on poverty reduction as an important index for discussing national development. Indeed, as far as the Nigerian sustainable economic and national development are concerned, a lot is yet to be done, and this will depend on the political will of the government in power, especially on what constitutes "good governance which is the sum-total of a transparent exercise of economic, political, social, and administrative authority in the equitable management of the state as well as its fiscal and monetary policy, its resources and how people articulate their interests to make sustainable progress.

In conclusion, it would be wrong to say that a military or democratically elected government *per se* has the final answer to national development. In fact, there are several instances in the history of other countries which may be considered as exceptions to the rule that, for example sometimes, national development may be

faster under military dictatorships than democratic regimes because of corruption, the inability of political office holders to do what is expected, politicisation of development issues etc. In the past, there was remarkable development in some countries in the Global South despite the fact that they were under military dictatorships such as Brazil, South Korea, Indonesia, Pakistan, etc. unlike in Zaire, Uganda, Nigeria and Ghana as constitutional democratic nations. Be that as it may, good governance and the entrenchment of democratic principles are some of the most strategic factors for promoting rapid socioeconomic development which currently constitutes the central element in the U N Human Development Index with focus on higher literacy/ educational achievements, life expectancy and income generating capacity to bridge socio-economic inequalities. Finally, one may insist that without good governance, there can be no sustainable development or meaningful progress in the Nigerian development process. This is because, throughout human history, the role of government remains as strategic as ever before in the development process of nation states.

Summary

The following are what you learned:

1. Nigeria is the largest country in Black Africa, with a large population and abundant natural resources, including oil reserves and gas reserves.
2. Despite its potential for development, more than 60% of the Nigerian population lives in poverty, with low life expectancy and a significant number of children out of school.

3. Nigeria's history is marked by ethnic diversity and cultural differences, which posed challenges to national unity and development.
4. The British colonial administration played a significant role in unifying the diverse ethnic groups and establishing Nigeria as a country.
5. Over the years, Nigeria has experienced changes in its political structure, transitioning from regional arrangements to the current system of 36 states.
6. Both military and civilian governments in Nigeria have struggled to achieve significant economic growth and development, with persistent issues such as corruption, poverty, and political crises.
7. The military governments implemented various policies and projects, including infrastructure development, national defence, and educational initiatives, but also faced criticism for neglecting certain areas and contributing to economic challenges.
8. Democratically elected governments have introduced economic policies and poverty reduction programs but have also struggled to alleviate poverty and achieve significant progress in national development.
9. The high level of poverty in Nigeria is a key indicator of the country's development challenges, despite its abundant natural resources and agricultural potential.
10. The dominance of the oil sector has had adverse effects on other sectors of the economy, contributing to the slow growth rate and limited agricultural development.

11. The Nigerian government's recognition of the importance of agriculture has not translated into substantial progress, with a significant portion of available land remaining unused.
12. The discovery of oil in Nigeria has brought both economic benefits and challenges, including the "Dutch Disease" phenomenon, where the overreliance on oil hinders development in other sectors.
13. The overall performance of the Nigerian economy in the last fifty years has been deemed disappointing, with a struggle to combat poverty and achieve sustainable development.
14. Good governance, democracy, and effective utilisation of resources are seen as crucial factors for eradicating poverty and promoting development in Nigeria.
15. Despite its potential, Nigeria faces significant obstacles to achieving national development, including corruption, political instability, and insufficient investment in key sectors like agriculture.

Self-Assessment Questions (SAQ)

- SAQ10.1.** What are the main challenges to national unity and development in Nigeria? (Tests learning outcome 10.2)
- SAQ10.2.** How has Nigeria's political structure evolved over the years? (Tests learning outcome 10.1)
- SAQ10.3.** What are some of the persistent issues faced by both military and civilian governments in Nigeria? (Tests learning outcomes 10.3)

SAQ10.4. What are some of the economic policies and poverty reduction programs introduced by democratically elected governments in Nigeria? (Tests learning outcome 10.2)

SAQ10.5. How has the dominance of the oil sector affected other sectors of the Nigerian economy? (Tests learning outcome 10.1)

Self-Assessment Answers (SAA)

SAA10.1. The main challenges to national unity and development in Nigeria include:

- Ethnic and religious diversity: Nigeria is composed of multiple ethnic and religious groups, which often leads to conflicts and tensions.
- Regional disparities: There are significant economic and social disparities between different regions of Nigeria, leading to feelings of marginalisation and inequality.
- Corruption: Widespread corruption undermines trust in government institutions and hampers development efforts.
- Security threats: Nigeria faces security challenges such as terrorism, insurgency, and communal clashes, which hinder national unity and development.

SAA10.2. Nigeria's political structure has undergone several changes over the years. Initially, Nigeria gained independence from British colonial rule in 1960 and adopted a parliamentary system. However, the country experienced military coups and military rule for a significant part of its history. In 1999, Nigeria transitioned to a democratic system with a presidential form of government, and it has since been governed by civilian administrations.

SAA10.3. Some persistent issues faced by both military and civilian governments in Nigeria include:

- **Corruption:** Corruption has plagued Nigerian governments at various levels, leading to embezzlement of public funds and inefficiency in public service delivery.
- **Weak institutions:** Institutions such as the judiciary, law enforcement agencies, and regulatory bodies have often been characterised by inefficiency, lack of independence, and inadequate capacity.
- **Political instability:** Nigeria has experienced frequent political transitions, military interventions, and electoral irregularities, which have hindered effective governance and policy continuity.
- **Socio-economic inequalities:** The unequal distribution of resources and opportunities has contributed to social tensions and conflicts within the country.

SAA10.4. Democratically elected governments in Nigeria have introduced various economic policies and poverty reduction programs. Some of these include:

- **National Economic Empowerment and Development Strategy (NEEDS):** Introduced in 2004, it aimed to achieve sustainable economic growth, poverty reduction, and job creation through sectoral reforms and private sector participation.
- **Agricultural Transformation Agenda:** Implemented from 2011 to 2015, it focused on transforming agriculture into a business-oriented sector, enhancing productivity, and increasing farmers' income.

- Conditional Cash Transfer (CCT) Program: Launched in 2016, it provides direct cash transfers to vulnerable households to alleviate poverty and improve social welfare.
- Microfinance and Small and Medium Enterprises (MSME) Development Fund: Established to provide financial support and capacity building for micro, small, and medium-sized enterprises, promoting entrepreneurship and economic growth.

SAA10.5. The dominance of the oil sector has had both positive and negative effects on other sectors of the Nigerian economy. The heavy reliance on oil revenue has led to neglect of other sectors such as agriculture, manufacturing, and infrastructure development. This has resulted in limited economic diversification, overdependence on imports, and vulnerability to oil price fluctuations. Additionally, the oil industry's environmental impact and the challenges of managing oil revenues have posed significant challenges to sustainable development in other sectors.

Tutor Marked Assignment

1. What are the economic benefits and challenges associated with the discovery of oil in Nigeria?
2. How would you evaluate the overall performance of the Nigerian economy in the last fifty years?
3. What factors are seen as crucial for eradicating poverty and promoting development in Nigeria?
4. What are some of the obstacles Nigeria faces in achieving national development?
5. How has ethnic diversity and cultural differences impacted Nigeria's history and development?
6. What role did the British colonial administration play in unifying Nigeria as a country?

Study Session 11: Environmental Challenges in Nigeria

Introduction

Environmental concern remains one of the critical areas of contemporary scholarship and the trend is bound to persist far into this new millennium. It has also attracted scholars from a wide range of fields of specialisation to the extent that many tend to forget that the most critical elements of the environment are geographical. Geography is concerned with a complex set of processes and relationships which generate environmental problems in man's interaction with the environment. Indeed, without a sound grasp of the geographical underpinnings of the earth's surface, that is, our living environment, the desire to solve environmental challenges associated with human activities through sound environmental management would continue to be elusive. In Nigeria the spatial-temporal distribution of environmental challenges is enormous. Nevertheless, in terms of frequency, anthropogenic challenges are more prevalent in the country. The socio-economic crisis of environmental challenges stems from man-environmental interaction. In many cases, the socio-economic crisis is the result of development styles that destroy both human potentials and the environment. This chapter, therefore, discusses the meaning, types of environmental challenges in Nigeria, causes, spatial distribution of environmental challenges in Nigeria and suggests ways of addressing environmental challenges in Nigeria.

According to B. A. Environmental challenges could be described as any crisis event that surpasses the ability of an individual, community or society to control or survive its consequences. He notes further that an environmental challenge

can be said to be an unexpected accident resulting from natural or man-made factors (or combination of both) that has a negative impact on the daily lives and living conditions of human's flora and fauna. In his own perspective, S. W. Peters defines an environmental challenge as any form of harm, danger, peril, or any risk of loss in the environment. He describes it further as any situation in nature or in the environment which is destructive or probably detrimental to man or any other component of the environment. It results from the deterioration of environmental quality. According to G. Kwame, environmental degradation in our physical world has been going on for centuries as human beings began to find ways of living on earth, which explains the fact that it emanates from natural processes that result from the interaction of man and the environment.

Learning Outcomes for Study Session 11

When you have studied this session, you should be able to:

- 11.1. Understand the interdisciplinary nature of environmental studies and the complex processes generating environmental challenges in human-environment interactions.
- 11.2. Recognize the spatial-temporal distribution of environmental challenges in Nigeria, including anthropogenic challenges and their impact across different regions.
- 11.3. Identify key approaches for addressing environmental challenges in Nigeria, involving stakeholders, collaboration, scientific assessment, risk analysis, and specific strategies like pollution abatement and resource conservation.

11.1: Types of Environmental Challenges in Nigeria

Nigeria is faced with a series of environmental challenges. However, the most common environmental problems in Nigeria are anthropogenic in nature. They result from human interference (interaction) with the environment. They occur as a result of human intent, negligence, error, or failure of the human made system. Anthropogenic hazards can be broadly classified under the titles of sociological, technical, transportation and others. Examples of sociological challenges are crime, arson, juvenile delinquency, civil disorder, terrorism, arms raise, and war. Likewise, technical environmental challenges include the industrial, structural collapse, power outage, fire, as well as hazardous materials.

Challenges resulting from transportation emanate from road, airspace, rail, sea travel, and pipelines. Other types of environmental challenges are pollution, air, and water contamination, household hazards, overgrazing, overfishing, dangerous agricultural practices and household waste.

According to A. Fatubar in, man-made problems of the environment are those problems created within the environment by man, as a result of the activities of man in the environment. He further stated that man-made hazards in Nigeria are to a large extent, technology, or culture dependent. Human activities in Nigeria have also resulted into environmental challenges like biodiversity loss, oil spillages, bush burning, urban housing problem, water scarcity, as well as pollution (water, soil, air, marine, noise, thermal, radioactive, and vehicular). Broader worries have also arisen about the environmental challenges of deforestation, urban flooding, destruction of aquatic habitats, over-exploitation of forest resources, illegal mining activities and dereliction, road transportation

mishaps as well as solid waste problems (municipal, agricultural, industrial, hazardous radioactive, and biomedical). Other forms of environmental degradation are desert encroachment, Ozone layer depletion, global warming, poor environmental sanitation, unlawful exploitation of fossil fuel resources, oil spillage, gas flaring and many other challenges related to oil exploration and production. The environmental challenges are aggravated by poverty and rapid increase in human population.

11.2: Causes of Environmental Challenges

Environmental challenges are caused mainly by natural forces and human influences, or a combination of the two. Natural causes of environmental challenges include climate, geologic, atmospheric, disease and biological factors. R. Coenraads identified the major causes of natural disasters as geological events, meteorological incidents as well as biological disasters. According to him, geological events are triggered by the inherent working of our planet while meteorological events are caused by the variation in global weather patterns and biological events are caused by actions of living agents. In a similar vein, S. W. Peters submits that while some natural disasters (e.g., volcanic eruption, earthquake and hurricane) arise from earth's inherent instability, others (e.g., mudflow, landslides and flood emanate from mass displacement of earth's materials. Similarly, R. Wright and D. F. Boorse have accounted for the causes of natural hazards under the categories of hydrological, meteorological, and geological forces.

Anthropogenic challenges are caused mainly by human interference with the environment. T. G. Miller, Jr. & S. E. Polman have identified population growth,

wasteful and unsustainable resource use, poverty, as well as insufficient knowledge of how nature works as the major causes of environmental problems. Also G.E.R. Ofomata & Phil-Eze identify the poor application of the principles of environmental management as a fundamental cause of some of the environmental challenges in Nigeria. Human activities like agriculture, fishing, livestock rearing, and hunting are mounting pressures on the environment.

Furthermore, other activities like mining and exploration for petroleum, land reclamation, overfishing, overgrazing, deforestation, hunting, as well as use of pesticides and herbicides are responsible for many environmental challenges.

11.3: Spatial Distribution of Environmental Challenges in Nigeria

Environmental problems in Nigeria are not restricted to any particular sector of the country. Like the harmattan wildfire, it acts across all regions of the country-rural and urban. Also, it cuts across the different geopolitical zones of the country. Table 11.1 below clearly shows the distribution of environmental challenges in Nigeria.

Table 11.1: Environmental Challenges in Nigeria

S/N	Natural	Man-made	Areas Most Affected
1	Drought and desertification		Sudan-Sahel Belt (Borno, Yobe, Jigawa, Kano, Bauchi, Adamawa, Katsina, Zamfara, and Kebbi States).
2	Flooding		Coastal belt, flood plains of major rivers, cities with inadequate drainage
3	Catastrophic soil erosion		Enugu, Anambra, Imo, Abia, Ondo, Ekiti, Akwa-Ibom, Ebonyi states
4	Destructive storms		All states
5	Dust storms		Sudan-Sahel Belt
6	Coastal Erosion		Lagos, Ondo, Delta, Rivers, Akwa-Ibom, Bayelsa and Cross River States
7	Earth tremors		Southwestern States.
8	Pest Invasion		All States
9	Human disease epidemic		All States

S/N	Natural	Man-made	Areas Most Affected
10	Animal disease epidemic		All States
11		Dam failure	Niger, Borno, Sokoto etc.
12		Building collapse	All States
13		Oil spillage	Niger Delta
14		Land, water, and air transport accident	All States
15		Bomb explosion	Lagos
16		Civil strike	Lagos, Kaduna, Kano, Taraba, Benue, etc.
17		Fire disasters	All States
18		Wildfires	All States

Source: F. O. Ibimilua & A. I. Ibimilua (Eds.) "Environmental Challenges in Nigeria: Typology, Spatial Distribution, Repercussions and Way Forward," in *American International Journal of Social Science*, Vol.3, No.2, 2014, p.248.

The above table shows natural and anthropological challenges in Nigeria. It also shows areas most affected.

11.4: Addressing Environmental Challenges in Nigeria

In order to save the environment from further degradation of the rich and exhaustive resources, it becomes inherent to address the challenges so as to be able to achieve environmental sustainability. Thus, overcoming environmental challenges demands the enhancement of agricultural production without compromising the natural ecosystem, strengthening of local governance for biodiversity, management of environmental resources (land, water, minerals, energy, forest wealth and biodiversity), as well as management and control of hazards.

Other environmental management techniques are the conservation of wildlife, biodiversity, energy, and population resources.

P. H. Raven, L. R. Being, & D. M. Hasenshal has convincingly reasoned that the elements which contribute to addressing environmental problems include scientific assessment, risk analysis, public education and involvement, political action, and long-term evaluation. However, they opined that solving environmental problems rarely proceeds in such a straightforward step. The subsidiaries approach for addressing environmental problems include the conservation of natural resources, pollution abatement, control of bush fires, planned industrial development, evaluation, and monitoring of radioactivity, as well as resource sharing.

Addressing environmental challenges also requires the role of the government (at national, state, and local levels), nongovernmental organisations, and community-based organisations, as well as individuals. It also necessitates the collaborative efforts of international organisations, law enforcement agencies,

academics and technocrats, the youth, the press as well as natural and multinational companies.

Conclusion

The continued existence and well-being of all living things, plants and animals depend to a large extent on the ability of man to enhance, protect, conserve, and manage the natural resources in the environment. These life supporting means are threatened by natural and anthropogenic challenges or a combination of the two. In Nigeria, different challenges are associated with various climatic, vegetation, and geologic zones. Also, there are disparities between urban problems and those of the rural areas.

Specific problems like oil spillage, coastal erosion, flooding, and pollution are also rampant in the oil producing areas. Major solutions to the environmental challenges in Nigeria are environmental education, governance of nature, formulation, and implementation of stronger laws or/and penalties, as well as the use of environmentally sound technology for the monitoring of the environment.

Summary

The following are what you have learned:

1. Environmental concern is a critical area of contemporary scholarship and is expected to persist into the new millennium. Scholars from various fields of specialisation are attracted to this area, although the geographical aspects of the environment are often overlooked.
2. Geography plays a crucial role in understanding the complex processes and relationships that generate environmental problems in human-environment interactions. Without a solid understanding of the geographical underpinnings of the Earth's surface, solving environmental challenges through sound environmental management would remain elusive.
3. Nigeria faces numerous environmental challenges, with anthropogenic challenges being the most prevalent. These challenges result from human interference and include sociological, technical, transportation, and pollution-related issues.
4. The causes of environmental challenges can be attributed to both natural forces and human influences. Natural causes include climate, geological, atmospheric, disease, and biological factors. Human activities such as agriculture, mining, fishing, deforestation, and the use of pesticides contribute significantly to environmental challenges in Nigeria.
5. Environmental challenges in Nigeria are not limited to specific regions but affect both rural and urban areas across the country. These challenges

encompass drought, flooding, soil erosion, destructive storms, coastal erosion, pest invasion, disease epidemics, and other hazards.

6. To address environmental challenges and achieve environmental sustainability, it is essential to enhance agricultural production while preserving the natural ecosystem, strengthen local governance for biodiversity, manage environmental resources effectively, and control hazards.

7. Conservation of wildlife, biodiversity, energy, and population resources are important aspects of environmental management. Solutions to environmental problems require scientific assessment, risk analysis, public education, political action, long-term evaluation, and specific approaches such as resource sharing and pollution abatement.

8. Addressing environmental challenges necessitates the involvement of government, NGOs, community-based organisations, individuals, international organisations, law enforcement agencies, academia, media, and corporations.

9. Collaboration among stakeholders is crucial for effectively addressing environmental challenges in Nigeria and finding sustainable solutions.

Self-Assessment Questions (SAQ)

SAQ11.1. What are some of the critical areas of contemporary scholarship related to environmental concern? (Tests learning outcome 11.1)

SAQ11.2. Why is it important to consider the geographical aspects of the environment when addressing environmental challenges? (Tests learning outcome 11.3)

SAQ11.3. What are the main types of anthropogenic environmental challenges prevalent in Nigeria? (Tests learning outcome 11.3)

SAQ11.4. How do human activities contribute to the environmental challenges in Nigeria? (Tests learning outcome 11.3)

SAQ11.5. What are some strategies for effective resource management and control of hazards in Nigeria? (Tests learning outcome 11.2)

SAQ11.6. How can wildlife, biodiversity, energy, and population resources be conserved in the face of environmental challenges? (Tests learning outcome 11.1)

SAQ11.7. What are the key approaches and techniques mentioned for addressing environmental challenges? (Tests learning outcome 11.3)

Self-Assessment Answers (SAA)

SAA11.1. Some critical areas of contemporary scholarship related to environmental concern include climate change and its impacts, sustainable development, conservation biology, environmental policy and governance, environmental justice, ecosystem management, renewable energy, environmental economics, and environmental ethics.

SAA11.2. Considering the geographical aspects of the environment is important when addressing environmental challenges because it helps us understand the spatial distribution, patterns, and interactions of various elements that contribute to environmental problems. Geography provides insights into the physical features, climate, ecosystems, and human activities within specific regions, which are essential for comprehending the causes and impacts of environmental challenges. By analysing the geographical context, we can develop more targeted and effective strategies to address environmental issues and tailor solutions to specific locations.

SAA11.3. The main types of anthropogenic environmental challenges prevalent in Nigeria include sociological challenges (crime, arson, juvenile delinquency, civil disorder, terrorism, arms race, and war), technical challenges (industrial accidents, structural collapses, power outages, and hazardous materials incidents), transportation challenges (road accidents, air and sea travel accidents, pipeline failures), and various forms of pollution (air pollution, water contamination, household waste, industrial waste, agricultural practices).

SAA11.4. Human activities contribute to environmental challenges in Nigeria through various means. Agriculture, mining, fishing, deforestation, and the use of pesticides and herbicides lead to biodiversity loss, soil erosion, water contamination, and disruption of ecosystems. Rapid population growth puts pressure on natural resources, leading to overgrazing, overfishing, and land degradation. Industrial activities generate pollution and waste, including hazardous materials. Additionally, unsustainable resource use, poor waste management practices, and inadequate environmental regulations further contribute to the environmental challenges faced in Nigeria.

SAA11.5. Some strategies for effective resource management and control of hazards in Nigeria include:

- Implementing sustainable resource management practices that balance resource extraction with conservation efforts. This can involve adopting responsible mining practices, promoting sustainable agricultural techniques, and ensuring proper waste management.
- Enhancing environmental regulations and enforcement to control hazardous activities and mitigate their impacts. This can involve strengthening monitoring systems, imposing stricter penalties for non-compliance, and promoting the use of cleaner technologies.
- Promoting community participation and engagement in resource management and hazard control. This can be achieved through community-based initiatives, capacity building, and encouraging local ownership and responsibility.

- Investing in research and technological innovations to develop sustainable solutions and improve resource efficiency. This can include the development of renewable energy sources, eco-friendly technologies, and sustainable waste management systems.
- Strengthening collaboration among government agencies, non-governmental organisations, and other stakeholders to coordinate efforts, share resources, and develop integrated approaches to resource management and hazard control.

SAA11.6. To conserve wildlife, biodiversity, energy, and population resources in the face of environmental challenges, the following measures can be taken:

- Establishing protected areas and wildlife reserves to safeguard habitats and biodiversity hotspots. This involves enforcing strict regulations against poaching, illegal hunting, and habitat destruction.
- Implementing sustainable land and natural resource management practices that consider the needs of wildlife and ecosystems. This can include promoting sustainable agriculture, avoiding habitat fragmentation, and restoring degraded ecosystems.
- Encouraging community-based conservation initiatives that involve local communities in the protection and sustainable use of natural resources. This can include initiatives such as community-based ecotourism, sustainable harvesting practices, and biodiversity monitoring by local communities.
- Developing and implementing renewable energy strategies to reduce dependence on fossil fuels and minimise the environmental impact of energy

production. This can involve promoting the use of solar, wind, and hydroelectric power, as well as improving energy efficiency.

- Implementing responsible population management policies that address population growth and its impact on natural resources. This can include family planning programs, education on reproductive health, and empowering women and girls.

SAA11.7. The key approaches and techniques mentioned for addressing environmental challenges include:

- Scientific assessment and research to understand the causes, impacts, and potential solutions to environmental challenges. This involves gathering data, conducting studies, and analysing findings to inform decision-making.
- Risk analysis to assess the potential risks and vulnerabilities associated with environmental challenges and identify strategies to mitigate or manage those risks.
- Public education and involvement to raise awareness about environmental issues, promote sustainable behaviours, and encourage public participation in decision-making processes.
- Political action to advocate for environmental policies and regulations that promote sustainability, conservation, and responsible resource management. This involves engaging with policymakers, lobbying for change, and supporting environmentally conscious candidates and initiatives.
- Long-term evaluation and monitoring of environmental interventions and policies to assess their effectiveness, identify areas for improvement, and ensure adaptive management approaches.

- Conservation of natural resources through sustainable practices such as responsible land use, water management, and waste reduction.
- Pollution abatement measures to reduce pollution sources, improve air and water quality, and minimise the negative impacts on ecosystems and human health.
- Resource sharing approaches to promote equitable distribution and sustainable use of resources, particularly in areas where resource scarcity or conflicts arise.

Tutor Marked Assignment

1. Which regions and geopolitical zones in Nigeria are most affected by environmental challenges?
2. What are some specific environmental challenges faced by Nigeria, such as pollution, deforestation, and urban flooding?
3. What are the main causes of natural disasters?
4. How can agricultural production be enhanced while maintaining the natural ecosystem?
5. What role do local governance and biodiversity management play in addressing environmental challenges?

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Glossary

Aso-Oke: Traditional Yoruba handwoven cloth often worn during special occasions.

Àdìrẹ: Hand-dyed fabric using resist-dyeing techniques, popular among the Yoruba people.

Bata: A type of drum used in Yoruba traditional music and dance.

Chieftaincy: A traditional system of hierarchical titles and leadership in Nigerian communities.

Dodo: Fried plantains, a popular Nigerian snack or side dish.

Eyo Festival: A colourful masquerade procession celebrated in Lagos, Nigeria.

Fula/Fulani: An ethnic group spread across West Africa, including Nigeria.

Gele: Elaborate headgear typically worn by Nigerian women on special occasions.

Hausa-Fulani: A socio-cultural group formed by the merging of the Hausa and Fulani peoples.

Igbo: One of the major ethnic groups in Nigeria, primarily located in the southeastern region.

Ìjálá: A Yoruba poetic chant often performed at ceremonies and events.

Ìrèké: A type of beadwork used to create elaborate Yoruba crowns.

Isiagu: A traditional embroidered patterned shirt worn by Igbo men.

Itsekiri: An ethnic group found in the Niger Delta region of Nigeria.

Kanuri: An ethnic group residing in northeastern Nigeria.

Kente: A colourful woven fabric often associated with Nigerian and West African traditions.

Kola Nut: A symbolic and ceremonial fruit often offered as a sign of hospitality in Nigerian culture.

Mmanwu: Masquerade traditions among the Igbo people, involving masked performers.

Obi: The central living quarters in a traditional Igbo household.

Ògún: Yoruba god of iron and war, one of the principal deities in Yoruba religion.

Oja: A traditional Nigerian marketplace or bazaar.

Òrìsà: Deities or spirits in the Yoruba religion, representing various natural forces.

Oware: A popular Nigerian board game also known as "Mancala."

Owambe: A term for elaborate and extravagant Nigerian parties and celebrations.

Sango: Yoruba god of thunder and lightning, also revered in other West African religions.

Sokoto Caliphate: A historic Islamic state in northern Nigeria.

Tiv: An ethnic group residing in the Benue Valley of Nigeria.

Udu: A traditional clay pot used as a musical instrument in Nigerian folk music.

Ukara: Indigo-dyed cloth with intricate patterns, commonly associated with the Igbo people.

Ukwu: A Nigerian dance style characterised by hip movements.

Uroko: A traditional Igbo motif symbolising the interconnectedness of life.

Yoruba: One of the three largest ethnic groups in Nigeria, mainly located in the southwestern region.

Zobo: A Nigerian drink made from dried hibiscus flowers.